

Hist 230 The Dark Side of Marxism

Numbered Transcript

HIST 230 • Dr. Paul Kengor

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Lecture 1: Marx Unmasked

At a glance — Kengor unmask Marx and introduces the series.

- 1.1 Hey, everybody. Welcome. Great to have you all here. So this series we're doing on Marx and Marxism, looking at the dark side of Karl Marx as well as Marxism.
- 1.2 I'll tell you a little bit about myself, my background. I'm from Western Pennsylvania, which is quite a distance from where we are in this studio right now. But I was born in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, in December 1966. You could figure out my age from there. I was actually raised in the town of Butler, Pennsylvania, which is now infamous—well, not infamous because the president was shot there but didn't die there mercifully. But I'll tell you, that's a weird thing when the high school that you graduated from, a class of 1984, Butler High School, that was quite a shock to have something like that happen in your hometown.
- 1.3 I went to school, the University of Pittsburgh, as an undergraduate. I actually was a pre-med major. I talked to Jordan Peterson about this when he interviewed me back in the summer of 2024. I worked for a pioneering transplant surgeon named Dr. Thomas Starzl. So that was 1987 to 1991.
- 1.4 It was during that time that I was pre-med, a biochem/biophysics major, that the Cold War was ending. It was the end of the Reagan presidency. The Berlin Wall came down in 1989. The collapse of Soviet communism in 1991. So I was really taken by those events, really got pulled into that, and ended up writing for the student newspaper and becoming the editorial page editor for the student newspaper.
- 1.5 In those days, back when they had print editions of newspapers—they don't have that many anymore—we were a daily campus newspaper. Well, at least daily Monday through Thursday. So every day I'm writing editorials, writing op-ed columns about the end of the Cold War. Amid all my pre-med studies, working at Presbyterian University Hospital, Children's Hospital in Pittsburgh, I'm constantly following the Reagan presidency and Gorbachev and John Paul II, Margaret Thatcher, Václav Havel, Lech Wałęsa, all of these events.
- 1.6 Eventually, I had to make a choice about which way I was going to take my career. I decided after—and this was agonizing, this was a tough decision. I mean, you're on your way to medical school. I decided to end up studying international relations, foreign policy, Soviet history, Marxism, communism, and so that ended up being my route instead. I went to graduate school in Washington, DC, at the American University's School of International Service. Eventually, I was hired by Grove City College, which is in Grove City, Pennsylvania— that's amazingly, only a half hour from my home in Butler, Pennsylvania—and I've been teaching there since 1997.

- 1.7 My first book, other than my dissertation, which doesn't really count—no one reads a dissertation, but it was published, the dissertation—was a book called *God and Ronald Reagan*, which came out in 2004. That book and the one that followed, which is *The Crusader, Ronald Reagan and the Fall of Communism*, led to *The Reagan* movie, starring Dennis Quaid, that came out in August 2024. So that movie is based on my book, *The Crusader, Ronald Reagan and the Fall of Communism*.
- 1.8 That led to a number of other books, including a book I did, *A Pope and a President on Ronald Reagan, John Paul II, and the end of the Cold War*. I think I've done in total over 20 books. They include the one that caught Jordan Peterson's eye, this one: *The Devil and Karl Marx*. This book and the conversation that I had with Jordan really inspired us to do this. Jordan had asked me, he said, "I'd like you to speak at my Jordan Peterson Academy. I said, "Yeah, I'd love to. I'd love to." I think at this point, we're talking right now, it's about a year and a half, two years ago. So I'm glad we made it happen.
- 1.9 I'm also—I've got to put out this plug—Editor of the *American Spectator*, which has been a fantastic publication founded by R. Emmett Tyrrell Jr. on the campus of Indiana University in Bloomington in 1967. It's been around now almost 60 years. We're still in print. We do a couple of print editions per year, but we're mainly online; spectator.org is the website for that.
- 1.10 All right, so that's a little bit about my background. I could say a lot more, but I don't want to talk too much about myself. We want to talk about Karl Marx, Marx and Marxism. Altogether, we've got eight lectures in this series. I will eventually read from the text itself at one point: *The Communist Manifesto*. It's not a very long book. Everybody thinks— I hear young people all the time that say, "Oh, *The Communist Manifesto* is a pretty good book if you just read it." I'm like, "Have you read it?" and it's very clear that they haven't. So, I'll tell them, "Read it, because it's not going to take you a lot of time." In fact, it's not actually even that long because this has several prefaces, intros, foreword, afterword; the text itself is about 50 some pages. So it's not that long of a book.
- 1.11 We're going to go chronologically through this series. So we'll start with Marx and where Marx was born, his upbringing, and then eventually when Marx meets Engels, then, when *The Manifesto* comes out, February 1848. And then we'll even go after that point through Bolshevik Russia, 1917, up through the end of the Cold War. And one of the subjects I want to hit in this series that doesn't get talked about enough, but I spent a lot of time on it in this book, *The Devil and Karl Marx*, is the infiltration of churches. That's a really shocking thing that the communists did, and people aren't aware of it. We were aware of it in the day, but people today don't talk about it much at all.
- 1.12 To begin with, the person of Karl Marx—so Marx was born May 5th, 1818. He was born in Trier, Germany. Trier is spelled almost like you'd pronounce it: Trier, T-R-I-E-R. And remarkably, this was one of the most religious cities in all of Germany and in all of Europe. The great Cathedral of Trier— Marx grew up really in the shadow of that

cathedral, what dates back to about the year 330. So, this goes back 1,700 years. It's one of the oldest cathedrals in Germany. That cathedral is so old; it was founded in part, built in part, financed in part by Helena, Saint Helena, who is the mother of none other than Constantine.

- 1.13** Constantine was the Roman Emperor who brought freedom and protection to Christians in the Roman Empire after several centuries of persecution of Christians. Helena is the one who—so she obviously was a woman of means. She had money. She went to the Holy Land, made a famous pilgrimage to the Holy Land around the year 320, and came back with several different relics, what she believed were relics. We're told were relics.
- 1.14** One of them was the Holy Cross, the cross itself, which today is in a cathedral in Spain. There are parts of the Holy Cross, relics, little pieces of it, that are recognized by the Vatican and in different churches around the world. Some people have said, "If you add up all the pieces, the cross would be as big as this room." I don't think that's quite true. I think that's people being cynical about it. But she brought back what she believed was the original cross.
- 1.15** She brought back the lance, the lance that Longinus, the Roman soldier at the foot of the cross, stuck into the side of Jesus. That is in the Vatican today. She brought back the Crown of Thorns, which she was told, and they believe, is the Crown of Thorns. Anyone know where that is today? It's in Notre Dame in Paris. In fact, when Notre Dame caught on fire a few years ago, a heroic priest ran in and grabbed the Crown of Thorns and put it up close and ran it through the flames to get it out of there and protect it.
- 1.16** This relates to the Cathedral in Trier. She brought back the robe that Jesus wore, that the Roman soldiers cast lots for at the foot of the cross. That robe is in the Cathedral in Trier today. Different Christians will make a pilgrimage there certain times of the year when they venerate the Holy Robe. So it is a sacred relic.
- 1.17** Now, quite remarkably, that relic, that robe, did Karl Marx know about it? Oh, yeah, of course. Everyone who grew up in Trier obviously knew about that. Marx, in one of his devilish plays, called "The Player," where he has this violinist who's sawing away with his violin and summoning up the powers of darkness. I'll read a quote from it in a minute. Marx was a playwright, so not only wrote the script for the play, but he also did the staging and production and also the costumes. He has his player, his violinist, as he's summoning up the powers of darkness, wearing the Holy Robe that Jesus wore, so mocking it.
- 1.18** In one case, Marx and his wife, Jenny—Jenny is making fun of these superstitious fools who come to town each year for this pilgrimage to check out the Holy Robe. I'll read from that poem right now. I open the book with quotes from two different Marx plays. As Jordan Peterson noticed and really caught on to this, Jordan pointed out, Jordan said to me that when he was a professor, and he would ask students to do writing, he

noticed that they would often do poetry because poetry really told them, was really a way to express themselves, and really showed a lot about the particular student.

- 1.19** What's fascinating that Marx wanted to be a poet. He fancied himself a poet. Marx, more than anything else—I mean, Marx was clearly not an economist. He would have been a lousy economist. He was a philosopher, really a polemicist. The Communist Manifesto is a polemic, a diatribe, really, but poetry. Poetry was his thing.
- 1.20** I'll read from Robert Payne, who was one of the best biographers of Marx that's forgotten about. He did, around late 1960s, early 1970s, two seminal volumes on Marx. Payne was a British professor, man of letters. He was a reviewer of plays, poems, literature. He was no hard-line, conservative or right-wing or anything like that, pretty apolitical. He did two different books, 1968, Marx: A Biography, and the 1971 book, The Unknown Karl Marx. The second book was published by New York University Press; the first book was published by Simon & Schuster. So these are very reputable publishing houses.
- 1.21** He did a deep dive and went into Marx's poetry, which a lot of people didn't even know about. It was really discovered by one of the first Marx biographers, a guy named Franz Mehring, way back in the time when Marx's daughters were still alive. When Mehring discovered some of this poetry, some of the quite literally demonic devilish poetry, he advised, "You should probably keep this under wraps. I don't know that you even want to get this published." And it was a later Russian scholar, a Soviet scholar for the Marx Institute, that found the material and had the integrity to post it.
- 1.22** By the way, at that point, the Soviets are militant atheists. Lenin and Trotsky had something called the League of the Militant Godless. So it probably doesn't bother them at all if Marx is writing this devilish poetry. But Payne, Professor Payne, picked up on this material, read it, and was really struck by it. So Payne wrote this, "Marx had a special love for poetry. Marx was devoted to poetry. Poetry was in his blood, and he could no more think of living without poetry than living without his vision of a Communist world."
- 1.23** Marx most admired Goethe. Goethe—people pronounce it a hundred different ways. Somebody watching this will probably say, "He's mispronouncing Goethe," G-O-E-T-H-E. Goethe did the famous Faust, the famous Faust play, epic. There's a Faust I, Faust II. This really struck Jordan Peterson as well because Jordan has read this stuff and knows it very well. Goethe wrote Faust. As Payne states of Marx, "Marx had a retentive memory and could recite long passages of Goethe's Faust with gusto, with a special preference for the speeches of Mephistopheles."
- 1.24** Now, Mephistopheles is the devil, the demon character, in Goethe's Faust. Faust is the Faust of the Faustian bargain. So this is no small thing. And Marx had a favorite line—I think this is fascinating, frightening, chilling, sick, disturbing, and it's one of the things that really got me into this whole issue of the devil and Karl Marx and struck Jordan as

well. If someone would ask you for a favorite line, a favorite quote, a favorite verse, I might quote a Scripture verse, I might quote a line from a saint, I might say something like, "Be not afraid." Ronald Reagan, one of my biographical subjects, would cite 2 Chronicles 7:14, maybe John 3:16. Actually, Reagan had a plaque on his desk in Sacramento that he also brought to the White House, which said, "There's no limit to how much a man could do if he doesn't mind who gets the credit." So this nice thought.

- 1.25** Well, Marx had an altogether different favorite phrase. It was a line from the Mephistopheles character in Faust. And the line was, "Everything that exists deserves to perish." "Everything that exists deserves to perish." I mean, that is something, right? "Everything that exists deserves to perish." And he's not just saying—this is so typical of Marx, which you'll see in The Communist Manifesto and his other writings—this guy is no tinkerer.
- 1.26** People say, "The Communist Manifesto is a pretty good book. It talks about loving your neighbor, helping the poor." We'll talk about this later. The word love is hardly mentioned at all in The Communist Manifesto. When it is, it has nothing to do with loving your neighbor. And the word neighbor isn't there either. It's filled with words like everything, criticism, abolition, abolish, over and over again. So he doesn't just say the bad things in society should cease to exist. This is so common of Marx: "Everything that exists deserves to perish." This is a guy who wants to take it all down, destroy it, root and branch, and stand there. I mean, picture if you could, Marx in some of his plays, standing there in a village of ruins with flames all around him: "Now we can begin again. Now we're ready. Now we're ready to go."
- 1.27** He also said—and I'll talk about this as well at the end of The Communist Manifesto—The Communist Manifesto calls for the abolition of the present state of things. And I think the most telling line at the end of the manifesto, which I'll drill down on a few lectures from now, it closes by calling for "the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions." Marx and Engels' Communist Manifesto, published in February 1848, calls for "the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions." This guy isn't a tinkerer with tax rates who was looking to redistribute a little wealth here to the poor. This is a guy who wants to take it all down: "forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions." "Everything that exists deserves to perish." To perish.
- 1.28** Marx also knew by heart passages from Dante's Divine Comedy, La Divina Commedia. The Divine Comedy has three parts to it. What are the three parts? The bottom: Inferno, hell. Middle: Purgatorio, purgatory. And then heaven, Paradiso. My colleague and good friend, Robert Orlando, has done a great book that came out in 2025 called Karl Marx: The Divine Tragedy. Rob has a website that goes with it called marxinhell.com, where Orlando imagines going to the different circles of hell with Karl Marx, because Marx was really fixated on Dante's Divine Comedy.
- 1.29** This is interesting: Dante's Divine Comedy. What Dante wants to do is, the pilgrim ascends, so you go down to the circles of hell, and then you go into purgatory for this

purgation, and your ultimate goal is heaven. But with Karl Marx, it's the opposite. He starts—and Orlando does this with his book— he starts as this idealist, and then he ends up in hell in the end. And one of Marx's plays that I opened up the book with, from 1837, he said, "Thus, heaven I've forfeited. I know it full well. My soul, once true to God, is chosen for hell." It's quite a statement: "Thus, heaven, I've forfeited. I know it full well. My soul, once true to God, is chosen for hell."

- 1.30** Rob Orlando said, it's curious. Dante's Divine Comedy, of course, he talks about heaven all the time. His eyes are all mainly in heaven. Rob says that Marx never writes about heaven. He doesn't. And actually, the one time that he does in that 1837 play, he says, "Heaven I forfeited. I know it full well." And then he says, "My soul, once true to God, is chosen for hell."
- 1.31** Marx himself, his soul was once true to God. He was raised in a religious home—I'll get back to this in a second. But he eventually chooses to move away from that. I don't know that we could say that his soul was chosen for hell, but Marx certainly chose from his own free will to reject this heavenly view that he had earlier and to reject God, and let's just say, go in a different direction.
- 1.32** Robert Payne also adds here that he said, "The young Marx was passionately devoted to poetry, and he took himself very seriously as a poet. Poetry was the life of his life, the safe refuge from all the turmoils of his revolutionary existence." The one play that I mentioned earlier—and I'll get to it again right now with the violinist— that was called "The Player," and it was published in 1841. He published it in the Berlin Literary magazine, Athenaeum, in January 1841. Marx at this point is 22 years old. So again, born May 5th, 1818. So at this point is 22 years old.
- 1.33** I've run into a couple of Marxist biographers. Most of the Marx biographers are sympathetic, so they try to defend the guy. Most of them ignore this devilish poetry like the plague. They want nothing to do with it. But if they mention it, they'll find a way to shrug it off, pretend like Marx is being playful or whatever, or these are like youthful indiscretions.
- 1.34** But when Marx is writing this at 1841, the 1840s are the peak of Marx's output. He did his "opiate of the masses" essay in the 1840s. He did The Communist Manifesto in 1846, 1847, published in February 1848. So this was published, "The Player," seven years before the publication of The Communist Manifesto, fittingly published by the editors under the title Savage Songs, which is really precisely what they connote, pure savagery. "The Player," this unnerving poem, describes this violinist who, in a delirious frenzy, is summoning up the powers of darkness with his furious strings.
- 1.35** I'm thinking here of Charlie Daniels' song, The Devil Went Down to Georgia: "The devil went down to Georgia, lookin' for some souls to steal." I don't think Daniels knew anything about this. But in the ballad, the violinist seems to be autobiographical, like it

might be Marx himself. This is hard to say. It's always hard to know when a writer or a poet is writing, if he's speaking about himself or not. Payne thinks it's autobiographical.

- 1.36** There can only be one outcome here. He ultimately destroys himself. So when an onlooker asks the violinist why he's playing this way, this delirious frenzy, and that onlooker is the love interest of the player, who Payne and others think is Marx's future wife: Jenny von Westphalen. So a perturbed Marx or perturbed player, whoever this is, says that he can't help himself, and he will stab her with his blood dark sword before his violin in hard burst. Here's the quote. Here's Marx: "The player strikes up his violin, his blond hair falling down. He wears a sword at his side and a wide, wrinkled gown." By the way, the gown is the Holy Robe of Christ.
- 1.37** "'Oh player,'"—this is a quote—"why playest thou so wild? Why the savage look in thine eyes? Why the leaping blood, the soaring waves? Why tearest thou thy bow to shreds?" And he answers, "'I play for the sake of the thundering sea crashing against the walls of the cliffs, that my eyes be blinded and my heart burst, and my soul resound in the depths of Hell.'"
- 1.38** "'Oh player, why tearest thou thy heart to shreds and mockery? This art was given thee by a shining God to elevate the mind into the swelling music of the starry dance.'" So the player here is misusing this elegant art, the graceful sound of a violin. I mean, what's more beautiful in an orchestra than a violin? Beethoven's Violin Concerto. Mozart orchestra concert or symphony. So he uses it not to elevate the mind, as God would want him to do, but the opposite.
- 1.39** Then Marx writes this, "Look now, my blood dark sword shall stab unerringly within thy soul. God neither knows nor honors art. That hellish vapors rise and fill the brain. Till I go mad and my heart is utterly changed. See the sword—the Prince of Darkness sold it to me. For he beats the time and gives the signs. Ever more boldly I play the dance of death. I must play darkly, I must play lightly until my heart and my violin burst." Yeah, crazy. "Ever more boldly I play the dance of death."
- 1.40** In the book, the opening chapter, I call The Dance of Death, because the Marxist ideology ends up responsible for more deaths than any other ideology in history: over 100 million people dead, according to the Harvard University Press Book, The Black Book of Communism, in the 20th century alone. So he plays not for God and to uplift the mind, but for the dance of death. So surely this again reminds of Faust, the Faustian bargain.
- 1.41** Robert Payne observes this: "Marx is here celebrating a Satanic mystery, for the player is clearly Lucifer or Mephistopheles, and what he is playing with such frenzy is the music which accompanies the end of the world." That's Payne's interpretation of it.
- 1.42** All right. Another Marx play that is very disturbing, and I would urge caution with this if you're doing any searching on this online, is called Oulanem: O-U-L-A-N-E-M. Oulanem: O-U-L-A-N-E-M. This is very unsettling, and Robert Payne has this interpretation.

Richard Wurmbrand, who wrote the book *Tortured for Christ*, the Romanian pastor who was tortured in communist cells in Romania during the Cold War, says this. Paul Johnson, the late British historian, said this: "This play, quite remarkably, is an anagram for Manuelo, or Immanuel, or God. In fact, as Payne formulated it, "Manuelo equals Immanuel equals God."

- 1.43 Wurmbrand was even blunter. He identified the anagram as a directly Satanic anagram for the name Immanuel or Manuelo, which is the Hebrew biblical name for Jesus, meaning "God is with us." It's at the Annunciation that the angel Gabriel says to Mary, "Hail, full of grace." She said, "What greeting is this?" "Be not afraid, Mary, for God has found favor with you. You shall bear a child. His name shall be Emmanuel, meaning God is with us." So he's inverting this in this play, the sacred name.
- 1.44 Marx does a lot of this. He does a lot of using religious language, which he knew because of where he lived and where he was brought up and the fact that he had been a Christian as a young man. And he ends up inverting it and turning into a dark way.
- 1.45 Act I of *Oulanem* takes the audience straight into a dialogue between two of Marx's main characters, including the namesake Oulanem, who's described as a German traveler, and his trusty companion who's named Lucindo: L-U-C-I-N-D-O, Lucindo. The action takes place in a mountain town in Italy. Oulanem and Lucindo find no room in the inn—maybe, perhaps akin to Mary and Joseph finding no room in the inn to give birth to Emmanuel. Yet Oulanem and Lucindo are no Mary and Joseph, even as they are somewhat of a couple or almost. Both are male, and it's a really weird thing.
- 1.46 They stay in this house of an Italian man named Pertini. As Marx himself states in his play, "Oulanem, Oulanem! The name rings forth like a death, rings forth until it dies away in a wretched crawl." And then he appends this really disquieting passage. "Yet I have power within my youthful arms to clench and crush you with tempestuous force. While for us both the abyss yawns in darkness, you will sink down and I shall follow laughing, whispering in your ears, 'Descend, come with me, friend.'"
- 1.47 So each scene, insidious scene, crawls along like this. I caution people watching this online—you're going to do it now, even though I'm going to warn you not to. If you look up, if you Google Oulanem, be careful because you'll get Satanic imagery on your computer. In fact, the Wikipedia entry for Oulanem even refers to a play by Marx, by the young Marx.
- 1.48 Scene III is the most bitter of all of these. Oulanem is seated alone at a table, writing with papers tossed all around him. That was what Marx did. Marx was always in a library, always with papers, always tossed around him. He suddenly springs up and stands with arms folded and declares—now, Payne and some others think, again, that this is autobiographical by Marx. I don't always know what Marx is thinking with this stuff. It's hard to say. But he springs up, stands with arms folded and declares, "All lost! The hour has now expired, and time stands still. This pigmy universe collapses. Soon I

shall clasp eternity and howl humanity's giant curse into its ear. Eternity! It is eternal pain. Death, inconceivable, immeasurable! An evil artifice contrived to taunt us."

- 1.49** This is the climactic scene right here, where the time comes for the death of Oulanem. It's here that Marx, quite astoundingly, appears to have either the person or the subject or maybe even himself declare in the form of the creator, "I shall howl gigantic curses at mankind." Paul Johnson's chapter on Karl Marx in his book, *The Intellectuals*, is titled, *I Shall Howl Gigantic Curses at Mankind*. Paine notes that Oulanem sees himself as this agent of destruction, as the judge who condemns and then acts as the executioner, confident that he is in possession of the powers of God to annihilate the universe. Payne says this: "Oulanem was Marx as judge and executioner." Here again, he goes to the line from Faust, Mephistopheles, "Everything that exists deserves to perish."
- 1.50** Richard Wurmbrand remarked that Oulanem may be the only drama he was aware of, in which every character is fully aware of his or her own corruption, and yet all flaunt and celebrate it with prideful conviction. All of the characters are irredeemably bad. There's usually a protagonist. So there's a dark night of the soul. There's a moment, there can be a happy ending, but not in this. And this is not done by the playwright with a noble purpose of revealing the dark to herald the light. There is no light, there is no black and white here. Just black. Wurmbrand wrote, "Here all are servants of darkness. All are Satanic, corrupt, and doomed." So Bad stuff.
- 1.51** All right, so picking up with Karl Marx in his early life. So born May 5th, 1818. And again, in that shadow of the great cathedral in Trier. His father was Heinrich. Heinrich was a very interesting man. He was Jewish. The family, Marx was ethnically Jewish. He came from a family that had many rabbis. A number of them were quite Orthodox rabbis. His father, however, like an uncle and some others in his family, converted to Christianity.
- 1.52** The father, some biographers say that the father did this in response to the social pressures of the day. This was a place where Jews were persecuted. I don't know if I totally see it that way. I mean, the father seemed legitimately interested in Christianity and seemed to have a pretty strong faith. Interestingly, the father converted to Lutheranism, which in the very Catholic Trier was not the direction that most people went. But the father became Lutheran.
- 1.53** His wife, Henrietta, wasn't fully on board with this. In fact, the father wanted the kids to be baptized. She wasn't so sure about that. Marx, however, in fact, you can see this in the fact that Karl himself didn't get baptized until 1824. So at that point, he's five or six years old. So he wasn't baptized at birth, even though his father had been converted earlier. Marx would be eventually confirmed as well at the age of 15.
- 1.54** The father urged the son always to embrace religion and understand the fact that it was good for a person. In fact, the quote from the father, he says to Karl, "Religion is a good support to morality and a simple faith in God. Sooner or later, it's good for a man

to have faith. It gives him something to believe in, something other than himself." But Marx starts to slowly pull away from this. He's a fairly passionate Christian as a teenager, writes a piece around the age of 15 or 16, an essay in high school on union with Christ, which actually shows that he seems to be a pretty sincere Christian. But he starts to pull away from this. In his late teens, as he becomes more restless, more troubled, and especially by the time that he got to college, he's going to have a full break when he gets to college.

- 1.55** His father is watching this and is very, very troubled by it. Heinrich, the father, wrote a letter to his son, Karl, on March 2nd, 1837. This is quite a letter. "Karl, at times, my heart delights in thinking of you and your future." Because Karl is a very intelligent young man. Precocious, obviously, is blessed with a good mind, high level of intelligence. So, "At times my heart delights in thinking of you and your future. And yet at times I cannot rid myself of ideas which arouse in me, sad forebodings and fear, when I am struck as if by lightning by the thought. Is your heart, Karl, in accord with your head, your talents? Has it room for the earthly but gentler sentiments which in this veil of sorrow are so essentially consoling for a man of feeling?"
- 1.56** Again, the importance of faith, valley of sorrow, veil of tears, valley of tears. Then this line from the dad to the son: "And since that heart is obviously animated and governed by a demon, not granted to all men, is that demon heavenly or Faustian?" Some translators interpret the word demon in the initial line as ghost or spirit. "If it's governed by a spirit, not granted to all men, is that spirit heavenly or Faustian?" And of course, Marx, who wants to write nothing less than Goethe's Faust of his age and wants to be a poet and quotes all the time, Mephistopheles, the father's on to something here.
- 1.57** The father asked him, "Will you ever—and that is not the least painful doubt of my heart—will you ever be capable of truly human domestic happiness? Will—and this doubt has no less tortured me recently since I have come to love a certain person like my own child—will you ever be capable of imparting happiness to those immediately around you?"
- 1.58** That's quite a statement because Marx is not very good at imparting happiness to the people around him throughout his life. He refuses to work. Both his wife and his mother expressed the wish that "Karl would start earning some capital rather than just writing about it." The family is broke all the time. They get their money from Engels. Well, first, initially, the family gets money from Marx's parents, and then Heinrich eventually has to cut them off. And then the mother, after that, in fact, Marx did not go to his father's funeral. Some sympathetic biographers said that he couldn't make it. The weather was bad, whatever. I don't totally know. Marx seemed to love his father. If this was outside—I don't know. But Marx did not attend his father's funeral.
- 1.59** He then goes, and he sees his mother for the first time in quite a while. He writes a letter back to his wife, "Jenny," saying, basically, "Bad news: I didn't get any more

money from her. However, some good news: I did get her to rip up the IOUs." Success, right? Success. And the mother at that point, tough love: "Karl, I know you have all these children. I know that they're going hungry. I know it's cold at night." Marx lost several children. Some heartbreaking stories. In one case, this son, Edgar, whom he loved and adored, it's quite heartbreaking that Marx lost his child, this boy they loved so much. Guido, another child that they lost near infancy. But the mother said, "I know this is a struggle, but we can't give you any more money. You've got to work. You have to get your own job. You have to get your own job."

1.60 So the family, at that point, he and his wife, Jenny, they go to Jenny's family. Jenny's family was pretty well off. They had money. So they started giving money to the Marxes because, again, Karl refused to work. Eventually, the family says, "We have to cut you off. We can't do this. No, this is wrong. You have to get an income. We can't lend you any more money."

1.61 Marx and Jenny start going after relatives for this. At one point, Jenny crosses the English Channel and shows up wet in a rainstorm at a relative's place, soaking wet, asking for money. Jenny is writing letters to Karl, saying, "Karl, I'm in a terrible state. Everybody thinks I'm a liar. The landlady wants to throw us out. The butcher is this terrifying individual. We need money. I don't mean to ask you again and again, but we need money. Karl, we need money." Really, what Marx is creating with his Marxist system is the economic system that would subsidize somebody like Marx. While he sat around and theorized and created an ideology and ideologized and sat in his study and didn't have to earn an income.

1.62 Eventually, Jenny's family said, "Okay, we can't give you any more money. We will lend you Helene. Lenchen was her nickname. Helene Demuth. Helene was the family nursemaid for Jenny's family, grew up with Jenny. And so at one point, the family says, "We will lend you Helene to help with the family at home." So Helene stays with Karl and Jenny and the Marx family. And Marx, of course, doesn't pay her a dime. She's really, Payne describes her as an indentured servant because Marx is champion of the working class and the proletariat and the working man and equal distribution of wealth, won't pay her any money at all.

1.63 By the way, Marx and Engels in their book, *The Origin of the Family*, which was published in 1884, a year after Marx died, posthumously for Marx. Marx died in 1883. But Engels and Marx talk in there about turning childcare into a full-time state-run industry where you would have nannies at home that would take care of the children. This is one of the things that radical leftists like about Marxism. Women would be pushed out of the home into the farms and into the factories where they could work. The raising of children would become a full-time state industry. They liked that idea. They liked that worldview.

1.64 So, Helene Demuth was lent to the Marxes, and Karl got her pregnant behind Jenny's back. We don't know exactly the circumstances. Payne says that it's not clear that the

sex was consensual. I don't know how he would know that. We don't know. But a child was born. And at that point, Marx, of course, absolutely denied that the child was his. Everybody knew the child was his, including Jenny. Paul Johnson said, Jenny's heart never recovered from this. She felt so betrayed by her husband over this.

- 1.65** Engels knows that the child is Marx's. So Engels says, "I don't care about marriage." Marx, by the way, wasn't a big fan of it either. He wrote a letter to Engels at one point, which said, "Blessed is he who has no family," kind of a curious take on the Beatitudes. I think he's expressing at that point his misery of raising children. He even wrote a letter to Paul Lafargue, his future son-in-law, saying, "If I had to do life all over again, I wouldn't get married." He even says, "My wife's misery is unspeakable," what she has to go through all the time.
- 1.66** So Engels did not believe in marriage. The communists and The Communist Manifesto talk about the abolition of the family. We'll talk about that later. Engels did not believe in marriage. He lived with a woman for a long time, which in those days didn't happen. If you lived together, you were married. And the woman that he lived with wanted Engels to marry her, but he refused to. When she died, by the way, he was heartbroken at the loss. It was not expected.
- 1.67** Marx wrote a letter to Engels, where, in the first couple of lines, he acknowledged Engels' loss. And then in the next 30 lines, he got to the more important point in Marx's mind of talking about money. And Engels exploded with an angry letter: "Even my capitalist friends showed more sympathy than you did." It almost blew the relationship right there between the two.
- 1.68** So the boy is born, and Engels steps forward and says, "Look, my reputation, I don't care about it. I'll accept paternity for the child. And they named the child Frederick, Friedrich, Freddie. He outlives all of Marx's children, the children to Jenny and Karl. He outlives Jenny, outlives Karl. Marx never acknowledged his existence, and of course, never gave him a dime. Never, ever gave him a dime.
- 1.69** Engels' relationship in all of this: he's not only a writing partner with Marx, but he's Marx's chief subsidizer. It's very ironic. We'll see this when we read The Communist Manifesto. Point three in The Communist Manifesto calls for the abolition of all rights of inheritance. What hypocrisy. Marx and Engels got all their money through inheritance. Marx got every bit of money he could from his father, his mother, from Jenny's parents. Engels' father was a wealthy industrialist. So after Marx couldn't get money from his and Jenny's family, Engels became Marx's sugar daddy. That's where all the money came from. Marx and Jenny could not have survived, literally, without the help that Engels provided.
- 1.70** All right. Getting back to Heinrich, the father. Heinrich said—and here's the quote, I'll read it again. I said it maybe about 10 minutes ago. He advised Karl— this is an exact quote, I butchered the quote a little bit earlier—"a good support for morality is a simple

faith in God. You know that I am the last person to be a fanatic, but sooner or later, a man has a real need of this faith, and there are moments in life when even the man who denies God is compelled against his will to pray to the Almighty." So that was his view, to the son.

- 1.71** I should note here before I move on a little bit further, and I want to make this clear to people watching this online: I don't say in my writings or in my book that has the title *The Devil and Karl Marx*, I don't say that I think that Marx was possessed. I don't know. To quote Barack Obama: "That's above my pay grade." I have no idea whether it's something like that. Richard Wurmbrand, the Romanian pastor, went really far in describing certain things that Marx did as Satanic rituals, Black masses, seances. I've never seen anything like that. What I've seen is troubling enough. I would caution people: don't go beyond what the evidence says. If you're going to criticize somebody, make strong charges, don't go too far.
- 1.72** But it's undeniable, you see over and over again, Marx's family members and close friends referring to him with words like his father: "governed by a demon." His son, in one spot, refers to his dad as "my dear devil." Maybe this is being playful. I don't know. But my son's never referred to me as my dear devil. Maybe behind my back. I don't know. Engels— and I'll talk about this when he and Engels met—referred to Marx as "the monster of 10,000 devils." His wife referred to him as "her wicked knave." My wife does not refer to me as her wicked knave. The striking number of intimates and associates who didn't hesitate to compare him to Faust or Mephistopheles.
- 1.73** Karl Heinzen, one of his biographers, one of his friends, wrote this. Karl Heinzen, Heinzen is H-E-I-N-Z-E-N, was a friend of Marx's. And he wrote about helping walk Marx home after the two of them had consumed, "several bottles of wine." That's a lot, by the way. My wife and I go out to dinner, we split a bottle of wine. If I go a little further, maybe a third glass, several bottles, I don't know. But Heinzen recounted this: "As soon as I was in the house with Marx, he shut the doors, hid the key, and jeered comically at me that I was his prisoner. He asked me to follow him up into his study." Now, Marx was obviously smashed drunk. Heinzen said that Marx seemed to forget that Heinzen was there, but then he came around, and he began acting very strangely.
- 1.74** Heinzen wrote this: "He"—Marx—"came over to me, and he gave me to understand that he had me in his power. And with a malice that recalled an imp rather than the intended devil, he began to attack me with threats and cuffs. I begged him to spare me that sort of thing because it went against the grain to pay him back in the same coin. When Marx did not stop, I gave him a serious warning that I would deal with him in a way that he would certainly feel. And when that too did no good, I saw myself compelled to dispatch him into the corner of their own. When he got up, I said that I found his personality boring, and I asked him to open the front door. Now it was his turn to be triumphant."

- 1.75 Marx said to him, "'Go home then, strong man,' he mocked and added a most comical smirk." And then here's this phrase again from Heinzen. "It was as though he was chanting the words from Faust, 'Faust, again, again. There is one imprisoned inside.' At least the sentiment was similar, although his unsuccessful imitation of Mephistopheles made the situation comic in the extreme. In the end, I warned him that if he would not open the door for me, then I would get it open myself, and he would have to pay for the damage. Since Marx only answered with mocking sneers, I went down, tore the front door off its lock, and called him out to the street that he should shut the house up to prevent the entry of thieves. Dumb with amazement that I had escaped from his spell, he leaned out of the window and goggled at me with his small eyes like a wet goblin."
- 1.76 So here again, words like "imp," "intended devil," "Faust," "Mephistopheles," "chanting the words from Faust," "there is one imprisoned inside," "in his power, mocking sneers," "dumb with amazement that I had escaped from his spell," small eyes like a wet goblin"—pretty weird. I've done biographies of a lot of people as diverse as Ronald Reagan, George W. Bush, Hillary Clinton, Pope John Paul II. I've never seen any description of any event by anybody ever like that.
- 1.77 But back to the point. We got about five minutes to wrap up this first lecture. I want to make clear in the issue of demonic and how exactly, how I interpret this. So these phrases, what you just heard from Karl Heinzen, what you heard from the father, "governed by a demon" and everything, there's just too many of these, and it's hard to just cast this off, laugh it off. Some of his biographers, if they deal with this at all, will say that this is in jest, maybe, or a weird playfulness by Marx, and it's not entirely clear, but the frequency of all these observations is jarring and something that's hard to shrug off.
- 1.78 That said, Robert Payne, in his 1968 book on Marx— Robert Payne, again, a British man of letters. This book was published through Simon & Schuster. In his chapter on Marx called *The Demons*, he writes this, "There were times when Marx seemed to be possessed by demons. He had the devil's view of the world and the devil's malignity. Sometimes he seemed to know that he was accomplishing works of evil."
- 1.79 How evil? Personally, I have no proof that Karl Marx was a Satanist. I can't say that the man was possessed. I wouldn't dare hazard that a charge. I don't know that. Some will say—and Jordan Peterson really drilled down on this with me—that by the end of his life, he was clearly a militant atheist. Why would an atheist be a Satanist? Well, I'll talk about this in the lead for the next lecture.
- 1.80 There are certain radicals of Marx's generation, Mikhail Bakunin, I could pick up with him. Even later, someone like Saul Alinsky, who in his book *Rules for Radicals*, in the beginning says, "Lest we begin with at least an over-the-shoulder acknowledgement to that first of all rebels who won himself his own kingdom, Lucifer." So they identify with Satan as this figure of rebellion. They might not even believe in the supernatural. They

might not believe that there's an actual devil or that Satan exists, but they like Satan as this rebel who won for himself his own kingdom.

1.81 So more likely, I think what some mean to say is that Marx was an atheist who, in a way, whether he was fully cognizant of it or not, was doing evil, or what some might even call the work of the devil and what communism led to, with all the death that it led to. But again, these are things that I certainly can't authenticate. I'll close again with the 1837 poem: "Thus, heaven I've forfeited, I know it full well," said Marx. "My soul, once true to God, is chosen for hell."

1.82 The IOUs that you spoke of.

1.83 Yes.

1.84 Since he refused to work, what exactly did he proffer was going to be the way that he would ever pay anyone back? Was he to become famous?

1.85 Right. Yeah. I don't think he really ever expected to make much money. He was somebody who, again, simply did not want to earn capital. There's a quote I use in the book from Aristotle, which some have translated as, "Men seek revolutions for their own purposes." So they want a new revolutionary world according to what it is that they want from their own personality.

1.86 I think Marx was trying to conceive or create a world where the system would take care of somebody like him. And if you look at all the different communist dictators: Lenin, Stalin, Mao Zedong, Pol Pot, Fidel Castro, these guys are taken care of by the masses. So I often say that communism is for the masses, not the masters. It's for the ruled, not the rulers. The rulers have their own system. They live in a mansion. They live in their Datcha on the Black Sea. Castro, everybody in Cuba makes the same amount of money, but he dies worth \$2 billion. So they set themselves up completely differently. The rules that they make apply to everybody else. So in Karl's case, he's trying to put together a system that I think would take care of somebody like him.

1.87 Now, the reality is—and he says this in his 10-point plan in The Communist Manifesto, we'll talk about this a few lectures from now—one of his points is an equal obligation for all to work. That's not like equal opportunity to work for everybody. In the communist system, you had an obligation to work. And if you didn't, the Soviets called you a work-shirker and would quite literally gulag people who refused to work. Janusz Bardach, in his book *Man Is Wolf to Man*, talks about being in the gulag and meeting a young girl who was in the gulag because she was 10 minutes late for work. He says, 10 minutes late for work. Ten minutes—in the gulag— 10 minutes late to work. But that's somebody who's failing in her obligation to work.

1.88 In America, in major cities, you see homeless people everywhere. You didn't see that in the Soviet Union. It's not because everybody has a job. No, you didn't go homeless. You

had an obligation to work, as the book itself says. So with Karl Marx, there's so much hypocrisy in his life and ideology.

- 1.89** One of the things I like to really tell people is, oftentimes, people think that I'm beating up on Marx personally in order to just go after him and take shots. No, I want people to see that the man's own life is a reflection of the ideology or even of the inconsistencies in the ideology. It's really important to understand the man, to understand the ideology and the evils of the ideology.
- 1.90** I guess my question centers around what were the economic or maybe cultural conditions that were existent when he was growing up that maybe helped shape his worldview?
- 1.91** Yeah, it's a good question. When he was growing up, as compared to later, especially with the launching of the Communist League and The Manifesto in 1848. Matt Fradd, who does Pints with Aquinas, I remember he asked me this in a podcast. He said, "Can't you say anything good about Marxism at all? Was there anything that the communists got right?" And I said, "No, I don't think so." I said that maybe they were right in militating against the harsh conditions of the Industrial Revolution, but that's not unique to the communists. The churches were all complaining about that, too.
- 1.92** In the United States, the turn of the century progressive movement pushed child labor laws. My family that came to America, my dad's side, Polish, my mother's side, Italian, who worked in the coal mines. They had harsh working conditions, but it was also their choice to whether or not they wanted to work there or not. So other people were right in describing that. Marx alone didn't have that insight. Read Charles Dickens. Dickens' father was in debtor's prison.
- 1.93** And I would tell this to people as well today. So, for people to say we should like Marx and Engels and communism even today, because they were right about the conditions of the Industrial Revolution. Look out your window. It ain't 1840s Germany anymore. So that world that they described at that point in time, that's now gone. It's a totally different world, which is why the Marxists today are applying Marxism not to economics and not to class, but to different areas: culture, gender, even sexuality, race.
- 1.94** If you go to the website peoplesworld.org, which is a successor to the Daily Worker, they have a call there in the About section for cultural workers. They're not trying to get coal miners from West Virginia. Those guys all voted for Trump. They're not trying to get steelworkers. My relatives from Western Pennsylvania, those guys voted for Trump. They're focused on the Starbucks worker. That's where you see them organizing with petitions. They're looking for people who could change the culture, who can apply communism in a totally different oppressor-versus-oppressed model, based not on economics and proletariat bourgeoisie, but on male-female, black-white, or some other oppressed-oppressor formulation. But I'm getting ahead of myself. I'll talk about that in-depth later.

- 1.95 Do we know what relationship Marx and Engels had if it was very close, maybe like Emmanuel and Lucindo or more formal, and if Engels' life was similar and maybe how they met?
- 1.96 Yeah, Yeah. So Engels was—I'm going to hold my fire on Engels when I talk about him, I think in the third lecture. But they did get along well. Engels spoke—Engels gave the eulogy at Marx's funeral. He gave the eulogy at Marx's wife's funeral, Jenny. And really, Engels was one of the only people who was able to get along with him. Marx would eventually blow up with so many different people, with Heinzen, with Bakunin, who I'm going to quote in the next lecture; he was very, very difficult to work with. He was difficult to live with. In the next lecture as well, I'm going to talk about what it was like growing up in the Marx household because the man led this incredibly disordered life.

Lecture 2: The Roots of Marxism

At a glance — The roots of Marxism.

- 2.1 Everybody, welcome back. So lecture two here. I want to read one more letter from Heinrich, from the father, to Karl Marx. And then we're going to go a little bit deeper into Marx on religion, his famous "opiate of the masses" essay. And as I alluded to in the previous talk about his family, a little bit more about his family, his disorderly life, really chaotic life, and also Mikhail Bakunin, because that relates to the whole issue of how these guys saw Satan as a Satanic figure—in some cases, not as an actual figure that they actually believed existed, because they were atheists, but as a symbol of rebellion.
- 2.2 I thought I'd pick up with another disturbing letter from the father. Heinrich wrote this on December 9th. Now, it follows a November 10th, 1837 letter from Karl Marx. It's really something, this letter. You could tell that Karl, at this point, is really wrestling with things. I don't want to overuse the word demons, but he's being tormented here. So he wrote his father a long, heartfelt, kind of sorrowful letter. And it's a rather touching letter. I don't always feel much sympathy for Karl Marx on so many levels, as you guys have seen, but this one kind of touched me.
- 2.3 And he finishes the letter about 4:00 in the morning. It's dated November 10th, 1837. So he's under candlelight while he's doing this. There's not electricity at that point. So the candle went out, probably. He can no longer see anymore what he had written. And nearing his final thoughts, Karl wrote, "A deep unrest has mastered me, and I shall not be able to lay the specters that haunt me until I am in your dear presence." That's to his father. Again, he had a good relationship with his father.
- 2.4 So it's interesting, the man who would write about the specter of communism, and as you'll see when we talk about The Communist Manifesto, it opens with the phrase, "A specter is haunting Europe, the specter of communism." So, ironic that he's using the word specter here. So, as a man who would write about the specter of communism that haunted Europe was writing about the specter, the specters that were haunting him. A deep unrest had mastered him.
- 2.5 One biographer refers to this as a monumental letter from the son to the father in response, which I think is fair to say. I'm only here quoting a little bit of the father's response. So it took the father some time to digest this letter from Karl, November 10th, 1837. On December 9th, so that would be about almost a month later, Heinrich Marx kind of vomited out this angry response to his son. And I feel bad for the son, but he vented at his son. And here we go.
- 2.6 "God's grief!!!" Triple exclamation marks. "Disorderliness, musty excursions into all departments of knowledge, musty brooding under a gloomy oil lamp." Karl, at this point, is not married yet, and we haven't seen the infamous Karl Marx of history, who

lives this incredibly disordered life. I mean, Marx was a very unclean individual, and this is something that bothered his wife and kids as well.

- 2.7 Marx was not into bathing. He very frequently didn't bathe. He kept a long beard throughout much of his life. He suffered his entire life from carbuncles, from sores. At one point, doctors come into the house to try to find out what's causing all of these sores all over his body. Big part of it is, the man doesn't exercise, he doesn't wash, he doesn't get up, he doesn't get up from around the house. He just simply didn't take care of himself. That was something that would plague him his entire life.
- 2.8 So the father writes, "Running wild in a scholar's dressing gown and with unkempt hair instead of running wild over a glass of beer; unsociable withdrawal with neglect of all decorum and even all consideration of the father. On several occasions," so he complains, "on several occasions, we were without a letter for months, Karl," meaning Heinrich and the family.
- 2.9 "And the last time when you knew Edward was ill, mother suffering, and I myself not well, and moreover cholera was raging in Berlin, and as if that did not even call for an apology. Your next letter contained not a single word about it, but merely some badly written lines, which I would quite frankly prefer to throw out rather than accept. A crazy botch-work which merely testifies how you squander your talents and you spend your nights giving birth to monsters." "Spend your nights giving birth to monsters."
- 2.10 "That you follow in the footsteps of the new immoralists who twist their words until they themselves do not hear them. And why? I do him the justice of saying that he is no rake. As if we were men of wealth, my Herr Son disposed in one year of almost 700 thalers, contrary to all agreement, contrary to all usage, whereas the richest spend less than 500 thalers. And why? I do him the justice of saying that he is no rake, no squanderer. But how can a man who every week," as the dad's saying to the son, "who every week or two discovers a new system and has to tear up old works laboriously arrived at, how can he, I ask, worry about trifles? How can he submit to the pettiness of order? Everyone dips a hand in his pocket and everyone cheats him, so long as he doesn't disturb him in his studies, and a new money order is soon written again, of course."
- 2.11 So the father is incensed here, right, of the son's selfishness, personally, financially, that the son is squandering his talents and dad's money, "giving birth to monsters," as he put it. Father died the next year, 1838, so quite tragic. And that was really the one person, I think, in Karl's life that was providing him order at that point and love and some guidance, and trying to keep him on the track of a faith that the father felt would do him good.
- 2.12 Now, Karl starts to break away from that faith. The key is 1835 when he goes to college. He goes to the University of Bonn. He goes to the University of Berlin. In college, he meets this professor of New Testament studies, what we might call today maybe

something like systematic theology, named Bruno Bauer, who was, like a lot of teachers at universities today who teach religion, an atheist. But Bauer was a committed atheist. He was a nasty individual, and he was anti-Semitic. He was anti-Semitic. And Karl, of course, was Jewish. He came from an ethnically Jewish family, although himself had become a Christian.

- 2.13** He could not have run into a worse mentor at that point than Bauer. So Karl Marx becomes Bauer's protégé. They do a lot together, to the point where, in 1841, they even launch a journal together, that they tried to launch together, called the Annals of Atheism. It didn't last very long. Apparently, it needed money to be kept afloat. They couldn't find, apparently, a rich enough atheist socialist who could give them some money for it. But he and Bauer palled around together. Among other things, they mocked religion together.
- 2.14** In one case, a local village that is known for recognizing Palm Sunday, because different villages had different kind of charisms and different things that people had mentioned before, that Trier had the Holy Coat, and people had a pilgrimage for that. Marx and Bruno Bauer together ride into the village on Palm Sunday on donkeys, mocking the entrance of Christ into Jerusalem on Palm Sunday. They would go into churches together and make loud noises, cough, sneer, mock.
- 2.15** So he's taking a dark turn here on religion very quickly, breaking away from the influences of his father, who died in 1838, and now going to this new—I don't think it would be fair to call Bauer a fatherly figure, but he was very close to him, and again, a mentor. Bauer becomes—George Jung would write this: "If Marx, Bruno Bauer, and Feuerbach," Feuerbach was a German philosopher who also influenced Marx, "come together to found a theological-philosophical review, God would do well to surround himself with all his angels and indulge in self-pity, for they will certainly drive him out of his heaven." "They will certainly drive him out of his heaven."
- 2.16** Marx spends a lot of time with Bauer, eventually departs, splits from Bauer. He's going to review Bauer's book on the Jewish question, which I'll talk about in a minute. But a profoundly important essay that Marx wrote for understanding Marx is his 1844 essay called "A Contribution to the Critique of Hegel's Philosophy of Right," which is known as simply, you guys know it, the "opiate of the masses" essay. It's got this long, clunky title, "Contribution to the Critique of Hegel's Philosophy of Right."
- 2.17** So many of these things I should note. There's a very good website called marxists.org, which you guys are probably thinking, "Paul Kengor is recommending a website called marxists.org?" It's run by a Marxist scholar who is a very honest individual, does a great job of putting everything up on the website. So many of these essays and what I'm quoting from, a lot of the essays that I quote, the translations are from marxists.org, because different translations will have obviously different verbiage with some of these.

- 2.18** But the "opiate of the masses" essay. So Karl Marx had said, "Communism begins where atheism begins." "Communism begins where atheism begins." So people who will say, "A Christian can be a Communist. There's a lot of—Acts 4:32, 4:35, they talk about sharing." Marx, and certainly Lenin and the Bolsheviks and Bukharin, and I'll talk about all of this later, they'd say, "No, communism begins where atheism begins." This is a complete worldview change, a revolutionary worldview change.
- 2.19** But Marx, in his 1844 essay, "opiate of the masses," that is the famous line: "Religion is the opium of the people, the opiate of the masses." Everyone remembers that phrase. Here's the full quote, which we'll put up on the screen. "Man makes religion, religion does not make man." Now, think about that. You're going to see this in Mikhail Bakunin as well. "The state and the society produce religion, which is an inverted consciousness of the world, because they are an inverted world. The struggle—" Think about this Marx statement.
- 2.20** "The struggle against religion is, therefore, indirectly the struggle against that world whose spiritual aroma is religion. Religious suffering is, at one and the same time, the expression of real suffering and a protest against real suffering." There's a lot in there to unpack, beginning with that line, "Man makes religion, religion does not make man." Now, here comes the money line. Remember the full phrase. "Religion is the sigh of the oppressed creature. It is the heart of a heartless world, the soul of soulless conditions. It is the opium of the people." "The opium of the people."
- 2.21** I've heard people say, "When Marx talks about religion as the opium of the people, opium of the masses, I get that. Even if you're a believer, it's a crutch to lean on. The believer believes that it's a real crutch. There's really a God, but it's a pacifier in a good sense. I know Marx probably means it in a more negative sense. That's all he really means there." No, you've got to read the whole thing, backing up to "man makes religion." That full line, again, "Religion is the sigh of the oppressed creature, the heart of a heartless world, the soul of soulless conditions. It is the opium of the people." That's a very negative view of religion.
- 2.22** We're going through this course chronologically. You have to go through that way to see how Marx develops or declines or deteriorates or descends. So that's 1844 that he wrote that, three years after the Annals of Atheism journal with Bruno Bauer. The same essay, 1844. Marx said, "The criticism of religion disillusion man, so that he will think, act, and fashion his reality like a man who has discarded his illusions and regained his senses."
- 2.23** So think about this. "So that he will move around himself as his own true sun." So revolve around yourself as your own true sun. The orbit, the universe, is yours. "Religion is only the illusory sun, which revolves around man as long as he does not revolve around himself." It's a statement of relativism, of defining yourself as the center of the world, as the center of existence. It's relative to you, not to an absolute ruler, not to the God in heaven that you revolve around. "He will move around himself

as his own true sun. Religion is only the illusory sun, which revolves around man as long as he does not revolve around himself."

- 2.24** It's interesting in this essay, the opiate of the masses essay, that Marx talks about Martin Luther and commends Martin Luther. At that point, you would think, well, why would he like Luther? Luther is the head of the Reformation. Luther is obviously a devout Christian. But what he likes about Luther is one peculiar, specific thing. As he put it, Luther, "overcame bondage," particularly from Rome. And the quote is, "On the eve of the Reformation, official Germany was the most unconditional slave of Rome," He put it.
- 2.25** So just as Luther makes a crucial break from the church of Rome, right, Marx and his fellow philosophers are going to make a crucial break in their revolutionary emancipation. So the key to break away from Rome—and whether you're Catholic or Protestant on this, I'm very careful in the book to say I'm not in any way insulting even Luther on this—what's crucial for Marx is, for 1,500 years, from the first century until the Reformation in 1517, the church was the authority—church, tradition, Rome. Luther provides that break from the church where the individual can now come to his or her own interpretation, doesn't need the church of Rome.
- 2.26** Now, Luther would not in any way approve of where Marx is going, but for Marx, it's like, "Oh, that's good. Because if we could just break away from Rome, that's a big start. Now we're in a way of not having to listen to them and their interpretation. Now we can listen to our own interpretation at that part." So, Marx stated then, and here's one of the most famous lines in all of Marx's writings. Marx was great for these different revolutionary catchphrases.
- 2.27** "As the revolution then began in the brain of the monk, so now it begins in the brain of the philosopher." So in a way, the monk is Luther. Luther was an Augustinian monk. So he breaks away with the revolution, with the Reformation. That was just a starting point. Now it can be picked up in the mind of the philosopher, with Marx. Now we can go away. That was a crucial break from the church that was necessary.
- 2.28** Marx—and you will see this, I'm going to quote this stuff over and over and over again in this series—Marx said also in that essay, "The criticism of religion is the beginning of all criticism." He uses the word "criticize" or "criticism" altogether in that essay 29 times. "The criticism of religion is the beginning of all criticism." Really, a pretty profound point if you think about it. The way to start is to go after religion, after God, because if that's your whole worldview, that we're made in the image of God, the "imago Dei," if your whole worldview is a Christian worldview, and Marx has something else completely different in mind, you have to begin with that. The Christian religion has to be the beginning of all of your criticism.
- 2.29** Marx wrote an 1843 letter to Arnold Ruge, where he called for "the ruthless criticism of all that exists." "The ruthless criticism of all that exists." Here we go again with that

phrase: "All." "The ruthless criticism of all that exists;" everything that exists deserves to perish. Marx said this about Christianity. A lot of people don't know what Marx actually said about Christianity; they just think of opium of the masses and so forth. But Marx wrote, "The social principles of Christianity preach cowardice, self-contempt, abasement, submission, and humility. The social principles of Christianity are hypocritical."

- 2.30** Now, indeed, the principles of Christianity do preach submission and humility, but the Christian would think that that's a good thing. You submit to a higher authority beyond yourself. You humble yourself. As Paul wrote, "Humble yourself to death, even death on a cross." It's a religion of sacrifice. The Christian faith is a sacrifice. The cross is a sacrifice. Christ said, "If you want to follow me, pick up your cross and carry it."
- 2.31** Marx said, "The more of himself that man gives to God, the less he has left in himself." Well, that's true, but the Christian would think that's a good thing. But Marx is thinking, "No, the more that you give to God, the less you have of yourself." But the Christian believes you give yourself fully to God in order to serve God. George Jung, who's a Marx contemporary and close friend, who I quoted just a few minutes ago, said that, "Marx calls Christianity one of the most immoral religions." Wait till you hear what he said about Judaism. That'll come in a few minutes.
- 2.32** Marx put his faith instead in evolution, evolution, all the way to death, all the way to death. In fact, Engels said that what Marx was doing—so Marx set up this evolutionary system where communism would go from slavery to feudalism to capitalism to socialism to communism. That's the evolutionary dialectic. So just as Darwin had conceived of an origin of species biologically, of Homo sapiens, of human beings, advancing from lower life forms all the way up into more advanced life forms, Marx believed, Engels believed, they argued that what Marx was doing for the social sciences is what Darwin had done for the hard sciences. So Marx is creating this new evolutionary development in the social sciences, in economic thought, in his dialectic.
- 2.33** At his funeral, Marx's coffin bore not a cross, but two red wreaths. And Engels, who gave the eulogy at both Marx's funeral and Marx's wife Jenny's funeral, invoked not God, but Darwin. Likewise for Jenny's funeral, he said this at Jenny's funeral. This is Engels. "The place where we stand is the best proof that she lived and died in the full conviction of atheist materialism. She knew that one day she would have to return, body and mind, to the bosom of that nature from which she had sprung."
- 2.34** Not very edifying, by the way. Here lies the vivacious Jenny, who now is just food for the worms, who's going to rot in this box and turn to dust. Nothing uplifting in that moment, like, "Children, you will see your mother again in all her glory, dancing with the angels." Nothing like that at all. This is a strictly atheist, materialist, their view of Darwinian evolution, view of the world, of death.

- 2.35** Leon Trotsky, one of the Troika, if you will—it was Trotsky and Stalin and Lenin who were the crucial three founders of the Bolshevik state— he likewise placed his faith in Darwin, and he said this, "Darwin destroyed the last of my ideological prejudices. The idea of evolution and determinism took possession of me completely. Darwin stood for me like a mighty doorkeeper at the entrance to the temple of the universe. I was intoxicated with his thought." So that becomes their guidepost, Darwinian evolution.
- 2.36** Now, what I have here next is, I'm going to warn people watching. This is very offensive. I'm always quite reluctant to talk about this in public because it's very racist. The language is really strong, quite vile. I've got to be careful what I say, which words that I say. When I speak in an audience with black people in the room, I often say I can't do it; I'm just going to skip it, not even say it, because it's just so offensive, the language that I use. But Marx and Engels both were evolutionists and racists, and their evolution views helped inform their racial views and vice versa.
- 2.37** Marx believed not that human beings were made in the imago Dei, but that they evolved from apes. He and Engels both looked at black people as being lower on the evolutionary scale than white people. This was their version of their Darwinian worldview. Marx's son-in-law, Paul Lafargue, who was married to his daughter, Laura— by the way, Marx had two daughters who committed suicide, in suicide pacts with their husbands.
- 2.38** In fact, the one daughter, her husband, Edward Aveling, who was a scoundrel, a socialist, never worked, just a money-grubber, begged money from people, he entered into a suicide pact with Marx's daughter, helped Marx's daughter consummate her part of the deal, and then he didn't go through with it. And people felt that Aveling should have been charged with murder for that. But Marx had two daughters who committed suicide in suicide pacts that they had made with their husbands. Paul Lafargue is one of them.
- 2.39** By the way, when Paul and Laura committed suicide, Paul left behind a letter saying, basically, "I'm 70 years old. This is a good time to stop life. I've stopped being productive." Even Lenin was like, "But why would they do this? They had more to give and more to do." But they just had this really dark, materialistic view of life. So Marx's son-in-law, Paul Lafargue, is the one that Marx wrote to, and said that, if he had to do life over again, he would not have gotten married. Maybe he was trying to talk the future son-in-law out of taking his daughter's hand.
- 2.40** Paul was partly Cuban. So in Marx's view, this meant that Paul had N-word blood in his veins. And if you go through some of these letters between Marx and Engels, it jumps out. They're writing in German, and then you see the American racial epithet for a black person, N-I-G-G-E— it's like, whoa, what's up with that? They're not even using the German word for black or what would be, like, maybe Negro. They're actually using the N-word. It's shocking. He was partly Cuban. So Marx and Engels tried to deduce with

scientific accuracy how much N-word blood was in his veins. Marx referred to Paul Lafargue as "Negrillo" or the gorilla, the gorilla.

- 2.41** Nathaniel Weyl wrote this. Nathaniel Weyl wrote an excellent book, one of the only books on Marx and the Jewish question and race. Nathaniel Weyl had been a Communist himself. He was an ex-communist when he wrote this book. "Consider the frequency with which Marx used the term N-I-G-G-E—in his correspondence with Engels instead of the emotionally neutral German word," and then he used N-E-G-E-R, or that Engels regarded N-word and idiot as synonyms. Since they wrote to each other in German, this meant inserting the offensive English word instead of using the correct German word." And for the record, Marx's wife Jenny used that word as well.
- 2.42** Weyl wrote, "Publicly and for political reasons, both Marx and Engels posed as friends of the Negroes. In private, they were anti-black racists of the most odious sort." I find this remarkable, too, because the founder of Black Lives Matter, Patrisse Cullors, who in her memoir opens up with a quote from Marx, a foreword by Angela Davis, the most famous female Marxist in America, Patrisse Cullors said, "Alicia and I," so the founders of Black Lives Matter were Patrisse Cullors and Alicia Garza, "Alicia and I are trained Marxists. We are super-versed on ideological theories."
- 2.43** If she only knew what a racist Marx was, I don't think she would call herself a Marxist. But frankly, to be fair, probably doesn't know any of this. They don't learn this stuff in school, the people who become Marxists in American universities. I did this presentation at a major college in Pennsylvania, where the tuition is over \$60,000 a year. I had two students who came up to me at the end of the class and said, "We've never heard any of that before. We took a course here on Marxism."
- 2.44** The Communist Manifesto. They didn't even read The Communist Manifesto in class. I said, "What did you read?" They said, "We read articles about Marxism by people who were sympathetic to Marxism." But in an era when people are being canceled, if they ever used a word like that at any point, at any time in history, Marx's writings are littered with it, and he gets away with it. It kind of reminds me of Margaret Sanger, the founder of Planned Parenthood, and her support of a Negro project and her really offensive stuff on race improvement. But they get away with it because the people on their side like their ideas. They don't cancel them.
- 2.45** Marx, referring to Ferdinand Lassalle in a July 1862 letter to Engels, Marx said this with a kind of confident pride, "It is now perfectly clear to me that, as the shape of his head and the growth of his hair indicates, he is descended from the Negroes." Lassalle's cranial formation, as Marx put it, was the giveaway. "Unless his mother or grandmother on the father's side was crossed with a N-I-G-G-E". Marx flung around the N-word. His writing is littered with epithets like "greasy Jew," again, I apologize for the language, "little kike," "water Polak Jew," "Jew-Bron," and the Jewish N-word.

- 2.46 Engels, on Marx's son-in-law, Paul Lafargue, Engels, of course, being a proud Darwinian, deduced with scientific accuracy, in his view, that Lafargue possessed "one-eighth or one-twelfth N-word blood." In 1887, Lafargue was a political candidate for a council seat in a Paris district that contained a zoo. So in an April 1887 letter to Paul's wife Laura, Engels, Marx's partner, wrote this. "Being in his quality as a N-word, that is a degree nearer to the rest of the animal kingdom than the rest of us, he's undoubtedly the most appropriate representative of that district." I guess he thought that was really funny. As I said, Paul committed suicide in a suicide pact with Marx's daughter. Very offensive stuff.
- 2.47 Marx was not only prejudiced against black people, but against Jews. And this is really weird because, again, the guy was ethnically Jewish, came from a long line of Jewish people who practiced Judaism. Marx's famous essay on this is his 1844 essay called "On the Jewish Question." It's actually a review of a book, "On the Jewish Question," by his mentor, anti-Semitic mentor, Bruno Bauer. What Marx says here is pretty remarkable.
- 2.48 "What is the worldly religion of the Jew? Huckstering. What is the worldly God? Money." Huckstering, money, that's what the Jew is all about. Marx is writing this. Marx is writing this. Conservative Jews will point to Karl Marx as a self-hating Jew, which he really was. My good friend Mark Levin says that a lot. Ben Shapiro has said that a lot. Michael Medved, Dennis Prager. Marx wrote, "Money is the jealous god of Israel, before whom no other god may exist. The bill of exchange is the actual god of the Jew." Wow. It's a Jewish guy writing that.
- 2.49 He said that the Jew had become impossible. "The emancipation of the Jews in the final analysis is the emancipation of society from Judaism." Marx said, "The Israelite faith is repulsive to me." Shocking. Shocking. I've written at least eight biographies of Ronald Reagan. I'm doing a biography of—I'm doing a major book on Ronald Reagan, on the subject of race. Reagan made one comment to Richard Nixon in a phone call in 1972 that's being interpreted in the worst possible way by people on the left. And I go at a great length to put all this into context and explain.
- 2.50 But they're renaming buildings because of this one comment, buildings that have been named after Reagan. I mean, if Ronald Reagan had all of these quotes in his background or somebody like a Donald Trump, they'd be canceled for good. But Marx has gotten away with all of this, because the people who are Marxists or like Marx, like his ideas, so they cover this stuff up. They don't talk about it. And people like the founder of Black Lives Matter, who calls herself a Marxist, she probably has no idea that Marx said any of this. No idea. I'll concede, she's probably completely innocent. And if she watched this right now, she'd probably be shocked. I hope, I would think.
- 2.51 Marx instead put his faith in communism. And you'll see this, that they end up, and their disciples and followers end up, treating The Communist Manifesto like their Bible and treating communism itself as almost like a kind of faith, a utopian faith. As Ronald Reagan put it, "Well, Marxism, Leninism, that religion of theirs." They treat it like a

religion. Marx said this about communism. He wrote this in his German Ideology, 1845, so this would be one year after "On the Jewish Question," 1844. This follows the opiate of the masses essay. This is still three years, or two or three years now before The Communist Manifesto is published. Marx said this.

- 2.52** "In a Communist society, where no one has exclusive sphere of activity, but each can become accomplished in any branch he wishes," and here's the magical formula for them, "society regulates the general production." This is like the key to the universe. "Society regulates the general production," like the magic wand; if we could just do that, here's what can follow, "thus making it possible for me to do one thing today and another tomorrow—to hunt in the morning, fish in the afternoon, rear cattle in the evening, criticize after dinner." We all know that Marx loved to criticize; it was his favorite thing to do. "Just as I have a mind, without ever becoming hunter, fisherman, herdsman, or critic." Communism would bring a kind of heaven on Earth.
- 2.53** Marx was an disciple of Mikhail Bakunin. And so I alluded to Bakunin in the first lecture. It's time we take a close look at this guy because this, I think, helps to unlock a lot of how we should interpret Marx's stuff about Satan and the devil and rebellion. Of course, we'll let Bakunin here speak for himself, but you see a lot of this influencing Marx and a lot of Bakunin's thinking and Marx's thinking as well.
- 2.54** Bakunin lived from 1814 to '76. He was a Russian atheist. Marx, of course, was German. And he was a revolutionary socialist anarchist. You guys at this point, you'd be like, "A socialist anarchist?" Marx even said, "I don't understand. How could you be a socialist but an anarchist?" Basically, for big, massive government, but no governments. Even Marx was a little bit confused by this one. It's like, touché, Marx.
- 2.55** Marx and Bakunin first met in Paris in the early 1840s, and they hit it off, just as Marx and Engels met in Paris in the 1840s. But later on, they would split, and Marx would heap insults at him, like he would with everyone. Bakunin wrote, "We saw each other often, for I greatly respected him for his learning and for his passionate and serious devotion to the cause of the proletariat. I eagerly sought his conversation." But eventually they split. And what does Marx do? With everybody that he disagrees with, he ends up calling him vile names. Marx flung his usual vitriol at Bakunin, and Bakunin denounced "Marx's habitual weapon, a heap of filth."
- 2.56** So, Bakunin's magnum opus was called God and the State, 1871. God and the State, 1871. He wrote in there—does this sound familiar, ladies and gentlemen?—"if God really existed." Remember what Marx said, "Man makes religion," right? "If God really existed, it would be necessary to abolish him." Wow. What did Dostoevsky say? "If God does not exist, everything is permissible." That's right. If God doesn't exist, everything is permissible, which is why you need God to exist, so you have guidelines and guideposts. You know what's permissible and what's not.

- 2.57** But these guys don't want those guides and those guideposts. They want to reinvent the whole thing, make themselves the sun of which they revolve around. So if God really existed, you'd have to abolish him. They don't want him. "All religions are cruel," wrote Bakunin, "all founded on blood." Well, of course, that's the Old Testament to the New Testament. To quote Augustine, "The old is revealed in the new, the new is concealed in the old." It's the old covenant, the new covenant. Passover, blood will be put above the doorstep so death will pass over. Christ, of course, is a sacrifice of blood on the cross.
- 2.58** Bakunin hailed Satan in this book as, here we go, "the eternal rebel, the first free thinker and the emancipator of worlds." This glorious rebel view of Satan. As I said, this is not unusual among radical socialists. Saul Alinsky, in his book *Rules for Radicals*, in the beginning, gave an acknowledgement to Satan as "the very first radical who rebelled against the establishment and won himself his own kingdom."
- 2.59** Much more here. Bakunin said this about Satan, preferring Satan over God. "Jehovah, who of all the good gods adored by men was certainly the most jealous, the most vain, the most ferocious, the most unjust, the most bloodthirsty, the most despotic, and the most hostile to human dignity and liberty." I would pause here and say to Bakunin, "Hey, dude, I hope you're right for your sake that God doesn't exist, because you're going to be in big trouble someday. You're really laying it out here, dude." But I guess he's pretty confident there's not going to be any eternal punishment for this view. I mean, look at that.
- 2.60** "Jehovah, who of all the good gods adored by men was certainly the most jealous, the most vain, the most ferocious, the most unjust, the most bloodthirsty, the most despotic." Yeah, I talked to Jordan Peterson about this. He said, "Oh, yeah, to these people, God is a despot. He's a tyrant. He's shackling you. He's telling you what to do all the time." For you to have true freedom and liberation and emancipation, you have to break away from that, like Satan, the fallen angel. You create your own kingdom. But as Christ said, this actually liberates us; Christ liberates us from the bondage of sin. And you need rules as guideposts. You don't want a system where you make completely your own rules.
- 2.61** Pick up with Bakunin. "Jehovah had just created," this is his narrative of the creation, his take on Genesis, "Jehovah had just created Adam and Eve, to satisfy we know not what caprice." We know not what whim that God did this for. Well, he actually gives us some speculation. "No doubt to while away his time, which must weigh heavy on his hands in his eternal egoistic solitude, or that he might have some new slaves." That's the reason God created you, right? To have some slaves.
- 2.62** C. S. Lewis in *Mere Christianity* has a great discussion about free will. And he says, "We don't know why God gave it to us, but apparently he didn't want a world of people who are just puppets on a string, that he could just tug around all day and play with all day." Chesterton did a whole play on this. You're just being controlled. Now, does granting

human beings free will lead to things that they do that displease God? Yeah, like people like Bakunin. He's got the free will to write this if he wants. But as Lewis said in Mere Christianity, apparently God felt that it was worth it.

- 2.63** Look at the parable of the Good Samaritan. The Good Samaritan chooses to do good. He chooses to help the wounded traveler on the road to Jericho, to pay the guy at the end. He could have just done nothing, or God could have made him a puppet on a string and do all those things. But he does something instead that pleases God through his own free will. But free will can be abused for ill, as well.
- 2.64** So Bakunin, "so that he might have some new slaves. He," this being Jehovah, "wished, therefore, that man, destitute of all understanding of himself, should remain an eternal beast, ever on all-fours before the eternal God, his creator and his master. But here," ta-da, "but here steps in Satan." And Bakunin is setting this up as good. "The eternal rebel, the first free thinker, and the emancipator of worlds. He makes man ashamed of his bestial ignorance and obedience; he emancipates him." Oh, man, I'll tell you, that's some heavy stuff there, is it not? But Bakunin, an associate of Marx, influenced Marx and vice versa, and they eventually split. They don't split over religion; that's not the issue of their split.
- 2.65** Disciples of Marx, Lenin, and Bukharin. I'll get— Bukharin is different from Bakunin—I'll hit this again later on, too. But for right now, I want to get some of these thoughts in your mind. So Marxism eventually becomes Marxism-Leninism, because the first real full-blown Marxist state is in the Soviet Union, Bolshevik Russia, October-November, 1917. That's when you get the first true Communist state. Lenin sees himself as the primary interpreter of Marx, of Marxism. So it becomes known as Marxism-Leninism.
- 2.66** And Lenin and his cadre, his followers, Lenin and Trotsky, Lenin and Stalin, and also Nikolai Bukharin. No, not Mikhail Bakunin, but Nikolai Bukharin. Bukharin was one of the first editors of Pravda. These guys follow the views of Marx and others on religion very carefully. Lenin would say this about religion. "All worship of a divinity is a necrophilia." All worship of a divinity is a necrophilia. You all know what that is, right? Google that. Love of the dead in its worst form. Sex with a corpse. "All worship of a divinity is a necrophilia."
- 2.67** Lenin had been a Christian in his youth, and like Marx, followed a similar path where he rejected it. Lenin said, "I broke with all religion as a teen. I tore off my cross from my neck, and I tossed it in the rubbish bin." "Broke with all religion as a teen. I tore off the cross from my neck and tossed it in the rubbish bin." Enough. Done with it. Why? Because, as Lenin said, "There is nothing more abominable than religion." "Nothing more abominable than religion." That's quite a statement.
- 2.68** If I was sitting around creating a list of the most abominable things, to think that, of all the things in the world, he said that is the most abominable, religion, of all things, praise God, me as an American, that there's nothing like this from the American

Founding Fathers. Jefferson had some weird beliefs, but Jefferson said, "We are endowed by our creator with certain unalienable rights—life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness." You at least acknowledge a creator. Washington, "It's substantially true that morality and religion are indispensable supports." John Adams, "The religion of the United States was made for a moral and religious people. It was wholly inadequate for the governance of any other type."

- 2.69** So, the founders had this respectful view of religion. They thought that religion was good for people. But these guys, "there is nothing more abominable than religion. All worship of a divinity is a necrophilia." So Lenin and Trotsky create something called the League of the Militant Godless. They go, and they banish churches. There are 657 churches operating in Moscow on the eve of the Revolution in 1917. According to official Soviet statistics, they were down to 46 by the 1980s. That's in W. Bruce Lincoln's book. Astonishing. They got rid of religion. They purged religion.
- 2.70** Where are they getting these ideas from? They're getting them from Marx and the others. Lenin, quoting Marx, like Marx said, "Religion is the opiate of the masses. It's a kind of spiritual booze." "Spiritual booze." Not just the opium of the masses. Lenin called it "medieval mildew." So Nikolai Bukharin, founding editor and chief of Pravda, for those of you who run into sister social justice or pastor social justice, he says, "You know, Christians could take some good lessons from communism. Marx said, 'From each according to his ability, to each according to his needs.' Well, that's Acts 4:32 and 4:35 right there."
- 2.71** No, that's not what the communists believe. To quote Bukharin, "A fight to the death must be declared upon religion. Religion must be taken on at the tip of the bayonet." Why, said Bukharin? "Because religion and communism are incompatible, both theoretically and practically. Communism is incompatible with religious faith." Incompatible. Acts 4:32-4:35, you guys know that, right? That's where it says, "And the community of believers came together, and they held all things in common. They brought forward proceeds from the sale of their property, and they shared among one another."
- 2.72** You'll get these muddle-headed Christians, they'll be like, "Oh, well, that sounds like communism." No. By the way, it was even Pope Francis, who wasn't good on communism, he said, "No, that's pure Christianity. That's not communism." That's from the first-century disciples. Those are people coming together, deciding to live in community, by the way, who believe in God and aren't trying to abolish religion, and agreeing on their own.
- 2.73** And they have private property. Communism calls for the abolition of private property. And they bring some of it forward and they sell it, and they agree voluntarily to share it, to help one another. And if you read on further, Acts 4:32 and 4:35, they just sell a portion of their property. They still have private property, and they have other property that they could sell as well. Communism isn't that.

- 2.74** Communism, which comes 1,800 years later, is, you get one central government in Moscow or whatever, which forcibly abolishes private property among everybody, the willing and the unwilling, abolishes their religion and closes down their churches, enforces everybody against their will, taking their property away, their right of inheritance and everything else. Not even to share their stuff, but forcibly redistributes it. That's nothing like what's happening in the Acts of the Apostles at all.
- 2.75** We run into this all the time with people that are like, "Oh, so Jesus talked about love, and communists want to help their neighbor. Jesus talked about loving your neighbor. Well, they're like communists." No, that's insane. That's taking massive leaps in logic there. We've got about five minutes left. I'm going to sum up here, then we can maybe even take some questions.
- 2.76** Leon Trotsky. So Trotsky, the aforementioned, he and Lenin launched the League of the Militant Godless. Trotsky said this, and here you have Trotsky speaking about Marxism as—here, I'll quote him directly. So if you arrive at this kingdom of Marxism, of atheistic Marxism communism, said Trotsky, "Man will at last begin to harmonize himself in earnest. The human species, the sluggish Homo sapiens, will once again enter the state of radical reconstruction and become in his own hands the object of the most complex methods of artificial selection and psychophysical training."
- 2.77** I mean, this is just amazing what Marxism can do. This is beyond like a Saul on the road to Damascus conversion, right? Look at what this can do for you. "Man will make it his goal to create a higher sociobiological type, a superman, if you will. Man will become incomparably stronger, wiser, more subtle. His body will become more harmonious, his movements more rhythmic, his voice more melodious. The average human type will rise to the heights of an Aristotle, a Goethe, a Marx. And beyond this ridge, other peaks will emerge."
- 2.78** This is, to quote from Benedict XVI, "The New Jerusalem will be realized." If you simply let these guys redistribute your wealth, abolish your private property, abolish all of this other stuff, then you will have heaven on earth. There's like an eschatology, an end times here. Although the problem with this is that it's done in a strictly materialistic, economic sense. We are not strictly material beings.
- 2.79** To quote Ronald Reagan in the "Time for Choosing" speech, October 27, 1964, "It's times like this that we realize that we're spirits, not animals, and that there's something going on in space and time, and beyond space and time, which, whether we like it or not, spells duty." So we are immaterial and material. We have a soul. There's more to us than just the body. The problem with the Marxists, the communists, is they really believe that man lives on bread alone. So, if you could solve the economic problem, the employment problem.
- 2.80** But as Augustine said, what we have is a God-shaped vacuum in each of us. We don't have a dollar-shaped vacuum in each of us. As Jesus told Satan, "Man does not live by

bread alone, but by every word from the mouth of God." But these people thought, "No, get God out of here, take it down, do this communism thing, and you're going to have this kind of heaven on Earth." New peaks will emerge, an altogether new sociobiological type. Ronald Reagan said, again, "Well, communism, that religion of theirs, Marxism-Leninism." Can I do my Reagan imitation? "Well, Marxism-Leninism, that religion of theirs."

- 2.81** Another example of the utopian thinking, and I'll finish up with this and then take your questions. Arthur Koestler, who wrote the book *Darkness at Noon*, and is also in the book, *The God That Failed*, which looks at about a half a dozen different former communists who left the faith and became anti-communists, he talked, too, about the faith that is found for the convert to communism. And listen to this. Listen to this.
- 2.82** "To say that one has 'seen the light' is a poor description of the mental rapture which only the convert knows." This is the convert to communism. "The new light seems to pour from all directions across the skull. The whole universe falls into a pattern, like the stray pieces of a jigsaw puzzle assembled by magic at one stroke. There is now an answer to every question. Doubts and conflicts are a matter of the troubled past. Nothing henceforth can disturb the convert's inner peace and serenity, except the occasional fear of losing the faith again. Losing thereby what alone makes life worth living and falling back into the outer darkness."
- 2.83** Again, even Saul on the road to Damascus, during—"Saul!" "Who are you, sir?" "Why do you persecute me, Saul?" He goes in. The scales eventually come from his eyes, eventually figures it all out. But no, man, this is you. All the light comes in, the convert to the skull, every piece of the jigsaw, the universe comes into being. This alone makes life worth living. Raymond Aron, in his anti-communist book called *Marxism: The Opium of the Intellectuals*, *The Opium of the Intellectuals*, sounds like these guys are smoking a little opium of their own.
- 2.84** This worship of Satan as a rebel, it seems like a really deep individualism. I'm wondering, was Marx's collectivism really kept purely to the economic side?
- 2.85** Yeah, that's a very interesting point you're making there, especially being that these people are all about the collective and the masses. They want to group everybody into either one of two categories. You'll see this when we talk about *The Communist Manifesto*. You're either in the proletariat or the bourgeoisie. But yet, on the other hand, they're very individualistic, in that you revolve around yourself. And they like Satan as this first free thinker and rebel who, to borrow from Saul Alinsky, wins himself his own kingdom. So here, again, they're just full of all these contradictions that don't really seem to make sense.
- 2.86** I would add, too, that another—I didn't say this when I talked about Marx referring to, "What is the worldly cult of the Jew? Haggling. What is the worldly god of the Jew? Money." Actually, the worldly god of Marx is money. Of the Marxists, all they care

about is capital. Their entire alpha and omega is based on economics and class. They don't view individuals as made in the imago Dei; they view them as strictly material beings. They're all about economics. If you just solve the economic problem, you'll have the New Jerusalem.

- 2.87** It's interesting, they'll refer to—people ask me, what do I consider myself? Well, I guess a free marketer. I think free markets are generally the best. And the communists would say, "No, you're a capitalist." Well, I'm really not. I don't even think about capital. I don't wake up in the morning and think, "How can I get my hands on some capital today? Where's the capital?" But I generally support a system of free markets.
- 2.88** I actually think government has a role, a responsibility, to help people who are homeless, poor. I'm not against social security. I'm not against welfare for a limited amount of time. People shouldn't be on it for 10 years. But these guys, they're the ones that are all about money. They're the ones that are all about capital. They obsess over it. It's a very common thing among leftists. They'll accuse you of what it is that they're doing.
- 2.89** They'll say, "You hater." It's like, "You're screaming at me. I'm not full of any hate at all at this moment. I'm smiling at you. Do you want to go have a beer? I don't hate you at all." "Yes, you do, you hater." It's like, "Well, you're hating." "No, I'm not. You are." And they'll do the whole diversity and inclusion thing. And at the same time, they're excluding people that they don't agree with, canceling them, keeping them out. So they're always full of these contradictions. Marx and the Marxists were masters of these contradictions.
- 2.90** Do we know if any of Marx's children or other relatives looked up to him and became Marxists or returned to religion at any point in their lives?
- 2.91** Yeah, great question. So two of his daughters, the two oldest daughters are very complicated. And there's a lot of different scholarship on this. Some Marxist historians believe that Marx was a doting father to the daughters and very good to the daughters. Mary Gabriel, Francis Wheen, others, they say that Marx was this very loving father; the daughters loved him. And in fact, a couple of the daughters became socialists and tried to carry on the Marxist torch and married men who were socialists.
- 2.92** On the other hand, the daughters ended up committing suicide. Another biographer, it's just a complete opposite view, Paul Johnson, said that Marx vetoed careers for his daughters completely. At the same time, he did seem to give them—I don't know where he got the money for this, but where and when he could, some forms of private education and music and Latin or whatever else. There's a lot of conflicting scholarship on that.
- 2.93** But I think Marx, by and large, loved his kids and vice versa. Where he failed was putting a roof over their head, providing income, providing food, providing shelter,

providing literal warmth. They had a couple of brutal winters where they couldn't keep the heat on where they were staying. So that's really where he failed.

2.94 And I would say, too, he failed in a way that ought to be the parents' first priority: give them a faith that would carry them through life. Instead, he gave them just the opposite, which left them despondent and depressed to the point where they killed themselves and took their own lives. He left them really not hope, but hopelessness and despair.

Lecture 3: The Communist Manifesto

At a glance — The Communist Manifesto.

- 3.1 Welcome back. We're going to pick up with The Communist Manifesto itself. However, I did want to read one more of these utopian quotes on communism, that religion of theirs. So we heard from Marx talking about how a Communist society is going to produce all these wonderful things. Arthur Koestler with that crazy statement about everything assembled together in one magic stroke.
- 3.2 One more from Moses Hess. Moses Hess, H-E-S-S. He wrote in 1846 something called a Communist Credo, or Credo, which is Latin or Italian for creed. So you have the Apostle's Creed. So he had an actual Communist creed. Well, of course he did. This is an extraordinary statement. It's shorter than the one by Koestler, just one long sentence. "Once we unite and live in communism, hell will no longer be on Earth, and heaven will no longer be beyond this world; everything which has been presented to us by Christianity in prophecy and fantasy is about to be wholly realized in the true human society according to the eternal laws of love and reason."
- 3.3 That's an extraordinary statement. "Once we unite and live in communism, hell will no longer be on Earth and heaven will no longer be beyond this world. Everything presented to us by Christianity in prophecy and fantasy is about to be wholly realized." Just amazement. It really is.
- 3.4 Russell Kirk, the great conservative writer, talked about how the problem with leftist ideologues is that they tend to be utopians, especially he's talking about the French Revolution, the people in that group. The problem is, they think that they can make a heaven on Earth. And he said, "We can't make a heaven on Earth, but we can make a hell of it." We can make a hell of it, if we're trying to get a heaven on Earth. And this is the problem. Worldview comes into this. If you think that there is no heaven up there, but you can make heaven down here, you've got it completely backwards. And you're going to be greatly frustrated, trying to achieve what cannot be achieved.
- 3.5 Utopia, the Greek word for utopia is "ou topos," which actually means no place. So utopia is something that cannot be had in this world. You have it in the next world. Peggy Noonan, the Reagan speechwriter, once wrote, "The problem with the current generation of Americans is that they think you can have full happiness and heaven in this lifetime, whereas previous generations realized that happiness only comes in the next world."
- 3.6 I love that, in the Declaration of Independence, Jefferson wrote, "Life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness." By the way, he's borrowing there from a philosophical tradition based on John Locke, which called for—the inalienable rights were, anyone know? Life, liberty, and property. Property, which the communists go after as well. But he didn't

use property, which he didn't have to, because the founders believed in private property, but life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.

- 3.7** I'm sure glad they didn't say "life, liberty, and happiness," because you're not guaranteed happiness. The sooner that you realize you can't have full happiness and heaven on this Earth, guess what? The happier you're going to be. And if you've got these guys who believe this, and they have folks who are saying, "I don't want you to take my private property. I don't want your communism," they're like, "Are you crazy? Look what we're going to provide for you." And in fact, the Soviets would actually put people in lunatic asylums as if they were crazy.
- 3.8** There's a quote from Lenin. "The kulak," who were the wealthy landowning farmers, "the kulak insanely detests Soviet authority." What's wrong with you people? We're taking away your cattle and your land. Yes, but gosh, look at the world we're going to create for you here. Do you not realize we're going to give you full happiness in this world? So that kind of person is in the way and needs to be locked up, carted off to Siberia. And by the way, with no rules, or "thou shalt not kill" or anything like that, maybe even killed, if they're in the way, if they're in the way of creating utopia. Amazing.
- 3.9** So we're going to pick up with The Communist Manifesto. The version that I'm using here is the 1998 Penguin Signet Classics edition, which I highly recommend. So almost every Communist Manifesto that you get is going to have a preface from somebody. This is a preface by Martin Malia, who was wonderful. He was a professor at Cal Berkeley, Harvard, as well as Richard Pipes. I was very close to Richard Pipes, and I could talk a lot about Pipes. I'd get on a rabbit trail about Pipes.
- 3.10** But Malia was—I think Malia was coming from, I think it was probably like a moderate Democrat, somewhere in that area, anti-communist, not somebody who was known to be right-wing or left-wing. But he did the preface, and it's outstanding. It's really very good. And when I use this in my course at Grove City College in Grove City, Pennsylvania, we spend about a week or two just reading through Malia's preface—it's that good—before we get to the actual Manifesto itself.
- 3.11** So this version altogether, this book, about 127 pages altogether. But the actual Manifesto itself starts on page 61 and ends on page 111. So the actual Manifesto is 50 pages long. That's it. When I run into these young people who say, "Oh, Communist Manifesto is a pretty good book if you just read it." "Yeah, really, have you read it?" "Well, I jumped around a little bit. It talks about love and sharing and loving your neighbor." I just look at them and say, "Read it. You can read it in one night. You can read it in two nights. It's not going to take you long. There's no excuse for it." When you actually read it, you'll have an idea of what it truly says.
- 3.12** These polls that you'll see from young people today: 44-42% say that they prefer communism over capitalism. These are polls done by groups like the Victims of

Communism Memorial Foundation. Turning Point USA has done polls like this, Young America's Foundation. And then they ask them to define communism, and they'll say things, "Well, it's about loving your neighbor. It's about sharing. It's about helping the poor." But if they read the book, they'll see it's not about that at all. It's about abolition, abolition, abolition, among other things.

- 3.13** So the authors are, of course, Karl Marx, 1818 to 1883. We've talked a lot about him, first two lectures in this series. And Friedrich Engels, 1820-1895. Engels was born in Germany, the son of a textile manufacturer. It was in 1844, as Malia notes, that Engels met Marx. Now, Engels is coming from a very different environment. His father was a wealthy industrialist. He had money. Engels himself, like Marx, as a young man, had been religious, had been a Christian, and he was pretty passionate about it. In fact, held to the faith longer than Karl Marx did. And you really didn't see this early rejection of the faith in late teen years with Engels, like you did with Marx.
- 3.14** But when Engels actually met Marx, he wrote an extraordinary statement about meeting him. He wrote a poem, of all things, something about poetry and these guys. I quote it in *The Devil and Karl Marx*. I go through, I give two different translations of it, but he describes Marx as this "black man from Trier." And black here means not like a black American, but in this sense, it means dark. It's not referring to skin complexion. He writes this about meeting Marx, about this Marx who's got him, in a way, to borrow it from Heinzen, almost like under this spell of his fixation.
- 3.15** "Who chases after his tracks," that would be Engels' tracks, "with reckless rage? It is a black man from Trier, a remarkable monster. He neither walks nor hops, but springs upon his heels and stretches high his arms into the air in anger, as though his wrath would seize at once the mighty canopy of heaven and tear it to the earth. With clenched and threatening fist, he rages without rest, as though 10,000 devils had him by the hair." Gosh, all the people I've ever met, I don't think I've ever described them like that. That's Engels writing about meeting Marx for the first time.
- 3.16** Here's another translation of it. "Who comes rushing in, impetuous and wild? Dark fellow from Trier, in fury raging, nor walks nor skips but leaps upon his prey. In tearing rage is one who leaps to grasp broad spaces of the sky and drag them down to earth." By the way, that's Marx, man, tearing down the canopy of heaven. Bring it all. It's like Marx's plays, Marx's poems. "Stretching his arms wide open to the heavens, his evil fist is clenched." This is Engels on Marx. "He roars interminably, as though 10,000 devils had him by the hair." Wow. All right. That's pretty shocking.
- 3.17** So that's the Marx that would saunter into Engels' life. And Engels talks about his own struggle to keep the faith, the faith of his youth, the faith that he was brought up with, as he sought to "find my way to God, for whom I shall long with my whole heart." The young Engels wrote some really nice, elegant, touching Christian poetry as a young man. And he earnestly hoped that, "I am not lost." I am not lost. But now here comes

this "dark man from Trier, as if a thousand devils had him by the hair." It's quite a statement. I don't know what you make of that.

- 3.18** So The Communist Manifesto. Here we go, from the text itself. Opening line. "A specter is haunting Europe." How many people know that it begins with that? I'm sure some of you in this room do. But the most common line, if you said to somebody, quote me The Communist Manifesto, they usually begin with a closing line: "Workers of the world, unite." We have a world to win, or something like that. But the opening line is, "A specter is haunting Europe." Here we go again with this specter stuff that Marx wrote about so often.
- 3.19** "All the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise this specter." Exorcise. Not E-X-E-R, like running on the elliptical, like I did at the hotel this morning, but like E-X-O-R, like an exorcism. Now, these phrases, "all the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise a specter," the holy alliance was conceived following the Congress of Vienna in 1815. That was the age of Metternich. The age of Metternich was 1815 to 1848, Klemens von Metternich, the Austrian prince.
- 3.20** It was the age; this was the old powers of Europe, the ancien régime getting back together, to try to restore order after Napoleon had run roughshod over Europe at that point. They get together, the Congress of Vienna, from leaders of Bourbon, France, of Britain, of Austria. Also, there is Tsar Alexander of Russia. Russia is one of the most religious countries in the world, Russian Orthodox Church. The communists always take the most religious countries. Probably the most religious country in the Western hemisphere, other than the United States, in the 20th century was Cuba. Extremely religious, and they went there and just destroyed the place.
- 3.21** Thomas Merton in The Seven Storey Mountain talks about having broken away from communism at Columbia University, getting ready to go into the monastery in Getsemani in Kentucky, and he's going to go in there. He's going to become a cloistered monk. But he's got one last pilgrimage he can make. Where should he go? Where should he go? Should it be Rome? Should it be the Holy Land? Well, no, it should be Cuba. Rich, wonderful Cuba, where at every corner I could walk to a church and receive communion five, six times in a day. That's where Castro went in and destroyed the place.
- 3.22** Pol Pot's Cambodia. Eighty thousand Buddhist monks existed there in 1975. By the time that Pol Pot and the group was done, 1978-79, they forced the monks to either renounce their vows or get married or be executed. By the time they were done, they went from 80,000 monks to 4,000. So they always go after—the communists—these religious countries. So the holy alliance was Tsar Alexander of very religious Russia. Even the final Tsar, Nicholas II, the Tsarina, who the Bolsheviks overthrew in 1917, 1918, very religious, very religious individuals.

- 3.23** So Tsar Alexander I has this idea at the Congress of Vienna. He says, "I know how we can get nations back together and keep them from warring with one another. Let's sign a statement. Let's make a holy alliance, that the countries will incorporate the principles of Christianity into their conduct with one another. That'll keep people from fighting." That's how religious Russia was. So that reference here, which is not an uppercase H-A for holy alliance, but lowercase, "All the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise the specter."
- 3.24** Then they name who these powers are: Pope and Tsar— those are the first two that get singled out—Metternich and Guizot, French radicals and German police spies. It's actually German police spies that are spying on Marx. They're going into the house. Some of the reports that we have on Marx and his disorder and uncleanness is from Prussian police reports who went into the house, the apartment, because they were trying—people knew what these Marxists, these communists, were up to.
- 3.25** Everyone knew, by the time this was published in 1848, how radical these people were. They're really going to know after they publish their Manifesto. But everyone's already on to them because nobody's calling for ideas this crazy, this radical. So they're spying on Marx. One of the Prussian police reports says, "The house is so disorderly. There are empty bottles everywhere, emptied-out pipe here, tables missing a leg. To sit on a chair in the Marx household is a dangerous exercise, a dangerous affair for it can break out from under you."
- 3.26** Marx is just laying there on his butt all the time, on his carbuncles, his boils. Paul Johnson said the boils were at their worst when he was writing *Das Kapital*. He had boils on his backside, on his private parts, which, when they would flame up, would put him into fits of boiling rage. Johnson makes the point, it's like, "We often don't think enough about this, but *Das Kapital* is really this kind of angry, oozing work."
- 3.27** He's writing it, Marx, when his boils are at their very worst. The guy was miserable while he was writing that book. Maybe that's why it seems like a miserable book. Marx wrote a letter to Engels where he said, "I've got one boil between my upper lip and my nose. It really hurts. It's as if the devil has been throwing S-H-I-T, excrement, at me." Maybe it was, I don't know, by that point. And they're trying to figure out what's causing all these. Well, it's because Marx wouldn't bathe. I mean, that's what's going on. Anyway, I digress.
- 3.28** So, "all the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise the specter. Pope and Tsar, Metternich and Guizot, French radicals and German police spies." So I told you about the Tsar. The Pope—this is really key—the Pope at the time was Pope Pius IX. So he started his papacy in 1846. The Communist Manifesto was published in February 1848. So his papacy would go from 1846 to 1878, the longest-serving Pope in the history of the Church, other than Peter. Catholics consider Peter the first Pope.

- 3.29** By the way, he's followed by Pope Leo XIII, 1878 to 1903. But in 1846, one of his first encyclicals, published in November 1846, was called *Qui Pluribus*. The first time I read this, as I told you all in the beginning of this class, that I was a graduate student studying these things. By the way, speaking of faith, I was agnostic, if not atheist, and so this atheistic stuff and the irreligion and anti-religion really struck me. It was something I couldn't ignore.
- 3.30** And when I read the church encyclicals, I thought, "Wow, these guys nailed it. How did they figure this out?" But 1846, *Qui Pluribus*, two years before *The Communist Manifesto* was even published, described communism as a "dark design of men in the clothing of sheep, while inwardly ravening wolves." That's an extraordinary statement. "A dark design of men in the clothing of sheep, while inwardly ravening wolves."
- 3.31** Do you guys know what the Fabian Society is? The Fabians are the British socialists that were around at the turn of the last century. And George Bernard Shaw— who else? Famous Brits. Why can't I think of the name of the guy, the playwright, the big writer? But the Fabians believed in socialism, common ownership of the means of production, through a series more of evolution rather than revolution. They wanted to go slower.
- 3.32** If you look at the coat of arms of the Fabians—look it up online, folks— it's a wolf in sheep's clothing, which evidently they think is cute, pretty cool. I'd be like, that'd be the first sign of me telling people, "You watch out." But I guess they think, wink, wink. They think it's pretty cool. Like this group in America that has a magazine called the *Jacobin*. You named yourself after the Jacobins? There's people guillotined, 40,000 people in Paris, during the French Revolution. Jezebel— wow, those are great names.
- 3.33** "After taking their captives gently," said *Qui Pluribus*, "the communists mildly bind them, and then kill them in secret." Now, I don't even know how they knew that at that point, because the dance of death, the communist killing machine, hadn't even ramped up yet. We need Lenin and the Bolsheviks to get that going in 1917, but still, Pius IX is on to him. "The communists are filled with deceit and cunning." And I love this quote. "They spread pestilential doctrines everywhere and deprave the minds, especially of the imprudent, occasioning great losses for religion."
- 3.34** And I would say, yeah, the imprudent is somebody who's like, "Yeah, it says in here, 'from each according to his ability, to each according to his needs.' That's just like the Christian gospel. Wow, we should be communists. " That's imprudent. That's being really naive, really naive. So that's 1846. So when they write here at the beginning of this, "All the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise this specter," starting with the Pope and Tsar, that's why. That's why they're calling out the Pope, because he published that two years earlier. That's the opening paragraph.
- 3.35** "Two things result from this fact," and here we go, two things. "One, communism is already acknowledged by all European powers to be itself a power." So all these powers in Europe are already indeed acknowledging that communism seems to be

itself a power. They're onto it. They know something's afoot here. This thing is spreading. To quote Pius IX, "spreading pestilential doctrines that can deprave the minds, especially of the imprudent." There's a danger here.

- 3.36** "Two, it is high time that communists should openly, in the face of the whole world, publish their views." That's what they're saying. It's high time. Given that all the powers of Europe are already acknowledging that communism is itself a power, it's high time that we communists here publish our views and explain what we think. "Publish their views, publish their aims, their tendencies, and meet this nursery tale of the specter of communism with a Manifesto of the party itself."
- 3.37** At that point, when this is published in February 1848, so there already existed—and this picks up with the last question at the end of the last class—they already at that point have something called the Communist League. It's sometimes called the Communist Party as well, but it's really a Communist League at that time, or Communist Society. It hasn't formed a political party, really, yet. When the Communist Party does become a party, it's going to be the only party in every country that has communism. In fact, Lenin and the Comintern and everybody tell everyone.
- 3.38** The first thing the Communists do is ban all other parties, because the Communist Party becomes, in the words of George Kennan, "the sole repository of truth." You go to them. You go to the Communist Party. To this day in China, China is not so much—China isn't really communist economically. They're doing all kinds of things to expand markets, but they're communists politically, in that communism is the only allowed political party. If you want to go into politics, you have to join the Communist Party. So they would do that in each different country.
- 3.39** The Communist League, at this time, was about 40 to 50 people altogether, basically all Europeans, mostly Germans. Political leftists have this phrase, I first heard this in college in the late '80s, early '90s, called DWEMs, dead white European males. These are supposed to be bad guys. By the way, they're bad guys if it's Dante, Shakespeare, Luther, Calvin, the popes, and then they're bad guys. But DWEMs are good guys if it's like Marx and Engels and the Frankfurt School and Freud, then they're good. But so it's made up mainly of DWEMs, this group, this Communist League.
- 3.40** They exist, and they say, "It's high time that we get together and publish a document telling the world what we communists believe. We need a document. We need a single programmatic statement. We need a Manifesto informing everyone what we really believe." Marx and Engels, Engels wrote a letter to Marx a few weeks before this was published, and he said, "Give a little bit more thought to our Communist Confession of Faith. I think we should drop the catechetical form and call it simply the Manifesto." So they knew enough to know that it was like a communist confession of faith, their creed. "Marxism-Leninism, that religion of theirs."

- 3.41** So "it's high time the communists should openly, in the face of the whole world, publish their views, their aims or tendencies, with a Manifesto of the party itself." And so, here it is. Here is our Communist Manifesto; read it—which these different sources did. But the young people today who say, "Yeah, I support communism. It's a good idea. It talks about—", they haven't read it. So they should really stop and pause and open the book and take a look.
- 3.42** Next paragraph: "To this end, communists of various nationalities have assembled in London and sketched the following Manifesto, to be published in English, French, German, Italian, Flemish, and Danish languages." And later, Russian, as well. So they're putting it in a bunch of different tongues here. Not Latin, apparently, but English, French, German, Italian, Flemish, and Danish languages. When I did research in the Soviet Comintern archives on the Communist Party USA at the Library of Congress, all those documents were in multiple languages. Usually, the first one was German. German was probably the closest thing to a native tongue of these two, even though most of them met in Paris. Marx and Engels met in Paris.
- 3.43** I'm anticipating someone asking this question: Where did the word communism first begin? No one knows for sure, but Richard Pipes says, in his wonderful little book, *Communism: A History*, that it was coined somewhere in Paris in the 1840s. I don't know if we've ever found out who said it first. Or who used the word capitalism first. It's often said that Marx coined the term capitalism as a term of derision to use against, like—I don't know. I've never been able to pin that down.
- 3.44** So the book is divided into different sections, and they start with Section 1, Bourgeois and Proletarians. Here's one of the famous Marx phrases. One of the reasons they go to Marx to write this is that he's a polemicist. He can turn a phrase. He's a good writer.
- 3.45** Kind of like, bad analogy, Jefferson would roll over in his grave, but like Adams and Franklin choosing Thomas Jefferson to write the Declaration of Independence because, man, that Jefferson, he could really write. We've got this 33-year-old guy from Virginia named Thomas Jefferson. The guy comes up with great phrases. "When in the course of human events." "We hold these truths to be self-evident." "All men are created equal, endowed by their creator with certain unalienable rights." "Let these facts be submitted to a candid world."
- 3.46** So they choose Marx because Marx writes well. He opens with this line, and think about this. "The history of all hitherto existing society is the history of class struggles." That right there is a mouthful. The history of all history up to this point is the history of class struggle. That's the worldview. If we went around the room and asked all of you, "What is your conception of the purpose of a human being, of history? What's the purpose?" A Christian might say, "To worship, glorify God, serve God," something like that.

- 3.47** He's going to be like, "No, all of history is the history of class struggles. It's all boiled down to two groups: the bourgeois and the proletarians. History is about class. It's about economics." Here's what I was saying in the last lecture, how they say, "You capitalists, you're obsessed with capital." No, dude, you're obsessed with capital. You think all of history could be boiled down into a class? I wake up in the morning, and I do not think about what class I'm in. And I don't even care. I don't sit around, counting my capital in the morning and fulminating in envy and rage against who has more than me, and that they're in that reptile class of capitalists. You guys do that. You Marxists do that. Normal people don't.
- 3.48** Martin Malia here in his footnote says, so the two groups are the bourgeois or bourgeoisie and the proletariat, the proletarians. So that's the worldview: the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. These are the two. "By bourgeoisie is meant the class of modern capitalists. They are the owners of the means of social production, and they're the employers of wage labor."
- 3.49** A socialist calls for, as does a communist, common ownership of the means of production. So what's produced in society, the socialists, the communists, want that to be commonly owned, which, by the way, means the government publicly owns it, nationalizes it, takes it commonly. Lenin says that, of course, this doesn't mean that everybody actually owns the different property. It's not like you each get a share of whatever dividend at the factory or whatever. No, common ownership of the means of production means public ownership of the means of production, which means that the state has to seize it.
- 3.50** "By proletariat is meant the class of modern wage laborers who, having no means of production of their own, are reduced to selling their labor power in order to live." These are the good guys, according to Marxist theory. They're the ones that are being exploited. The bourgeoisie are the exploiters, the proletariat are the exploited. And the proletariat are like wage slaves, selling themselves to the owners in order to live. They're in bondage in that way.
- 3.51** Now, right here, you've got to start asking the questions from the first sentence: Do you guys even have this right? I know you fancy yourselves as economists here, but— I mentioned earlier, my people came to this country, my great-grandfather, the Italian side, Pietro Giovanazzo. One of the reasons that I'm so pro-immigration, he was a stowaway on a ship from Calabria, Italy, because he pulled a knife on a policeman in a fight in Calabria, Italy, couldn't get a visa, stowaway on a ship, came to America.
- 3.52** As the boat approached, came down the Hudson River and approached Ellis Island, he jumped into the water and swam, made his way to Little Italy, somewhere in New York, and then eventually went to Latrobe, Pennsylvania, and then changed his name, escaped to the mountains of Emporium, Pennsylvania. But the entire time that he was over here, and all my relatives, they never saw themselves as wage slaves. They left this

beautiful place in the boot of Italy, across from Sicily, because they wanted to have the choice to work for whoever they wanted.

- 3.53** And even the people who, in Marx's dark view of the Industrial Revolution, I mean, you can quit your job. They don't own you. You're not actually a slave. Again, I'm from Pittsburgh. Carnegie, Frick, Mellon, all these people, they owned these corporate—Westinghouse, my parents met at Westinghouse, George Westinghouse. They didn't have to work there. My dad didn't see himself as selling his labor in order to live, a wage slave of this owner. They were happy that this big, rich, fat cat founded a business and gave them a job.
- 3.54** And they were hoping—my dad did this working up through the steel industry, moving from the assembly line, eventually to a management job, Armco Steel in Butler— that you make your way up, so you can buy some property of your own, make some money of your own. But they have a very grim, dark view of the world. All of history is class struggle. The world is increasingly divided into these two.
- 3.55** They put it this way: "History of all hitherto existing society is a history of class struggles. Freeman and slave, patrician and plebeian, lord and serf, guild-master and journeyman, in a word," and here we go, "oppressor and oppressed." That's the worldview. And by the way, that is the Marxist worldview right now: oppressor and oppressed. The only question is: Who's doing it? Who's the oppressor this time, and who's the oppressed? Today, it would be the race-based Marxists, critical race theory. The world is divided into black versus white. Black, oppressed; white, oppressor.
- 3.56** It's a funny thing about the left. They hate the idea of binary when it's gender—you're either male or female—but they love the idea of binary when it's something like black versus white. But what could be more simplistic? My youngest son is black. He's adopted. You imagine if I said to him, "I know you like how you're being raised here with freedom. But you're screwed because you're black. And any white person that you meet is your oppressor. That's just simply the way it is."
- 3.57** Or to say to—I was a big Kobe Bryant fan: "Kobe, I know you have all this money. You've developed this great life, and you're actually raised in an upper-class family, but you're oppressed." "I am?" "Yeah, well, you're black. And that homeless white guy you passed on the way in? I know he looked like he was in a bad state, but he's your oppressor." "Huh?" "Well, he's white. You're black. Oprah, you're oppressed. The oppressor is that white guy." This is how they do it, and it divides people.
- 3.58** Martin Luther King Jr., who had strange views on socialism, communism, was not a good anti-communist, but did say that ultimately the reason he was against communism is because it divides people in camps according to class, and rejects religion and rejects the idea that people are made in the imago Dei. It sees people as purely material beings, based on economics and class. That's precisely the point.

- 3.59** The gender Marxist says, "Here's the world: male, female. Male, oppressor; female, oppressed." The gender Marxist Judith Butler, who I think is at Berkeley to this day; Kate Millett, who wrote the book *Sexual Politics*, which was her dissertation at Columbia, 1968-69; Shulamith Firestone, who wrote *The Dialectic of Sex*. It's pretty weird. I can't imagine being a guy in college, trying to pick up girls and say, "Hey, baby, you want to read *The Dialectic of Sex*?" Pretty weird. I digress.
- 3.60** So, in a word, oppressed and oppressor. "The modern bourgeois society that has sprouted from the ruins of feudal society has done away with class antagonisms. It has but established new classes, new conditions of oppression, new forms of struggle in place of the old ones. Our epoch, the epoch of the bourgeoisie, however, possesses this distinctive feature. It has simplified the class antagonisms." Here we go. "Society as a whole is more and more splitting up into two great hostile camps, into two great classes, directly facing each other, the bourgeoisie and the proletariat."
- 3.61** So here they are, bourgeoisie, proletariat, ready to clash, oppressed and oppressor, dividing the world, all the incredible complexities of the world, into two great hostile camps. My kids, if you look at their Ancestry.com results, including my youngest, who's adopted, they're all over the place. You get DNA from a million different places. I mean, my wife's got roots in every country in the Middle East. Imagine saying to them, "No, you're either black or white, one of the two." Israelis, Palestinians—one of you has got to be white guys, one of you has got to be the brown guys. People try to do that with the Palestinian-Israeli issue as well, certain types of modern Marxism. "But divides the whole world into those two camps, facing one another."
- 3.62** A big part of Marxism and Marxist teaching, Lenin talks about this in his essay, *What Is to Be Done?*—it's talked about by Kate Millett and others, 1960s radicals—is the idea of consciousness raising. So you have to teach the oppressed that they are the oppressed class. They might not know any better. They might just think that they're going on with life here, and they can have freedom and buy themselves some property and have a good time. They need to know that no, their situation sucks. They are oppressed, whether they like it or not, and they need people like this to teach them, to raise their consciousness, to know their plight.
- 3.63** Mark Rudd, who was one of the founders of the Weather Underground with Bill Ayers, Bernardine Dohrn, talks about, in his memoirs, which is a brutally honest memoir, came out maybe about 10 years ago—he was one of the founders of the group Progressives for Obama, but they were really Marxists and radical communists—but he talked about, he organized Columbia. He shut down Columbia University in the spring of 1968.
- 3.64** They talked about going out to cities like Pittsburgh, Chicago, and Cleveland to organize what they called the Greasers, the working-class kids, the Poles, the Italians, the Irish. And instead, these Greasers would be like, "Get out of here. We don't like communism. We want our private property. You commie, get out of here." So he said they would beat up Rudd and their friends from Columbia. Rudd and their friends are getting

punched out, going, "But don't you see, we're comrades. We're enlightening you to this world, this brave new world. Don't you understand?"

- 3.65** So it becomes the job of the universities, the graduate schools, too, the cultural institutions. To quote Gramsci and these guys, "the conveyor belts of culture." You have to go into the universities to learn the faith, to learn this, to learn that indeed the world is divided into two great hostile camps: oppressed and oppressor. You're in one or the other. And by the way, you need to hate the other guy, because he's oppressing you.
- 3.66** A lot of people stop with part one: bourgeoisie versus proletarians. I think the most important part is part two: proletarians and communists, which comes about 20 pages later. Here, they say some really remarkable things, which really articulates what communism is. "The immediate aim of the communists is the same as that of all proletarian parties; that is, formation of the proletariat into a class, overthrow of the bourgeois supremacy, conquest of political power by the proletariat." Pause there for a moment on that.
- 3.67** "Overthrow" is one of the most commonly used words in the Manifesto. Now, depending on the translation that you're using—I'm right now working on a content analysis right now of the Manifesto—the word overthrow is used in The Communist Manifesto nine times, including the final statement calling for the forcible overthrow of all existing conditions.
- 3.68** Remember, with the modern college kid, who says that he or she likes communism, says, "Well, it's a good book. It's about redistributing the wealth and helping your neighbor, loving your neighbor." How many times is the word redistribute used? Zero. Distribute or distribution: four times. Neighbor: zero. Love: twice. These are passing references. They have nothing to do with Marx saying, "And I must say, communism means to love your neighbor." It doesn't say that. Sharing, share: four times. Violent, violence: seven times. Overthrow: nine times. Critical, criticism: 10 times. Radical: 15. Revolution, revolutionary—I'm still trying to tabulate all those. Force, forced, forcible: 47 times. Remember, neighbor: zero times. Love: twice. Force, forced, forcible: 47 times.
- 3.69** And the winner is abolish, abolition: 61 times. Patrisse Cullors, the co-founder of Black Lives Matter, "I am an abolitionist." Everyone's like, "Oh, yeah, you're against slavery." No, she's a Marxist abolitionist. Marx was an abolitionist. Marx was all about abolition. In fact, Robert Payne says he calls for abolition so many times, it jumps out so many times; he wants to abolish everything from private property to profits, family, morality, religion, nationalities, calls for abolition of the present state of things. You'll see this again and again as we read through this.
- 3.70** Here's maybe—it says a number of times, the most important. Here's one of the most important lines. If someone asked me for a definition of communism, I'd say, "Well, I'll

give you Marx and Engels' definition because they made it very simple." They say here, "The theory of the communists may be summed up in the single sentence," four words, "abolition of private property." The theory of the communists may be summed up in a single sentence: abolition of private property. Okay, got it.

- 3.71** I tell you, if one of my students handed that in, a paper calling, "Professor, I intend in this essay to argue for the abolition of private property," maybe I'd turn him into the dean for that. Well, do you realize that if you want to abolish private property, you're going to need force, despotism? Private property is—some people consider it a sacred right, a natural right, from the cave to the courthouse. "Thou shalt not steal" is one of the Ten Commandments. Go all through the Old and New Testaments.
- 3.72** Private property—Richard Weaver in *Ideas Have Consequences* says, "Everything hinges on private property." The right to be able to buy your own land, sell it, cultivate it, produce resources on it, everything is all about private property. By the way, if you said to these two guys, "Don't you get that?", they'd probably say, "Oh, yeah, I totally get it. But if everything that exists deserves to perish, we sure as hell need to blow up private property." They get it.
- 3.73** And you'll see when we get to their 10-point plan, it says, of course, in the beginning, this cannot be effected except by means of despotic inroads. Don't you know that you're going to need force to do this? Well, yeah, our final paragraph—we can't help it if people don't read it—calls for the forcible overthrow thing. Yeah, we get it, totally get it.
- 3.74** Francis Wheen, the Marx—very pro-Marx, Marx biographer, says it's absurd to blame Marx for the guns and the gulags. There's no mention of guns and gulags in the Manifesto. They call for the forcible overthrow of everything that exists. They call for abolishing private property. What do you think they're going to— you don't think they're going to need guns and gulags? You think people are just going to say, "Oh, you want to take all my land and my property? Okay, cool. I'll see you. You can have all of it. You can have all my cattle, everything, because I believe in this new world that you're going to create. Sure, here it is, here."
- 3.75** Of course, you're going to have to kill people to do that, to abolish their private property. They write, a couple of pages later, "You are horrified at our intending to do away with private property. In one word, you reproach us with intending to do away with your private property." Do they say here, well, we don't really mean that? They write, "Precisely so. That is just what we intend."
- 3.76** I should have used it in this course, but you guys can look it up. Go to marxists.org and read Engels' essay called "The Principles of Communism," which was published in 1847. And he says in there things like, "But isn't it going to be necessary to use force to abolish private property?" The answer is, yes, of course. What else? You have to, because people are going to resist.

- 3.77** In between that, they write this. "And the abolition of this state of things is called by the bourgeois, abolition of individuality and freedom! And rightly so. The abolition of bourgeois individuality, bourgeois independence, and bourgeois freedom is undoubtedly aimed at that." They do a lot of playing with words here, too. They'll do things like, "But in your existing society, private property is already done away with, for nine-tenths of the population. Its existence for the few is solely due—" Well, hey, whatever.
- 3.78** First of all, they don't have any data on that. They don't know that anyway, because Marx never actually went to the field and did studies or real research. But if your argument is that it doesn't already exist for nine-tenths, so what are we going to do? Abolish it for them, too, and everybody else? What's your point? Do you want it, or do you want it not? Or do you not want it?
- 3.79** But either way, the entire communist theory may be summed up in a single sentence: "abolition of private property." I can tell you right now, you're going to probably have to kill 100 million people, trying to pull that one off. And you could stomp up and down and call them greedy and whatever, they want their private property, but there's something called human nature, and you just have to deal with it. If you want a philosophy that works, it should adapt to human nature.
- 3.80** Federalist 51 by James Madison, which is wonderful, and he says, "What is government but a reflection on human nature?" I screwed up the quote. It's really good. Look at Federalist 51. He says, in creating a government, "ambition must be used to constrain ambition." But he said, government is the best of reflections on human nature. You need to understand human nature. Benedict XVI said the problem with Marx and Engels, it was not so much economically—of course, economically, it doesn't work—not so much philosophically, but anthropologically. It's an anthropological failure. They failed to understand human nature. And people just aren't going to let you do this.
- 3.81** We've got about six minutes. Jumping ahead here, how about some more abolitions? You all keeping track? Here we go, page 87. "Abolition of the family! Even the most radical flare up at this infamous proposal of the communists." "Well, I didn't know that was in there. I thought it was about sharing." "Abolition of the family!" Now, you have to say, "Even the most radical flare up at this infamous proposal of the communists." It was already infamous at that point.
- 3.82** American communists, who I'll talk about in this series, they talked about what they called communist marriage. Communist marriage was a marriage where the guy and the girl were living together, and they had not been married in a church. That's what you did. They wanted to redefine marriage. They wanted to change marriage. They wanted to change the family. "Abolition of the family! Even the most radical flare up at this infamous proposal of the communists."

- 3.83** And then this. What's this doing in a book that just talks about sharing wealth? "Do you charge us with wanting to stop the exploitation of children by their parents?" The answer here should be: we wouldn't do that. "To this crime, we plead guilty. But, you will say, we destroy the most hallowed of relations when we replace home education by social." What's up with that? You're going to replace home education by social? What are you messing with that for? I thought you just wanted to share wealth. What's this abolition of the family, stopping the exploitation of children by their parents, replace home education with social?
- 3.84** And then you'll see, when we talk about, in the next lecture, in the 10-point plan, their final, the 10-point plan, is free education for all children in public schools. So they want to end home education. They want to end religious education. They want to push mothers and fathers out into the factories and farms. They want the daily care of children to be done by daycare people, full-time workers of the state, daycare. They want everything to be done in the new government collective, educational collective.
- 3.85** They rail against what they call "the bourgeois clap-trap about the family and education, about the hallowed correlation of parent and child, which becomes all the more disgusting, the more, by the action of modern industry, all family ties among the proletarians are torn asunder." But the bourgeois clap-trap about family and children, the hallowed correlation of parent and child.
- 3.86** Actually, we believe that the relationship between parent and child is hallowed. It is special, created, ordained by God. The two come together. The man and the woman leave their parents, become one flesh, create children. The first home, the first school of the family, of the child, is the home. They want to rupture that. They want to take that apart. They want to push them all into free education, end home education.
- 3.87** By the way, they have to, in order to create this whole new ideological worldview. "The bourgeois sees in his wife a mere instrument of production." Opinion? It's your opinion, dude. Maybe Marx and Engels might see it that way, but don't tell that to my wife. I'll get kicked right in the head. My wife teaches kickboxing. She could do it. Bam, bam, bam, bam. "Our bourgeois, not content with having the wives and daughters of their proletarians at their disposal, not to speak of common prostitutes, take the great pleasure in seducing each other's wives."
- 3.88** And Marx actually seduced the family nursemaid, I should note, right. That's why I point out that stuff in earlier lectures, like I said, not to just pile on Marx's character, but to point out the incredible hypocrisies in so much of this. "Bourgeois marriage is in reality a system of wives in common." Further down on that page—we've got about two minutes left. "The communists are further reproached with their desire to abolish countries and nationality." Keep that list of abolishing. We've got family, countries, nationality, marriage, capital, private property. It's a long list. But like I said, abolish, abolition, used 61 times in these 50 pages. Oh, yeah, they're abolitionists, all right. Sure were.

- 3.89** Moving ahead. They do this quite often. They put quotes around statements as if to say, "They're saying this about us," and it's not always clear if they're saying these are people saying it about Marx and Engels and the communists, or if they're saying it themselves, and they often don't give you an answer. "There are, besides, eternal truths, such as freedom, justice, etc., that are common to all states of society. But communism abolishes eternal truths; it abolishes all religion, and all morality, instead of constituting them on a new basis."
- 3.90** And they say, what does this accusation reduce itself to? "This history of all past society has consisted in the development of class antagonisms." Look at that phrase, "Communism abolishes truths, it abolishes all religion, all morality." Well, we do know that they're against religion; we know what they've been writing about religion. We know you think it's the opiate of the masses, the heart of a heartless world, soul of soulless conditions.
- 3.91** And finally, I'll finish with this, which will set us up for the next lecture, which is on the 10-point plan of The Communist Manifesto. And this really nails it. According to Marx and Engels themselves, and the Communist League, in their Communist Manifesto, "The Communist revolution is the most radical rupture in traditional relations; no wonder that its development involves the most radical rupture with traditional ideas." So if you were to say, "Don't Marx and Engels realize how radical this is?", yeah, they do. You know, the modern millennial in the college, who thinks that the book is just about sharing, sure as heck doesn't. They get it.
- 3.92** "The Communist revolution is the most radical rupture with traditional relations; no wonder that its development involves the most radical rupture with traditional ideas." They realized that there was nothing more revolutionary than what they were proposing. This isn't like American progressivism or conservatism or liberalism or libertarianism. You don't get more revolutionary than this. That's why all the powers of old Europe, as they empty this book, have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise a specter, and realize that itself, what a power it was. Because they knew that this was something that could—popes are writing encyclicals on this stuff, it's so shocking.
- 3.93** All right, very good. I'll stop there. If you have any questions?
- 3.94** In the Manifesto, Marx says the proletariat has to be brought together into a class. It seems to me he's saying it's not a class unless it's unified into maybe a collective force. So, how would Marx define a class?
- 3.95** Yeah, that's a good question, because he uses these phrases so interchangeably. In the end, he called for, you would eventually have what he called a dictator of the proletariat. And that dictatorship—it's appropriate, by the way, if Marx used the word dictatorship—and that dictatorship of the proletariat would be a way station on the way to an ultimately classless society. So you would have a worker's utopia bereft of classes.

- 3.96** Now, the problem with this, for anybody with any practical mind at all reading this book, I love teaching this to older groups of business people. They're jumping out of their seats. "Well, how are you going to do that?" It drives them absolutely crazy. But the problem— and Lenin acknowledges this in *What Is to Be Done* and other things—is that somebody needs to be the vanguard of the class of the proletariat. You need a group. And this is what Lenin said. You need a trained cadre of revolutionaries, educated revolutionaries.
- 3.97** In our country, it would be the enlightened people at Columbia. To come forward and let the masses know, OK, we've gone from slavery, and now we're at feudalism. Now we're at capitalism. Now we're at socialism. We're at common ownership of the means of production, but that's not good enough until you go to full communism. Now we're at this step. Now we need to do this. Now we're here. And so, what you really need is, as Malia and others say, a regime and a plan and a party that's going to manage all this.
- 3.98** Because this stuff doesn't just happen organically. It's not like, here's the masses in the class, and it comes up, and now here it becomes—you need guys in charge, who are educated, raising the consciousness of all the idiotic, unwashed, superstitious, idiot religious masses, to lead them and teach them and manage them and tell them where we are. And that has to be, because if they're abolishing private property and religion and all this other stuff, that regime is going to be a group of dictators with guns and supreme police. There's no other way.
- 3.99** And for the communist who doesn't like that and says, "Well, there's no other way, because the masses won't agree to it, damn them," they won't. So somebody is going to have to use force against them, even if it's for their own good. So this is Wheen's point, "nowhere does Marx call for guns and gulags." Just think it through. Think through practically how you're going to do this.
- 3.100** And I haven't even gotten to the 10-point plan yet. That'll be in the next lecture. We go through that, you'll be like, oh, yeah. They're just going to let you, oh, what is it again? Gradual abolition of all the distinction between town and country by a more equitable distribution of the population over the country? How are you going to do that without force? Other questions?
- 3.101** Yeah. I mean, there's a lot. I guess, how is it that this ideology has been able to spread, albeit somewhat effectively, through multiple countries and continents? I studied Latin American revolutions in college, and I actually believed a lot of this, and so the naïveté was there. How is it so well funded, organized, et cetera, and why is the counter, even though it's coming, why is it not more proliferated?
- 3.102** Well, I personally think there's a spiritual reason behind it, frankly, but that's not something I can prove. That's not the political scientist's explanation. But in reality, the countries where communism has been implemented have all been through revolution or upheaval, usually by force. It's hardly ever, if ever, elected. And then if it is, or they

come into power through some sort of popular support, they never hold elections after that. And if they do, they're skewed, even in the case with Maduro recently.

- 3.103** Fidel Castro promised in 1957 that he was going to hold free and fair elections, multiple times. Then he takes over the country, Batista flees, January 1st, 1959. We are still to this day waiting for elections in Cuba. He never held them one time. And by the way, if he would hold elections, then America would have to lift embargo, out of the terms of the Cuban Embargo Act. So it would be the easiest thing in the world for him to say, "Well, communism is popular. The people love me. I'll hold an election. I'll show everybody. Jimmy Carter will come down here and certify it. The UN will certify it." But he wouldn't do it because he knew he would lose. So they never really have popular support.
- 3.104** All the countries—so they take the Soviet Union through revolution, and then they take all of Eastern Europe. So they get seven, eight countries in Eastern Europe in the Warsaw Pact, because of World War II. Stalin keeps his troops in Eastern Europe, Yalta and everything. So he takes them. China is taken by the Chinese civil war, '46 to '49, Cambodia by Pol Pot and his goons. So it's always by forcible overthrow and force. So I think it rarely, if ever, does have popular support.
- 3.105** I'll probably talk about this if I get to it, in the final lecture in this course. What does have more popular support is in America today, where they're calling for things like democratic socialism. I mean, people in New York just freely elected Zohran Mamdani, who's a democratic socialist, as mayor of New York, who says a lot of positive things about Marxism. But that's different than being a pure Marxism who's calling for a Marxist revolution.
- 3.106** Reading the Manifesto, it seems that Marx has this understanding of economics as purely even barter, and nowhere is even the idea of profit brought up. Is this on purpose, or is this something he didn't even consider?
- 3.107** Yeah, he seems to—this sounds so insulting and dismissive, doesn't it, on my part? He really is just an economic ignoramus. He really doesn't understand economics at all, or even how profit works. In a real system of profit and markets, it's based on the free exchange, interaction between buyer and seller. The seller is able to sell because he has property. The seller might even sell property to somebody buying property. These are consensual relationships, and the way that people have existed since the dawn of time.
- 3.108** It's really kind of like the natural state of Homo sapiens. We've just had this ability to have property, build it, have families, and then exchange things, unless something comes in to throw it all off. But he saw the world in this very simplistic way of a proletariat, bourgeoisie, oppressed versus oppressor; and never seemed to quite realize, too, that maybe they were just at an odd spot in history during the Industrial Revolution, when there were certain abuses that were going on in this period.

3.109 But he sees all of the history of the world, "all history hitherto is class struggles," from the very beginning to the very end of time, ending in this New Jerusalem of this utopian classless society. So I just don't think he really understood any of it or thought it through, which is why he is, more than anything else, a philosopher, a revolutionary. He's not an economist. It's very clear he wasn't an economist.

Lecture 4: The Ten-Point Plan

At a glance — The ten-point plan of the Manifesto.

- 4.1 Welcome back, everybody. I was just talking to some members of the audience about writing the book, *The Devil and Karl Marx*, and just how dark and depressing it was. At the end of the day, doing that research and that writing, you just have to stop. You've got to go switch to something else, get into another gear, read something different.
- 4.2 My wife would often hear me in the other room, just groaning. She's like, "What is it now?" I'd say, "Well, listen to this." I'd read a poem from Marx. I'd rather be writing books about something like baseball, anything but Karl Marx. After I did that book, I did a different book on a religious subject that was much more uplifting. But anybody who does this kind of research and writing over and over again, there's only so much of it you could take.
- 4.3 And in the acknowledgements to that book, I talk about one of my student assistants who helped me with a lot of the research. And I later apologized to her when I found out, because oftentimes, as a professor, we teach from about August until May, and we'll collect research during the year, and I'll have research assistants. Frankly, a lot of this everybody had in lecture notes. Everybody knew a lot of this about Marx anyway. But I would have my student assistant go out and look up somebody like Wilhelm Reich, who wrote the book *The Sexual Revolution*, the sexual-gender, Freudian Marxist. She would collect it, and then she would graduate.
- 4.4 Then once she left campus—the student's name is Hannah; I mentioned her in the acknowledgments—then around mid-May, I dug into the research, and I'm like, "Good lord, look what I had this girl look up." I e-mailed her and apologized. I said, "And please apologize to your—extend my apologies to your parents as well, for putting—I had no idea that you were researching this kind of thing." She said, "Well, yeah, that's okay. I figured you didn't know." But really dark. A lot of it is really dark.
- 4.5 We'll pick up today with *The Communist Manifesto*. So, in the last lecture, we were actually going through the book itself. As I said, I used the 1998 Penguin Signet Classics edition with the editor as Martin Malia. I wanted to pick up with a note from Malia. I haven't quoted Malia much, but he notes this in his wonderful introduction to *The Communist Manifesto*, talking about the bourgeoisie and the proletariat and dividing the world into those two groups. So Malia wrote this. According to Marx and Engels in *The Communist Manifesto* and Communist theory, "The proletariat is the agent of emancipation."
- 4.6 So this is the group that's going to emancipate and liberate humanity in this big worldview perspective that Marx and Engels and the Communist League are cooking up. "The proletariat is charged with this supreme mission precisely because it is the most exploited and hence most dehumanized class in existing society." So their

worldview is class, economics. So according to them, what is the most dehumanized and most exploited class or economic group? Well, it's the proletariat.

- 4.7 So because of that, as Marx put it, when he first mentioned the proletariat in 1843—now the Manifesto was published in 1848, so it's first mentioned in 1843 by Marx—he refers to the proletariat as "the universal class" because its sufferings are universal. So that's like the be-all and end-all class. It is the universal class because its sufferings are universal. It's like you're pinning all of the hopes of humanity here upon the suffering, the sacrifice, of the proletariat. By the stripes of the proletariat, you will be healed.
- 4.8 "Marx thus defined the proletariat in the first instance, not as the body of factory workers, but as the metaphysical demiurge, destined to liberate the species from social inequality." So it was, and I think what Malia writes here is beautifully stated: the proletariat was the victim class that would become the redeemer class. So the victim class that becomes the redeemer class, the class to end all classes.
- 4.9 "Marx's revolution would occur when the proletariat achieved consciousness." Now, there's that phrase again. So the goal of the educated classes, the Marxist classes, the people at Columbia and the other universities, charged with this sort of mission, is to raise the consciousness of the proletariat, let it know what its mission is. By the way, a lot of people in the proletariat are like, "What's the proletariat? I didn't even know that I was in this group. Frankly, I don't even want to be in it, now that I've read what you have to say here." They said, "Well, no, no, no, no. You're kind of like a chosen people. You need to be educated to realize what your goal is in this universal dialectical sweep to end all classes."
- 4.10 "Marx's revolution will occur when the proletariat achieves consciousness of its dehumanized plight, and so also of its emancipatory mission." So you need to know your role as an emancipator. "Thus, this provincial German ideologue, freshly arrived in Paris, did not hesitate to proclaim," and here's another famous Marx quote. Remember the quote about how "the revolution that began in the mind of the monk will now continue in the mind of the philosopher." Marx, in the "opiate of the masses" essay, talking about Luther?
- 4.11 Marx did not hesitate to claim "philosophy is the head of this emancipation, but the proletariat is the heart." So the heart, the proletariat, is like the muscle, the beating heart of this revolution. And Marx and Engels said that revolutions are "the locomotives of history." So revolutions drive history. So these people want revolution, because revolution is what brings that change.
- 4.12 Trotsky, who we talked about in the last lecture, Trotsky worked with Lenin and Stalin, early founders of the Bolshevik Revolution—he preached the idea of permanent revolution. And his group was, his heirs today are the Socialist Workers Party. At one point, we'll talk about this in the next lecture, Stalin—there's a battle when Lenin dies

in January 1924 over who's going to be the successor. And the successor is going to be probably either Stalin or Trotsky, so this battle commences between the two.

- 4.13 And eventually, Stalin has Trotsky exiled out of the country in 1927, to Alma-Ata, Kazakhstan. And then Trotsky spends a long period abroad, 1927 to 1940, ends up in Mexico, Mexico City. And it's in Mexico City that, at that point, Stalin finally has enough of Trotsky, writing the things that he writes, agitating against Stalin, and he has Trotsky murdered in Mexico City, with an ice pick to the back of the head. But Trotsky's group became the Socialist Workers Party.
- 4.14 Bernie Sanders was a supporter of the Socialist Workers Party. We don't have any evidence that Bernie ever joined the Socialist Workers Party. Bernie has always been an independent. When he ran for President of the United States in 2016 as a Democrat, James Carville, the old Bill Clinton advisor—you all know who James Carville is? He's got that Cajun accent. He said, "People need to know that Bernie is not a Democrat."
- 4.15 He's not. He's not a Democrat. He was always an independent. He was always very smart not to affiliate or tie himself too closely to a political party. But Bernie Sanders was a formal presidential elector in 1980 to the Socialist Workers Party. So again, that's the party of Trotsky that calls for permanent revolution. And Marx and Engels said that revolutions are the locomotives of history.
- 4.16 Back to Malia's introduction here to The Communist Manifesto. So he quoted Marx, who said, "Philosophy is the head of this emancipation, and the proletariat is the heart." So the proletariat is the heart; it's the muscle of the revolution, but it's the philosophers. Thomas Sowell talked about the vision of the anointed, the philosopher class that will lead this, that will provide the head, the understanding. "Thereby, Marx made the proletariat the bearer of universal reason; and his communism became, not just equality, but the rational ordering of all human life."
- 4.17 Malia again. "And his dialectical logic rolled on." I love this religious language here by Malia. "The social redemption of humanity would be produced by the very process of dependence that defined its historical Way of the Cross," the Via della Croce, the Via Crucis, which is done every year at the Vatican with the stations of the cross during Lent, during Good Friday, where you follow all the different stations and you follow Christ all the way to Calvary, where he makes his final sacrifice on the cross.
- 4.18 So, in a way here, there's a march, too, through the stations of history, and the proletariat is carrying the cross, as the victim class that will be the redeemer class, that will bring in emancipation. So again, it's through the stripes of the proletariat that you are healed. It's very much a kind of eschatology here, end-times understanding, a kind of messianic aspect to Marxism, to communism.
- 4.19 "The species therefore must suffer the degradations of ancient slavery, feudal serfdom, and bourgeois wage labor exploitation to build a productive capacity to free itself, not only from the blind forces of nature, but also from the class divisions within the body

social." So that's the vision. That's the plan here. It's going to be through economics, it's going to be through class, that you're going to have this liberation.

- 4.20 Picking up where we left off in the last class. So we were going through the Manifesto. We left off with the quotes on the bottom. This is about 30 pages into the Manifesto. As I said, in this edition, Manifesto goes from pages 61 to 111. It's just 50 pages. That's it. It's a short book. It's not a long book. We left off with this statement, which is, again, a powerful statement of what Marxists believe. "The Communist revolution is the most radical rupture with traditional relations." The most radical rupture with traditional relations. "No wonder that its development involves the most radical rupture with traditional ideas."
- 4.21 Yeah, and what could be more radical than abolishing private property? Phrases like "abolition of the family!". Communism abolishes, as they put it in quotes in the Manifesto, "all religion, all truth, all morality," abolishing nationalities and countries. So they realize this is the most radical rupture in traditional relations. They are starting again anew, entirely. And they have a 10-point plan. Here we go. Are you ready for the 10-point plan?
- 4.22 It's often said, too—I've encountered this over the years—some people say, "Well, the problem with Marxism is, it's too vague in different parts. They talk about this is going to lead to that." Yeah, and in some sense, it can be way too vague. How exactly is the proletariat going to uprising? Who's going to be in charge of it? Who's going to be calling the shots on the different spots, on the Via della Croce, the Via Crucis? Who's going to know each step that you're going through? But on the other hand, they provided some specifics, provided a bunch of specifics, provided a 10-point plan, and here it is.
- 4.23 Point one. By the way, isn't it perfect that the 10-point plan would begin with what word? Abolition. Abolition, again. "Abolition of property in land and application of all rents of land to public purposes." So "abolition of property in land." If you're keeping that abolition list, it's a long list. As I said in the last class, the last lecture, at least 60 references to words like abolish, abolition. It's one of the most common words in the Manifesto, and probably the most important. After all, abolition means abolition.
- 4.24 Point two. I find this fascinating. "A heavy progressive or graduated income tax." That's point two of the Manifesto. "A heavy progressive or graduated income tax." In the United States, I remember one of the first times that I went to the Reagan Library, and I was looking through old Ronald Reagan's speeches in the 1950s, 1960s, that Ronald Reagan had written himself. Reagan wrote all these speeches himself. This is before he ran for governor in 1966, long before he became president in 1981.
- 4.25 In one of the speeches, he commented about "our progressive income tax in America, which is straight out of Marx's Communist Manifesto." And I thought, straight out of Marx's Communist Manifesto? That's got to be hyperbole. What's he talking about there? And when I actually read The Communist Manifesto, which I didn't in graduate

school, when I was studying communism—well, how can you study communism without reading The Communist Manifesto?

- 4.26 And this is the problem, right? As people who generally are sympathetic of the ideology are teaching kids in college about the ideology, and try to convince them that it talks about sharing and the redistribution of wealth and helping the poor, if they just actually had them read the book, the kids would come to a completely different conclusion on Marxism, which is why they don't have them read the book. They figure, if they read this, they're not going to be in at all. They're not going to be on board at all.
- 4.27 But a heavy progressive or graduated income, progressive or graduated income tax, we in America got our graduated progressive income tax, permanent tax on income, anyone know what year? 1913. It was in 1913, in America. So up to that point, we had not had a permanent tax on income in the United States. They had to amend the Constitution in order to do this, the 16th Amendment to the Constitution.
- 4.28 If you go back and you read the debates in Congress over a progressive income tax, it was a knock-down-drag-out, especially between the people who said, "Well, look, you got these guys out there that got piles of money, and this is just going to be a small tax, upper level, 7% on the very wealthiest people. I mean, people making over a million dollars a year in 1913." This is going to apply to a couple of Mellons, Vanderbilt, Frick, Carnegie, maybe a dozen people.
- 4.29 And the lowest rate is only 1%. So the progressive income tax works, it depends on how much money you make. But if you make, let's say, under \$20,000 a year, you'd be at 1%. And then \$20,000 to \$40,000 a year, 2%. And then \$40,000 to \$60,000, 3%, and eventually, climbs up and up. Over a million a year, 7%. So a higher rate, the more that you make. There's this knock-down-drag-out in Congress at the time over this, and among the people who are against it, quoting people like John Marshall, "The power to tax is the power to destroy."
- 4.30 And they were concerned that if you enacted the principle, the right to have a permanent tax on income in the United States, look out, because Congress, with that kind of power, is just going to keep jacking it up. That'd be like giving the drunk the keys to the liquor cabinet. Don't let the government do that. Don't let them, don't let them have that ability. So it starts in America, 1913, top percentage of 7%. This is how quickly it went up.
- 4.31 By 1921, after two terms of the Woodrow Wilson Administration, that upper rate of 7% was 73%. 73% became the highest rate in 8 years. And don't ever let some progressive supporter of this say, "Well, we had World War I." No, look at the rates. Look it up. World War I started in 1914. It didn't start for America until Woodrow Wilson asked Congress for a Declaration of War, April 1917, got it April 6th, 1917. We really don't even start sending troops in earnest till the end of 1917, beginning of 1918. It's over November 11th, 1918. We're in that war for about a year, a year and a half.

- 4.32 What that's funding, that tax, is Woodrow Wilson's so-called administrative state. This is the beginning of the expansion of the federal government, and they're going to use money from the graduated income tax, progressive income tax, to fund it. That 73% rate was eventually brought down to 24% through the Republican administrations in the 1920s, under the leadership of the Treasury Secretary Andrew Mellon, from my hometown of Pittsburgh. So he brings it down to 24%.
- 4.33 Herbert Hoover, who was no laissez-faire free marketer, brought the top rate back up to 63%. People have, what was the song from All in the Family, right? "Mister, we could use a man like Herbert Hoover again." Maybe use a man like Calvin Coolidge, but Hoover was a big taxer. So it goes back up to 63%. And then FDR took it up to 94% on incomes over \$100,000.
- 4.34 And at one point, and a really good book on this is FDR Goes to War by Burt and Anita Fulsom, FDR wanted—and I'm not making this up, you can look it up; people that are watching this are thinking, "I'm going to Google this right now. There's no way this guy is right." At one point, FDR wanted a 99.5% rate on incomes over \$100,000. 99.5% on incomes over \$100,000. Take 99.5% of what you make strictly through federal income tax, over \$100,000. Incredible. Congress, which was run by Democrats, said, "No. That's absurd. You can't do that."
- 4.35 And that's not the fun World War II. This is the fun, the New Deal. Well, part of it's the fun World War II, but this is the New Deal. This is his great expansion of the welfare state, like Wilson's expansion of the administrative state. This actually drove Ronald Reagan out of the Democratic Party. Reagan had been a huge FDR supporter, called himself a hemophiliac liberal, a bleeding-heart liberal.
- 4.36 Reagan, as an actor in Hollywood, found himself in the 90th percentile. In those days, major actors made several movies a year. They would make two or three movies a year. So Reagan learned that, once he hit a certain income level, there's really no point in making another movie because you're going to lose 91-94% of the income. And Reagan noticed that if he made that decision not to make that film, and others made the same decision, you know who was really hurt? The ladies in the cafeteria lot at Warner Brothers, the cameramen, the janitors, the little guy. Those are the people who didn't make money if the movie wasn't done.
- 4.37 Frank Capra, one of my all-time favorite film directors—he did "It's a Wonderful Life," "Mr. Smith Goes to Washington," "Meet John Doe," "You Can't Take It With You," "It Happened One Night"—he created his own film company at the time, and it very quickly died because all of his income was taken in federal tax dollars. Capra, in his biography, it's actually quite funny that he does this—he would say, "Now, 'Meet John Doe' was obviously a great success, and you would think that I must have made a mint on this. Well, in fact, I made a blank amount of dollars, like \$992,000. But after my federal income tax, I made only this." So he was very careful to point out to people how damaging that was.

- 4.38 And my point in mentioning all of this with the American system is that we actually got Marx's graduated or progressive income tax. And FDR, eventually, that top 90-plus percent rate was brought down to 70% by John F. Kennedy, and then Reagan eventually brought it down to 28%. And when Reagan came in, and there are people here who've been paying taxes long enough to know this stuff, there were 16 separate tax brackets. So you'd be in the 1% rate, the 5%, the 10%, the 15, the 20, the 28, climb all the way up to 70. Reagan said, "We're going to simplify this. We're going to have two rates: 28% and 15%."
- 4.39 And ever since then, that rate went up to 31% under George H. W. Bush, who said, "Read my lips, no new taxes," put up to 31%. Bill Clinton put it up to 39.6. George W. Bush brought it down to 36. Barack Obama retained it, although he wasn't happy about it; he compared his Republicans to hostage-takers. "You have to understand this federal income, these tax cuts are like the Holy Grail to these people." Then Trump has tinkered with it a little bit, but hasn't really changed it much, has done some things with the rates.
- 4.40 In communist Russia, Vladimir Putin, as much as I certainly don't like Vladimir Putin, one of the first things that he did when he came in in 2000—and my friend Richard Vedder, who writes for us at the American Spectator, was part of the group that actually advised the Putin government on this, before the Putin government went crazy and became completely thuggish and did all the things that they did—but the Russians, post-communists, moving away from communism, implemented a flat tax on income. It's 15 or 20% around the year 2000.
- 4.41 So a lot of people in America today, myself included, would prefer a flat tax, something like 20% across the board on all incomes. Often your people on the left will say, "Well, then the middle class pays as much as the rich." No, you don't. You pay the same rate. But if you're making \$2 million a year or making \$50,000 a year, 20% applied to 50 is a lot less than 20% applied to 2 million. All right, so progressive graduated income tax. That's in The Communist Manifesto. Is that not wild?
- 4.42 Point three. Abolition of all right of inheritance. You're thinking, what are we going to abolish next? All right, there we go. Abolition of all right of inheritance. But this one is really shocking. And again, this goes back to why I talk about the personal life of Marx so much. And people often accuse me, "You're just beating up Marx and saying these things about him personally to denigrate his ideas." No, you later see how his ideas are an extension of his life, and oftentimes, hypocrisy based on his early life.
- 4.43 These guys want to abolish all right of inheritance? That's how Marx got all of his money. That's how Engels got all of his money. That's how Marx and Jenny got all their money, from Marx's dad, and then Marx's mom, or at least getting her to rip up the IOUs, and then getting Jenny's family to give money, and Jenny's relatives, and then even Lenchen, the nursemaid, being lent to them. And then at that point, Engels, who

inherits all the money from his industrialist father, subsidizes the Marx family with that inheritance. So these guys want to abolish all right of inheritance?

- 4.44 But beyond Marx and the hypocrisy of Marx there, just think about what this means. Abolition of all right of inheritance. This is why business people—I love giving this lecture to business people. They are like, "No, wait a second. What does that look like?" First of all, there has to be a group, because, again, the proletariat is just not like this amorphous blob that's out there that magically does all these things. So you're going to need a regime. You're going to need a cadre of revolutionaries. You're going to need people in power to oversee the abolishment of the all right of inheritance.
- 4.45 And by abolishing it, that means all the money that you've saved in your life, although they've already abolished private property, but that's just another kind of contradiction. And then they've done taxes. So I guess you've saved this amount of money, and now you would like to bequeath, leave it to an heir, to your family. But now you can't because that's going to be abolished. So what's going to happen to that money?
- 4.46 Well, someone's got to come and take it out of the bank or from your home or under the mattress, and that someone would have to be a central authority with police, because you're probably not going to want to do this. And then they're going to have to put it in some giant national central bank or something of some sort. And then they're going to use that money, I guess, to redistribute all of that to people, however they want to do it.
- 4.47 If you think about this, too, at another level, this is such a basic right of people, the right to choose an heir. These folks, the communists, are already abolishing all this different stuff and depriving you of all these rights. And now, at some point in your life, you've saved up this money. What's wrong with you being able to pass it on to somebody when you die? Do they, Marx and the Marxists, talk about greed? Boy, talk about greed. These people are so greedy that they don't even want to let you keep your money.
- 4.48 How about government greed? This is a massive grab of all of your property, all of your savings, everything. And I'll say this to the young person in Manhattan in a Starbucks, who claims to be a Marxist and has a—"How would you like it if, when your parents pass on, you don't get any of their money at all? It just all goes straight to the single federal national authority, and everybody else's money as well does." Abolition of all right of inheritance. All right.
- 4.49 A few other points here in the 10-point plan. I won't hit every single one of them, but let's jump up to number five. "Centralization of credit in the hands of the state by means of a national bank with state capital and an exclusive monopoly." A national bank with an exclusive monopoly, centralization of all credit in the hands of the state. Modern Marxists, do you really want to—do you have any idea what that would look

like today? Maybe in 1848, but could you imagine America today, the banking system, all the people that work in banking and finance.

- 4.50** I'm from Pittsburgh, which is the home of PNC Bank. The baseball field for the Pirates is named after PNC. The "P" in PNC stands for Pittsburgh. PNC Bank employs 11,000 people in the Pittsburgh region. And by the way, quite a mix and diverse group, too. I have friends who work there who are conservatives, who work next to woke liberals and progressives. How would you like it if the government just came in and did, through a national bank, an exclusive monopoly on all credit and everything, just in one fell swoop?
- 4.51** And if you did this, too, you wouldn't have a hallmark of capitalism and free market economy, which is competition. You need different banks out there offering different rates and different loaning things. Think of all the options that you have if you want to get a loan for a car or to build a house. You wouldn't have that if you had a single-state exclusive monopoly, one single national bank on all capital. These guys, they ain't economists, I'll tell you that, or they're not very good ones, not very good at all. Think about the practical reality of what you're doing here.
- 4.52** Six. "Centralization of the means of communication and transport in the hands of the state." Number six. "Centralization of the means of communication and transport in the hands of the state." Another one where, all right, maybe if you're an 18-year-old in the class and you're just reading through all your assignments and you're burned out because your professor gave you 100 pages to read, and you might fall asleep while reading that, but that should wake you up in the middle of the night, right there. How are you going to centralize all the means of communication into the hands of the state, the ownership and the management of the state?
- 4.53** Now, in 1848, I don't know. Help me out, folks. What would communication have even been in 1848? There's no phones, obviously. There's no radio, no TV. There's newspapers. And the Bolsheviks, when they take over in Soviet Russia, they immediately take dozens and dozens of papers, of newspapers, because in those days, every major city had a half-dozen newspapers. I mean, that was the main means of communication. And they consolidated all of them into two, Pravda and Izvestia. "Pravda" meant truth in Russia, "izvestia" meant news. And the joke among the Soviet citizens was, there's no "pravda" in Pravda, there's no "izvestia" in Izvestia. But they took all of those and consolidated them, state control, to just Pravda and Izvestia.
- 4.54** And you got to wonder how diversity-loving leftists who are against fascism and big government and everything could possibly support an ideology that would call for "centralization of the means of communication into the hands of the state." You want the Donald Trump White House centralizing all communication in the United States? Crazy.

- 4.55 And in that same line, as if centralization of the means of communication isn't enough, they're going to add centralization of the means of transport into the hands of the state. So another doozy. Today, gosh, what would that be today? Airlines, railroads, busing, subways, well, your cars today, which is why, in 1848, doing this today is just utterly inconceivable and impossible. It should not ever even be talked about as something that you could ever possibly do today.
- 4.56 In 1848, what would it have been, transportation would have been? I don't know. Early trains. Transcontinental railroad is 1860s, maybe. Someone will fact-check me on that, that's fine. Yeah, shipping. It would be shipping. Maybe horse and buggy service, transportation? So maybe some of this could—by the way, I don't know why you would want to put it in the hands of the state to begin with. Why do you even have to do that, unless you have an obsessive philosophy that just wants to grab and manage and abolish everything?
- 4.57 And "who are these," to quote Milton Friedman, "who are these angels in the government that are going to be in charge of managing all of this so beautifully and brilliantly, that's going to do such a good job with it?" Why this great faith in these managers, in these planners? Reagan, in the October 1964 "A Time for Choosing" speech: "the more that the plans fail, the more that the planners plan." They just say, "Well, the problem is that we haven't planned enough yet. The problem is that you all haven't given us enough power yet. If you would just give up your stuff and put us in charge, we'll get it right next time."
- 4.58 Modern-day communists will often say, "Well, the problem with communism is it hasn't been tried properly yet." Stalin, aberration. Lenin, aberration. Khrushchev, aberration. Andropov, aberration. Mao, aberration. Pol Pot, aberration. Castro, aberration. All of Eastern Europe, aberration. On and on and on and on and on. And you would think that if it actually is this great idea, they would have at least one case where it worked, just one. They ought to have, like, 100. You would think that they would have at least one. But yes, centralization of transport in the hands of the state.
- 4.59 All right, seven, point seven in the 10-point plan of The Communist Manifesto. Here's a mouthful. "Extension of factories and instruments of production owned by the state." Again, just words that if you're an 18-year-old in class, it's kind of like [snoring], but "an extension of factories and instruments of production owned by the state." Got to grab those factories, got to grab those farms, got to grab those instruments of production. When you're going and defining what a society has that are termed instruments of production, that's a lot of stuff. That's a lot of industries. That's a lot of companies.
- 4.60 Have you seen Dr. Zhivago? There's a moment in Dr. Zhivago where the doctor has his house, and they take his house, and they put him and his wife—and he's a very benevolent, charitable individual—they eventually push them up into the top floor, and the house becomes like a collective, because how dare a wealthy person like him should own that? This is now common property. And then eventually, he gets tipped

off to leave. "You'd better get out of here now." And then eventually, he leaves. That's what that looks like in real practice.

- 4.61 "The bringing into cultivation, the improvement of the soil, generally, in accordance with a common plan." So, a common plan here for the soil, the cultivation of soil—the Soviets were notorious for what were called five-year plans. They had a common plan for everything, a five-year plan for agriculture, a five-year plan for coal, a five-year plan for steel. In the real world, in the free market, things don't work this way. Companies will have plans, but they're willing to change them instantaneously. They're constantly adjusting things because they're driven by the market.
- 4.62 So to imagine a single government—actually, what would it be? It's called a central planning bureau. That's what it is for the Soviets, where you would have millions, thousands, if not millions, of prices and production levels decided not by the free market and by people who own and run businesses, but by central planners in a bureau, trying to determine how much to charge for tomatoes, bolts, and nuts, and screwdrivers, and coal, and everything else.
- 4.63 Only really, this is the great Austrian economics scholar Ludwig von Mises, Friedrich Hayek in *The Road to Serfdom*, Ludwig von Mises in his book, *On Socialism*, he predicted that communism would collapse because there is so much information in the market that can only be decided day-to-day by the "invisible hand"—to use Adam Smith's phrase—of the market determining prices. No group of human beings could possibly have the collective knowledge, almost a supernatural power, to be able to sit in an office in the Kremlin and determine prices for an entire country, especially, by the way, a country that covered 12 time zones. The USSR was a big place.
- 4.64 You couldn't pull something off like this in the little borough in my hometown, all right? Let alone try—could you imagine today in the United States of America, trying to have something like that? Our modern-day democratic socialists, A.O.C., Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, who's with the DSA, the Democratic Socialists of America, before she ran as a Democrat, they have the Green New Deal. And the Green New Deal calls for certain forms of management of the economy in order for environmental purposes.
- 4.65 Remember how infamous that was, because it set limits on air travel, had people traveling by train? And you just knew right away it was going to be impossible. Try to do it. Forget it. Often, too, you think, if they're going to ban air travel, does AOC, does she really not want to get on a plane to fly from New York to California? When she escapes New York during COVID to go take her mask off, needed a restaurant in Florida, is she going to take a bus there? No. No, she's going to fly. You are going to take a bus there. She's going to fly.
- 4.66 Remember, socialism is for the ruled, not the rulers. The anointed who are in charge, these rules don't apply to them. They get their dacha on the Black Sea. They get their

money. Socialism is for the masses. Marxism is for the masses, not the masters. Different rules for them. They are the anointed.

- 4.67** Point eight in the 10-point plan. "Equal obligation of all to work. Establishment of industrial armies, especially for agriculture." First thing you do in the playbook when you become a Communist and a ruler, you got control of a country, is you nationalize agriculture. You collectivize agriculture. And by the way, there might even be a note in the playbook that says, by the way, this isn't going to work, and millions are going to starve to death, but you got to do it because it's what you do as a Communist.
- 4.68** Mao's Great Leap Forward, Cultural Revolution. Tens of millions, 30 million, 40 million people starved to death. Pol Pot, the starvation. The Ukraine starvation through the collectivization of agriculture under Stalin in the 1930s. It never works. But go back to the lead here in point eight. "Equal obligation of all to work." We talked about this a couple of lectures ago, and I said they're all about the workers and defending the proletariat and the working class, but they're not soft on the workers. You have, damn it, you have an equal obligation to work.
- 4.69** This isn't calling for equal employment or equal opportunity. Everybody's got to work, and that includes the women-power in the country. So if you're a Soviet mom, read Alexandra Kollontai on this, or Lenin's wife on this. Read my article, it was for American Spectator, on International Women's Day and the founders of International Women's Day, which was started by the communists in the Soviet Union, International Women's Day. I write an article every year for American Spectator on the subject of International Women's Day. People have no idea what the roots of it are.
- 4.70** But they were all about pushing women into the workforce, pushing them into the factories, pushing them into the farms. The daycare taking care of children would become a state affair, as Marx and Engels wrote in *The Origin of the Family*, published in 1884. So, for women who want the choice to not have to go into the factories or farms, or to stay home or whatever and educate their kids at home, remember what they said earlier in this book? "But, you say, we ban all education."
- 4.71** In fact, let me hit that again. "But, you will say, we destroy the most hallowed of relations when we replace home education by social." You're not going to be home-educating your kids. You're going to be putting them in the free public schools. Point 10—we'll get to that in a couple of minutes. So you all have an equal obligation to work, and if you don't work, you are a work shirker, which is a crime in the Soviet system, in the communist world. You are a parasite living off of society. There's no mercy.
- 4.72** The Soviets would say in the 1980s, "Ronald Reagan, you have all this homelessness in America. We have no homelessness in Moscow." Well, of course. Or if you do, you round them up and send them off to wherever. You're not just going to hang out and live in Gorky Park and do whatever. You have an equal obligation to work, comrade.

- 4.73 We've got two left: number nine. This is one of my favorites. It's so awful. It's just so awful. "Combination of agriculture with manufacturing industries." All right, whatever. But here it is, and this is a mouthful. But again, the 18-year-old has fallen asleep because they have 100 pages to read. "Gradual abolition"—here we go again, guys. Are you keeping a list? What are we abolishing now? This is a really novel one. "Gradual abolition of all the distinction between town and country." Pause. "Gradual abolition of all the distinction between town and country."
- 4.74 Right off, we say, "I don't even know what the sentence is going to be here, guys, but how are we going to do that? How are you going to gradually abolish the distinction between town and country? I mean, right now, we're recording this in Phoenix. This is a big major city. This is a big town. Are you going to abolish the distinction between this and Scottsdale and Tucson and Tempe and some rural area, whatever? How are we going to do that? They have an answer. They continue.
- 4.75 "Gradual abolition of all the distinction between town and country by a more equitable distribution." Now, here's the word distribution, finally. Oh, good. We love to redistribute money. "A more equitable distribution of the population over the country." They want a more equitable distribution of the population over the country, in order to abolish the distinction between town and country. What do you mean by that? How are you going to do that?
- 4.76 We're going to more equally distribute the population, you're going to have to move them out of their houses and more equitably redistribute them in a way that gradually abolishes the distinction between town and country. So they don't want to just redistribute your stuff, your money, your income, even your land. They want to redistribute you, spread you out there more equally.
- 4.77 And by the way—I should look at the camera here—the Marxist in Manhattan, who's there at the Starbucks, doing activism against those hayseeds in the Midwest who voted for Donald Trump, guess what? We're moving you out there because we need you to have a more equitable distribution in the country. We're moving you out of your beloved city, so you can be out there in the rural areas in MAGA country, because we need a more equitable distribution of the population all around the country.
- 4.78 Francis Wheen, the Marxist biographer who I quote a couple of times in previous lectures who said, "It's absurd to blame Marx for the guns and the gulags," you're not going to do that by force? You're just going to go and tell them to get up and leave, get out of their homes, off their property? I know you've lived your life in Berkeley or Boston or Philadelphia, but part of our great vision for the world is a more equitable distribution of the population across the country and a gradual abolition of the distinction between town and country. We're moving you out of Boston, and Berkeley, and Portland, and we're going to put you out in the middle of the Midwest. This is all part of the new world, the New Jerusalem. That was point nine.

- 4.79 Point 10, the final point in the 10-point plan. They must have really thought about this one, too. "Free education for all children in public schools." Now, you're going to need to replace home education by social and take the kids out there and get them away from their parents; as they said, the disgusting clap-trap about the hallowed correlation between parent and child. Get them away from their parents. Get them away from their churches. Get them all in the educational collective where they can learn Marxism.
- 4.80 In the next lecture, I'm going to quote from Lenin's 1920s speech to the All-Russian Congress, who says that the goal of the current generation of communists must be to teach communism. So put them all in there, so they can learn this stuff, so they could learn the new world, so they could be the disciples, the progenitor of this new world. Also shows, again, what economic ignoramuses as they are. Free education, there's no such thing as free education, just like there's no such thing as free health care.
- 4.81 It's not like you go down to Washington, DC, and, oh, here's the Department of Education. Here's the money trees that grow outside the Department of Education. And you shake them and you get big bushel baskets and collect all the money, and you use that to pay for education. Where you go to the Department of Health and Human Services, and the money just grows out of the ground there. You just scoop it up, you put it in there, and you use that free money to pay for health care for everybody.
- 4.82 No, you pay for it. You pay for it through your tax dollars. Anybody who's 19 and at that Starbucks in Manhattan that I'm talking about, renting or whatever you do—and I know the rent there is terrible, I get it, I feel for you. But once you buy a house, because you have the right in America to buy a house, you'll get hit with something called property taxes, which in the New York City area, probably \$30,000, \$40,000 a year that you're going to be shelling out, simply on top of what you're already paying, paid for your house, what you're paying in interest rates.
- 4.83 That money, which goes from your pocketbook away from you and goes to the state, they use that to pay for free education. So free public education, it's not free, you're paying for it. Maybe you think it's free because when you walked through the door as a 12-year-old, you didn't write a check or swipe your credit card when you walked through the door. But it's paid for. It's paid for by tax dollars. So free education for all children in public schools.
- 4.84 That's the 10-point plan. Pretty extraordinary. Again, for the young people who say, "The Communist Manifesto is a pretty good book, if you just read it. It talks about sharing the wealth and loving your neighbor." Yeah? Read it. Read the 10-point plan and think about it. Very telling, in the beginning of the 10 points, they preface the 10 points by saying, "Of course, in the beginning, this cannot be effected except by means of despotic inroads." They realized you're going to need despotism to do this.

- 4.85 Another word for despotism: tyranny. In order to have tyranny, you're going to need tyrants. In order to have despotism, you're going to need despots. You're going to need people in charge that are running this show and enforcing all of this and making it happen. You're going to need a regime, which is what communism produced in every country that became communist, because those were the people in charge who tried to enact various elements of the 10-point plan and this book in general.
- 4.86 All right, we'll finish up the Manifesto. As I said, when I teach this at the college where I teach every spring, we spend about three or four weeks reading the Manifesto, so here we're just doing two lectures on it. But jumping to the end of the book, the close of the Manifesto, everybody remembers the phrase, "Workers of the world, unite!" It's probably the most famous line in the book. The other line is, "Workers, you have nothing to lose but your chains."
- 4.87 The beginning of Patrisse Cullors' memoir, Patrisse Cullors is the co-founder of Black Lives Matter, who calls herself an abolitionist, and she calls herself, she said, "Alicia and I, my co-founder, we are trained Marxists. We are super-versed in ideological theories." She opens her book with a quote from Assata Shakur, who had fled America and was living in Castro's Cuba, and was a Marxist. She opens the book with that line, "We have nothing to lose but our chains." So she opens it with that Marxist line.
- 4.88 So everybody remembers that. "Workers of the world, unite!" We have, "Workers, you have nothing to lose but your chains." The proletariats have nothing to lose but their chains. They have a world to win. In the next lecture, we'll pick up with that world-to-win mission of the communists in the next lecture.
- 4.89 But more important, back up a few paragraphs. Here are these two really telling lines. In short, Marx and Engels wrote, "The communists everywhere support every revolutionary movement against the existing social and political order of things." That's quite a thought. Communists everywhere support every—these guys do this all the time. Every, every, every. All, all, all. Again, they're not tinkerers. They don't even say, like, "many of us communists support the injustices in society." No. "Communists everywhere support every revolutionary movement against the existing social and political order of things."
- 4.90 I've seen many times over the years, because I watch these guys, I follow their websites, Communist Party USA, which is cpusa.org, People's World, peoplesworld.org, if you just follow them, you can see their activism and what they're up to. It's like, wow, what are the communists doing in Ferguson, Missouri? Why are the communists there at the George Floyd thing? The first time that I saw the acronym LGBTQIA+, I thought, I don't know what that means. I know what LGBTQ means. I don't know what IA+ means. Plus became the add-on for everything. I meant intersex, A meant asexual. First time that I saw that was in People's World.

- 4.91 Also, the first time I saw strong advocacy for same-sex marriage was in American communist publications. The entire Congress in 1995, including Democrats and Republicans alike, passed the Defense of Marriage Act, defining marriage as between one man and one woman. Bill and Hillary Clinton both supported it. Bill Clinton was President at the time. I wrote a book on Hillary Clinton, on her faith, called *God and Hillary Clinton*. Hillary Clinton called herself an old-fashioned Methodist who was against redefining marriage and defined marriage as between one man and one woman.
- 4.92 She flipped in 2012, the same year that Obama flipped, when Obama was running for re-election and she was planning to run in 2016. Not to say that they were politically motivated; I think they probably actually believe it. But now the entire Democratic Party has completely flipped on that issue from where they were. Between Obergefell in 2015 and the Defense of Marriage Act, 20 years earlier, they did a complete 180. But that happened in 2015, 2016.
- 4.93 The communists were way out in front on that. Why? Because if they could get on board for some kind of an idea that would do something like redefine marriage, redefine the family, redefine gender, something that revolutionary, they're going to support that. They're going to support any revolutionary movement that goes against the existing social and political order of things. I could talk about this for an hour. I've done a lot of research on it.
- 4.94 Communists used to be militantly, brutally anti-gay. I mean, they locked them up in nut houses, insane asylums, in Castro's Cuba. The Soviets were really against it. Harry Hay, in the United States, who's known as the founder of gay communism in the United States, had to leave the party, the American Communist Party. They were totally against that stuff. Now, all of a sudden, in the early 2000s, boom, they completely flipped.
- 4.95 I think they flipped because they saw this as a revolutionary movement that could help redefine the existing social and political order of things. Remember, they're completely against traditional ideas and traditional relations. They know that much. So traditional marriage, traditional gender roles, they're all about redefining those if it helps them undermine the existing social-political order of things.
- 4.96 Final point here in the Manifesto. This is the last paragraph before the line, "Working men of all countries, unite!" And this one, too, should really make you, well, to quote Marx and Engels, "tremble." "The communists disdain to conceal their views and aims." That's what Marx and Engels said. We no longer want to conceal our views and aims. "They," or we, Marx and Engels, "openly declare that their ends can be attained only by the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions." Their ends can be attained only —only!—by the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions. Everything. That's the only way. By force, by overthrow, of all. Not just, again, the injustices, maybe a bad tax rate, maybe. No, no, no, no, all. All means all, existing social conditions.

- 4.97 "Let the ruling classes tremble at a communist revolution. The proletarians have nothing to lose but their chains. They have a world to win. Working men of all countries, unite!" And let the ruling classes tremble, which is why they began this book by saying that a specter is haunting Europe, the specter of communism.
- 4.98 All the powers of old Europe have entered into a holy alliance to exorcise this specter—Pope and Tsar, Metternich and Guizot, French radicals, German police spies. Communism is already acknowledged by all European powers to be a power itself. So it's high time that we communists should openly, in the face of the world, publish their views. And let it be known, we are not going to conceal our views. We are calling for the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions. That's what the Manifesto is about, not about loving your neighbor. It's about that.
- 4.99 Kind of long, but if we look at The Communist Manifesto as a whole, it's already hard to imagine it applied to the US. But the ideological conclusion or instate was a global communist state.
- 4.100 Yeah, fantastic. That's exactly what we're going to talk about next, and it's crucial because they feel that—I've talked to modern communists who say, "Well, yeah, it won't work for the Soviet Union if it has to compete against the rapacious United States." That's why the whole world needs to be communist. Then you have no competition here among the countries, with the ruthless capitalists burying the communists. If the whole world will work at this, then it'll work. So that's the key. We've got to dream on. We've got to get the whole world to do it. The problem here, again, is all of you folks, that you won't just hand over that power and your property, and let them bring us this heaven on earth.
- 4.101 It seems Paris was a very popular meeting place for Marxists. Do we know if it was one of many locations, or if there was something specifically going on in Paris which was drawing them there?
- 4.102 Oh, I love that question. I could do a whole hour on this. Paris was a hub. Paris was a hub. It really goes back to, in particular, I could say a lot more, but the French Revolution, 1793, 1794, the storming of the Bastille, the Jacobins, Maximilien Robespierre taking over. I had a professor at the University of Pittsburgh named Don Goldstein, who co-authored the book *At Dawn, We Slept*. He was one of the student assistants who helped write the book about Pearl Harbor. He used to call the Jacobins the first communists, which they weren't, but I understand the point.
- 4.103 And among other things, the Jacobins were totally against religion. They were all about redefining human nature. And communism really is a totalitarian ideology that, at its core, is about transforming human nature. The Jacobins went so far as to, in declaring war on religion, they even tried to eliminate the Christian calendar. So seven-day weeks were turned into 10-day weeks, in order to eliminate the very notion of the Lord's Day

and Day Seven. They renamed the year. They declared war on the calendar. 1794 was renamed the year zero. They were starting over again.

- 4.104** Now, a group of Southeast Asia people who all went to Paris and met in Paris was Pol Pot and the Khmer Rouge. Pol Pot, Saloth Sar, was this innocent young student who went to Paris to study radio electricity and comes back this raving Marxist. They learned that junk there in Paris. They came back and, with their Khmer Rouge, they rechristened the year 1975, the year zero. So very much like the Jacobins did.
- 4.105** By the way, we're declaring war on the Christian calendar in America here today. AD is no longer anno domini, it's what? Current era, C-E. B-C, before Christ, is now B-C-E, before current era. People are so slippery and sneaky that they find a way to keep the acronym a little bit close. And by the way, they still date it based on the birth of Christ, which is an interesting thing that they're doing. But yeah, so a lot of it, Paris was just this intellectual hotbed. Marx and Engels were not French, but they met in Paris, and it became this gathering place.
- 4.106** Marx really did his work in Paris, Brussels. Did it in Brussels in the shadow of the great cathedral of Saint Michael the Archangel, which I think is a chilling thing. Michael the Archangel, the prayer to Michael the Archangel is, "Michael the Archangel, defend us in battle. Be our protection against the wickedness and snares of the devil. May God rebuke him, we humbly pray. Do thou, Prince of the heavenly host, by the power of God, cast into hell Satan and all his evil spirits who prowl about the world, seeking the ruin of souls." And the great cathedral of Michael the Archangel, Marx is literally writing the Manifesto in the shadow of that cathedral. And he was raised in Trier, in the shadow of the cathedral in Trier. So the religious underpinnings of all of this are so remarkable. It's frightening at times.
- 4.107** Is there a place where a degree of state economic intervention is beneficial?
- 4.108** Yeah, yeah, good. So I'm not against state intervention. In fact, people often ask me, what's my philosophy on this stuff? I'm a general, limited government, conservative, kind of Kirk, Burke, Russell Kirk, Edmund Burke. I call myself a Reagan-Kirk conservative.
- 4.109** I did a book called 11 Principles of a Reagan Conservative, where I lay out a lot of this stuff. That's a short book. Not as short as this, but it's a short book. One of my favorite statements on this is the 1991 encyclical by John Paul II, called Centesimus Annus. I could spell that for you, well, for the cameras. Centesimus is C-E-N-T-E-S-I-M-U-S, and it means 100 years. It refers to the 100th anniversary of Rerum Novarum, the Leo XIII encyclical from 1891, which condemned socialism repeatedly. The other one, Quadragesimus Anno, which came out 40 years, 1931, under Pope Pius XI, that's the one that says, "A Christian cannot be at the same time a Christian and a socialist." They are contradictory terms.
- 4.110** But Centesimus Annus by John Paul II, he grew up under communism in Poland. He hated communism. He knew what it was. But he also understood that free market

systems weren't perfect. And he really feared a post-communist world in which a West that mercifully defeated communism and Marxism and Marxist materialism and atheism would fall into kind of like a Western secular commercialism and materialism, where an idolatry of the free market, where we didn't take care of people and didn't understand that the state can have a limited government role.

4.111 I get this from Conservatives all the time, who think that conservatism is anti-government. It's not. It's about limited government. So I think society has a role. And Europe has social democracies. They're doing the social democracy rather than democratic socialism, which is a very different thing. I'll probably talk about that, I think, in the last lecture in this course.

Lecture 5: Revolution Abroad

At a glance — Revolution abroad — communism in power.

- 5.1 Welcome back. In this lecture, we're going to talk about communism actually taking hold in Soviet Russia, and with it beginning to go global at this point.
- 5.2 But I did want to pick up from the last lecture because I had mentioned the encyclicals like *Quadragesimo Anno*, *Centesimus Annus*, and I happened to have a handout in my bag with a couple of quotes from some of these, so I figured I'd share a couple of them with you.
- 5.3 Remember, we had mentioned *Qui Pluribus*, which was the Pius IX encyclical in 1846, two years before *The Communist Manifesto* came out. But I mentioned in the last lecture, Pius XI did *Quadragesimo Anno*—we'll put that up on the screen, the spelling of it—that came out in 1931, so that's 40 years after *Rerum Novarum*. It had this statement: "Religious socialism, Christian socialism are contradictory terms. No one can be at the same time—" Now, he's a pope, so he's Catholic, but he could be Christian, too. "No one could be at the same time a good Catholic, a good Christian, and a true socialist." So religious socialism, Christian socialism are contradictory terms.
- 5.4 As I noted in the previous lectures, Bukharin and the others said that religion and communism are incompatible. We must take on religion at the tip of the bayonet. So the communists said that. The people today in our churches today who say, "Oh, you can be a Christian still." The founders themselves would tell them that they're wrong. So quit saying that to your congregation. Actually, they might welcome it because they're like, "Hey, if this was what it takes to dupe the people and bring them in, that's great." I wrote a whole book, by the way, called *Dupes*, which came out in 2010. A big part of it was this dupery that happens with people among the religious left.
- 5.5 Then this, though—and I especially like this from *Quadragesimo Anno*. Pius XI said, "Those who want to be apostles among socialists simply ought to profess Christian truth, whole and entire, openly and sincerely. They should not connive at error in any way. If they truly wish to be heralds of the Christian gospel, let them above all strive to show socialists that socialist claims, so far as and if they are just, are far more strongly supported by the principles of Christian faith and much more effectively promoted through the power of Christian charity."
- 5.6 In other words, when I was an evangelical, we had this phrase, WWJD, what would Jesus do? Not what would Marx do, WWMD. Marx would abolish everything, including religion and morality. As you see with the Bolsheviks, they would abolish churches. If you want to love your neighbor, if you want to help the poor, just follow the Christian gospel. Just because Marx writes, "From each according to his ability, to each according to his needs," and there's a statement like that in Acts 4:32 to 4:35, doesn't mean you should suddenly start following Marx instead. Follow the Beatitudes, follow the Ten

Commandments. That stuff was written thousands of years earlier. There's no reason to connive at error over it.

- 5.7 There's also, Leo XIII had written another encyclical called—Leo XIII was the Rerum Novarum pope, 1878-1903. He's the one that, of course, the current Pope Leo XIV took his name from. He wrote an encyclical called Quod Apostolici Muneris—we'll put that up on the screen, too—in December 1878. He defined communism as a fatal plague. A later encyclical, Divini Redemptoris, in 1937, would define it as a Satanic scourge. They actually argued that this comes from the pit of hell, this ideology.
- 5.8 Leo XIII said, "We speak of that sect of men who, under various and almost barbarous names, are called socialists, communists, or nihilists, and who spread over all the world, bound together by a wicked confederacy, no longer seek the shelter of secret meetings, but they are now openly and boldly marching forth in the light of day." Marx and Engels had said, "It is a long time that we declare publicly and openly our aims, and here they are."
- 5.9 Then Leo XIII said this—and for people who might have thought this was hyperbole, remember, this is how The Communist Manifesto ends—these communists, these socialists, "they strive to bring what they have been long planning—that is the overthrow of all civil society." As we know from their document, from their Manifesto, that's what they wanted to do. They concluded it by calling for the forcible overthrow of all the existing order. So this guy isn't exaggerating. This guy who wrote this read the book. Unfortunately, people today who say positive things about communism don't read the book. But if you read the book, you'll see that it does call for the overthrow of all civil society.
- 5.10 The overthrowers in chief, here they come. So, The Communist Manifesto, published in February 1848, it's going to take about 70 years, about seven decades, for it to be put into power. The group that spearheads this revolution, that gets it in place in a country, is not in Germany, not in France, not in Belgium, not in Britain, but in Russia, of all places, in Soviet Russia. The trio, the troika, who spearheads this revolution, was Vladimir Lenin, Leon Trotsky, and Joseph Stalin.
- 5.11 Stalin would outlive all the others. Stalin had Trotsky murdered in 1940, as I said in the last lecture. Stalin himself would die in an agonizing, frightening death, March 5th, 1953. Lenin died in 1924 at the age of 53. It's still mysterious as to what exactly he died from, but probably something akin to a cerebral hemorrhage. But he died obviously much younger than he thought that he would.
- 5.12 The Bolsheviks, so their revolution comes in October, November 1917. I could give a whole lecture on this, but obviously I won't because I don't have time. But what really allows for the Bolsheviks to take Russia is World War I— 1914 to 1918, the war lasted. Russia, the last Tsar, Tsar Nicholas II, would have been on our side in the war because

America comes in, as I said in the last lecture, in April 1917. That's right after the time that the Tsar abdicates during that period.

- 5.13 Russia is losing more people in World War I than any other country. The Russians always lose more than any other country. They lost more people in World War II than any other country. In Ukraine, they're losing an entire generation of young Russian men. They always have enormous numbers of fatalities, casualties, killed in action. Crazy numbers.
- 5.14 So it's World War I that precipitates this, creates the chaos in Russia that allows for, eventually, the abdication of the Tsar, the fall of the Tsar, the Bolshevik Revolution to take place, 1917, 1918. Once the Bolsheviks have their revolution, the October Revolution, there's a civil war that erupts in Russia, which is typically what happens in these communist countries. With China, the communists, Mao Zedong, take over China. October 1949, that follows a Chinese Civil War from 1946 to 1949. It's always these awful, horrific bloodletting events that seem to precipitate even greater evil in the scheme of things.
- 5.15 The Russian Civil War lasts from 1918 to 1921 between the Bolsheviks and the Mensheviks. The whole world was watching this very carefully. Our President, Woodrow Wilson, the Progressive's Progressive, who I was very critical of in the last lecture. But Woodrow Wilson understood how bad the Bolsheviks were. Part of this with Wilson—I write about this in my book *Dupes*. I have a few chapters on Woodrow Wilson. Wilson was a devout Calvinist, a five-point Calvinist, strongly committed to reform theology. He knew how atheistic these guys were.
- 5.16 Wilson tried to tell his fellow progressives, who were excited about this great experiment that they saw developing in Soviet Russia. He tried to tell them, "No, look, draw a line there. You might favor greater government, administrative state, progressivism, child labor laws in the United States." But the Bolsheviks— he and Winston Churchill at the time and others called them brutes, barbarians, savages. Every name that you could think of, they knew that these guys were an altogether different beast.
- 5.17 The Russian Civil War goes from 1918 to 1921. According to the historian W. Bruce Lincoln, who, in the late 1980s, wrote one of the first major, I think, books on the Russian Civil War and the end of the Soviet Union with information being released from the Soviet archives, he estimated that seven million Russian men, women, and children died in that war. Seven million. To give you a sense of the numbers here, what's the bloodiest conflict in the history of America that we were ever involved in? Anyone know? Our Civil War, 1861-1865. We lost about 600,000 in that war. Latest numbers on this, it might be close to 700,000.
- 5.18 By the way, for the United States, that was higher than all the combined death losses in all other wars in American history. The American Revolution, World War I, World War

II, Korean War, Vietnam, Gulf War—you've got to combine all of those to get close to what we lost in the American Civil War. So the American Civil War: 600,000-700,000 dead. Russian Civil War: seven million dead. Ten times that number. Russians always outdo everybody with these numbers.

- 5.19** So seven million altogether, and their reward after all this suffering is a Bolshevik victory. The communists win. Lenin won. That's what they end up with. With that, Lenin spearheads his version of Marxist ideology, which is known as Marxism-Leninism. It becomes known as Marxism-Leninism. Lenin in books like *The State and Revolution*, which he started writing in 1917, never fully completed it. Lenin believed that he was the one anointed gatekeeper who truly understood Marx.
- 5.20** A lot of these other people, this typical language of Lenin as it was of Marx, too: "Philistines, louts, idiots, morons. They don't understand Marx at all. I understand Marx." So what Lenin puts in place becomes known as Marxism-Leninism. They put together, eventually, the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics, which really develops in 1922. So you go from Tsarist Russia to Russia, Soviet Russia, to eventually the USSR, the Soviet Union, the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics.
- 5.21** But as they put it—as Lenin put it, too—communism would proceed through different stages: from feudalism to capitalism to socialism to communism. Eventually, here, institutions such as property, the family, religion, the state, even money, would wither away, as Engels put it, or they would have to end up simply abolishing these things. You see this with Lenin.
- 5.22** I've had people email me over the years—and I probably will after this course, too—"No, you don't understand. What Marx and these guys are talking about with abolition was more of a withering away, a disappearing, a vanishing." As you see from all people that implement Marxism, they go for the word abolish. They abolish the churches, they abolish religion, they abolish private property. So they have a very different interpretation of what Marx was saying here.
- 5.23** Lenin himself explained the difference between socialism and communism. This is good. This is very valuable. I think everybody should know this. Marion Smith, who had been with the Victims of Communism Memorial Foundation, used to say, "As the Christian aspires to heaven, the socialist aspires to communism." That's the earthly utopia. That's the New Jerusalem.
- 5.24** I hear young people say, "Well, I'm a socialist, but I'd never be a communist. I would never go that—or I'm a democratic socialist." I'll say that Lenin talked about democracy. Lenin talked about socialism. But here's how Lenin defined it. "And that brings us," wrote Lenin, "to the question of the scientific distinction between socialism and communism." They use the word science all the time. They felt they were very exacting. Remember, as Engels said about Marx, "Marx is doing for the social sciences

what Darwin did for the biological sciences." So the Soviets used this word all the time, scientific socialism. They believed it was the exacting in that way.

- 5.25** So here's Lenin defining it for us. "What is usually called socialism was termed by Marx the first or lower phase of communist society." Here's another key statement involving this: "In so far as the means of production become common property, the word 'communism' is also applicable here, providing we do not forget that this is not complete communism." Socialism, too, is about common ownership of the means of production. So is communism. But the socialist needs to go all the way to get to complete communism. So socialism is a transitional phase to that final step of communism.
- 5.26** Here is the universally accepted definition of socialism. If people go online right now and type into Google, "definition of socialism"—unfortunately, that's being messed with a lot today, even like words like gender and family and all this other stuff is. But Merriam-Webster says that socialism is government ownership of the means of production. Lenin would say that so is communism, provided that we understand that you need to get to complete communism. Socialism also believes in common ownership of the means of production, as long as you eventually get to complete communism.
- 5.27** Lenin gave a speech in 1920 to the Communist Youth League, and this is an extraordinary statement. I'm going to quote from it quite a bit. You could find it online at marxists.org. It was written on October 2nd, 1920. If you just Google Lenin, "The Tasks of the Youth Leagues," and go to marxists.org, it's also often referred to as Lenin's Speech to the Third All-Russian Congress of the Russian Young Communist League, but I would just type in Lenin's Speech, Communist Youth League, 1920. You'll find it easily.
- 5.28** So this is a major oration by Lenin in the day. The Third All-Russian Congress of the Russian Communist League took place in Moscow, the first week of October 1920. It's attended by about 600 delegates. These are all on fire, young communists. This is immediately published in Pravda, October 5th, 6th, and 7th, 1920. As I said, Pravda becomes the official house organ publication mouthpiece of the Soviet Union. So he wants everybody to hear this. He wants everyone to hear this message.
- 5.29** So any course on Marxism, I think, should know this as well, especially because you see his sense of morality as he defines it. "Comrades, today I would like to talk on the fundamental tasks of the Young Communist League, and in this connection on what the youth organizations in a socialist republic should look like in general." Now, he immediately talks about "destroying the foundations of the old." That's in the second paragraph.
- 5.30** Third paragraph, what's this all about? Learn. You need to learn. In the fourth paragraph, he calls for "the transformation of the old capitalist society. Communist society cannot be conducted on the old lines." Now, you see here, this is very much

Marx thinking. We're going to change everything. "The teaching, training, and education of the youth must proceed from the material that has been left to us by the old society. Only by radically remolding the teaching can we have the creation of a society that will be unlike the old society." So they want to completely throw out the old, change the new.

- 5.31** "The science of communism created by Marx in the doctrine of Marxism." And he says here, "Marx was a genius." I read Marx, I'm like, this guy is anything but a genius. But Lenin is like, "Wow, this guy." Well, Trotsky said, I quoted Trotsky in an earlier lecture: "Marx and Darwin, they unlocked for me the key to the universe, intoxicated by their thought." So they were really taken by this.
- 5.32** Lenin says here of Marx—and keep in mind, this is the first implementer of Marx in the Soviet Union—"Marx critically reshaped everything that had been created by human society without ignoring a single detail." I don't know about that, by the way, that Marx didn't ignore a single detail. Then again, if you just say "we're going to forcibly overthrow everything that exists," I suppose that does cover everything.
- 5.33** "He reconsidered, subjected to criticism, verified on the working class movement, everything that human thinking had created." Lenin gets it here. He realizes what a true revolutionary Marx was. These two are of the same mind. "We must not borrow the system of encumbering young people's minds with an immense amount of knowledge, nine-tenths of which was useless and one-tenth distorted." Marx did this thing, too. "Nine-tenths of your private property is already abolished anyway." So they're very good at saying this.
- 5.34** "The old schools produce servants needed by the capitalists. The old schools turned men of science into men who had to write and say whatever pleased the capitalists. We must, therefore, abolish them." Here we go—abolish, abolition. Hey, Lenin read Marx. What's the song by Don McLean, American Pie? "When Lenin read a book on Marx, dirges in the dark, the day the music died. Lenin read a book on Marx."
- 5.35** We have "harboring an absolutely justified and necessary hatred for the old schools." Lenin used the word hate all the time. Lenin, in one quote, said, "We must teach the youth to hate, to hate their parents." Hate their parents if their parents are against communism. My colleague, Mark Hendrickson, uses the phrase, "Love that hate." Love that hate. They love that hate when that hate was employed for them in their service of abolition. "That is the way the main task should be presented when we speak of them, which is to learn communism." That's his message here today to these people. Learn communism. You young people, learn this. Not learn the Scriptures, not learn Aristotle, not learn. Learn communism.
- 5.36** The new generation, your duty. You have a duty to "build up a communist society. The ground has been cleared, and on this ground, the younger communist generation must build a communist society. That is the task that you should pursue in educating,

training, and rousing the entire younger generation." This is almost like he's sending them out into the mission field. You are the apostles, you are good. This is the Great Commission here by Lenin. You have to go out and destroy the old, start the new. "You must be foremost among the millions of builders of a communist society in whose ranks every young man and young woman should be." Every. Just like Marx: every, everything, abolish, all.

- 5.37** "This naturally brings me to the question of how we should teach communism and what the specific features of our method should be. I, first of all, shall deal here with the question of communist ethics." That should have you. Communist ethics? What are those? Here we go.
- 5.38** "You must train yourselves to be communists. It is the task of the Youth League to organize its practical activities in such a way that by learning, organizing, uniting, and fighting, its members shall train both themselves and all those who look to it for leadership, it should train communists. The entire purpose of training, educating, and teaching the youth of today should be to imbue them with communist ethics." But is there such a thing as communist ethics? Is there such a thing as communist morality? Remember, in the Manifesto, Marx and Engels had that statement about abolishing all religion, all morality, all truths.
- 5.39** But Lenin says, "Of course there is. It is often suggested that we have no ethics of our own. Very often, the bourgeoisie accuse us, communists, of rejecting all morality." You guys said you were throwing out all traditional ideas. "This is a method of confusing the issue, of throwing dust in the eyes of the workers and the peasants."
- 5.40** So in what sense do we reject ethics, reject morality? Here's the answer. "In the sense that it is given to us by the bourgeoisie, who based ethics on God's commandments." On this point, we, of course, say the quote, ready? "We do not believe in God." "We do not believe in God." Here again, another message for sister social justice or pastor social justice is that you should be Christian communists, right? "We do not believe in God. We reject any morality based on extra-human and extra-class concepts. We say that our morality is entirely subordinated to the interests of the proletariat's class struggle. Our morality stems from the interests of the class struggle of the proletariat."
- 5.41** Ronald Reagan, in one of his first speeches as president in 1981, said that the Soviets "lie, they steal, they cheat." He said that they themselves said that the only morality that they recognize is that which furthers class interests. Everything is moral that's done in the name of advancing class interests, including, as Reagan put it, "to lie, to cheat, to steal, to kill." And at the time that that happened, people said, "Reagan's just making this stuff up. Where is he getting this from? Like the John Birch Society or something?"
- 5.42** It's right here in Lenin's speech to the Youth Congress. "Our morality stems from the interest of the class struggle of the proletariat. The old society, we had to destroy all

that and overthrow them. But to do that, we had to create unity. That is something that God cannot create." Sounds like Mikhail Bakunin here.

- 5.43 Here's the quote that basically was verbatim what Reagan said, "To us, morality is subordinated to the interests of the proletariat's class struggle. What does that struggle consist in? In overthrowing the Tsar, overthrowing the capitalists, and abolishing the capitalist class." Again and again and again. "Our communist morality is also subordinated to that task. We say," he'll say it again, "morality is what serves to destroy the old exploiting society and to unite all the working people around the proletariat, which is building up a new communist society."
- 5.44 What he's basically saying here, too, is whatever it needs to be done to advance the proletariat and destroy the old society and overthrow the Tsar, the capitalist class, that's justified. That is communist morality. It's not based on God's commandments, because as he says, "We do not believe in God." So they're creating their own morality, like what Marx said in his "opiate of the masses" essay: they're revolving around their own sun. They're creating their own morality based on advancing class interests.
- 5.45 He's going to say it again, over and over. "Communist morality is that which serves this struggle and unites the working people against all exploitation, against all petty private property. For petty property puts into the hands of one person, that which has been created by the labor of the whole society." Again, "When people tell us about morality," us being communists, Communist Youth League, "we say this: to a communist, all morality lies in this united discipline and conscious mass struggle against the exploiters."
- 5.46 Then this line, "We do not believe in an eternal morality." "We do not believe in an eternal morality." What did he say earlier? "We do not believe in God." He says, "We do not believe in an eternal morality. Communist morality is based on the struggle for the consolidation and completion of communism." To borrow from Reagan: whatever is moral is that which advances communist interests. Pure relativism.
- 5.47 This thinking is so dangerous because it is effectively saying, even if he doesn't say it, that if you have to use the guns and the gulags and everything to advance communism, everything is moral that's in the interest of advancing the proletariat. Killing? Like we said, we do not believe in God's commandments. "Thou shalt not kill." We don't believe in that. Is that an eternal truth? We do not believe in eternal morality. It says it all here in this single speech.
- 5.48 He says this on and on throughout the speech. I'll just conclude with his call for them to go out into the mission field. The Young Communists, "The members of the League should use"—and does this not sound like a religious calling? "The members of this League," this Young Communist League, "should use every spare hour to improve the vegetable gardens, to organize the education of young people at some factory, and so on."

- 5.49 "The Young Communist League must combine its education, learning, and training with the labor of the workers and peasants so as not to confine itself to the schools or to just reading communist books and pamphlets. Only working side by side with the workers and peasants can one become a genuine communist." This is why they go out into the field and they organize and go to the factories. This is a religious calling.
- 5.50 Reagan, again: Marxism-Leninism, that religion of theirs. Go and spread this gospel. This generation should know that the entire purpose of their lives is to build a communist society. That is your purpose. The entire purpose of your life is to build a communist society.
- 5.51 These apostles would go out and they would do it, and they would die for it, and they would kill people for it. The entire purpose of your life is to build a communist society. By the way, in order to get into that mindset, you guys, you got to do what? You've got to abolish the old truly, because certainly the Old Testament to the New Testament has a completely different worldview. It says the entire purpose of your life is to call and serve others, faith, hope, and charity.
- 5.52 In order to get to this point, that the entire purpose of your life is to build a communist society, you've got to erase and abolish all that other stuff. You have to because it's a competitor. You've got to take it out. That's why you have to take out all religion and all other forms of eternal morality. "We do not believe in God. We do not believe in eternal morality." From Lenin himself, October 1920, public speech, 600 delegates. Published in Pravda. That's Lenin's speech to the Communist Youth League.
- 5.53 Here we go. Here's where the rubber meets the road. What was the final phrase of The Communist Manifesto? "Workers of the world, unite! We have a world to win." This can't just happen in Russia. This has to be global. Marx, in 1850, speaking to the Communist League, had said, "Our task is to make the revolution permanent in all the leading countries of the world."
- 5.54 Lenin comes forward and Lenin says, "Our victory will be a lasting victory," and he said this in November 1920, "Only when our undertaking will conquer the whole world." You can see Lenin is a lot like Marx, isn't he? Only, everything, all, totally, conquer, overthrow, abolish. There's a good reason it's called Marxism-Leninism. "Our victory will be a lasting victory only when we will undertake to conquer the whole world." By the way, conquer seems to me like a word that advocates for violence, doesn't it? You're not saying only when we educate the whole world. Because we launched it exclusively counting on the world revolution.
- 5.55 Richard Pipes, the great Harvard professor of Sovietology, said that the only reason that it takes Bolshevik Russia is that it's the ripe target of opportunity. That's where they get. And Lenin, as early as January 1917, is in exile outside of Russia, and he's depressed. He thinks that he's never going to live to see the revolution. The war is still going on. And then all of a sudden, the Tsar abdicates, America declares war, gets into

it, and all of a sudden, Lenin is like, I can't believe it. Here we go. Russia. Let's go make it happen here.

- 5.56 Lenin, in March 1919, here he spoke at the Party Congress that launches the Soviet Comintern, Communist International, which my next slide will be about. Lenin said this, "The existence of the Soviet Republic side by side with the imperialist states is unthinkable. In the end, either one or the other will conquer. And before this result, a series of horrible conflicts between the Soviet Republic and the bourgeois states is unavoidable."
- 5.57 Dude, tell me what you really believe, right? In the end, one or the other must conquer. We cannot live side by side. That is unthinkable. In the end, one or the other is going to conquer, and you're going to have a series of horrible conflicts with the bourgeois states.
- 5.58 This is where people like Woodrow Wilson said to his fellow progressives, "You want to read what the guy is saying over here? You know what he wants to do?" This is like permanent revolution advocating for violence: horrible conflicts conquer. Look at the language that's being used." They'll say that in the end, a series of disagreements between the Soviet Republic and the bourgeois states will take place, and we'll try to extend an olive branch and work about these things. He said, "No. Violent from the very beginning."
- 5.59 Then again, the book calls for the forcible overthrow of all existing conditions. So, they established the Soviet Comintern. Comintern stands for Communist International. Instead of just creating an acronym out of Communist International, they took Com Intern, so Communist International. Trotsky would call it the "General Staff of the World Revolution." This was the group. It would establish what Lenin called for in March 1919, "the full-fledged political project of world socialist revolution."
- 5.60 The first head of the Comintern was Grigory Zinoviev, who's somebody that everybody who studies communism and the Soviet Union should know about. He said, "With the establishment of the Comintern, world civil war is the order of the day." He said, "The Communist International has declared war on the entire bourgeois world." These guys don't mince words. Right off.
- 5.61 This Comintern would be headquartered in Moscow in an actual physical building. They would have a representative from all the different countries that had Communist parties. Every country would be permitted to have one Communist Party, and that Communist Party answered to Moscow. You had a representative, a liaison in Moscow. You couldn't have multiple Communist parties.
- 5.62 I could show you documents, including in my book Dupes, if you get a copy of my book Dupes, where the Comintern at one point is annoyed with the United States because they seem to have two different Communist parties, American Communist parties. And the Comintern says something like, "Get your act together now, comrades. There has to

be one Comintern or one Communist Party, American Communist Party, and it answers to us."

- 5.63** To borrow from George Kennan: it's the Comintern, it's the Kremlin that's the master's voice. You follow them. From there, they would organize and conduct the global communist symphony. When Marx called for "Workers of the world, unite!", you needed a uniting organizing force to organize the workers of the world. Every country would need a Communist Party, but each of those Communist parties would follow the lead of Moscow. That's how it had to be done.
- 5.64** There's a difference today with other communist countries. I talked about China in an earlier lecture. China, as I said, is politically communist in the sense that it's the only party that's allowed, but they've allowed a lot of free markets. They've had a lot of economic growth. You really can't call them economically communist. But China is not trying to do this. There's no Comintern today in Beijing that has a goal of global revolution. In fact, the octogenarians making up the Chinese Communist Party, these guys are filthy millionaires and billionaires. They just want to make a buck. They want Taiwan, they want Hong Kong, but they're not committed to a plan to make Latin America communist.
- 5.65** Neither is North Korea. North Korea is horrific. It is the most repressive country in the world. It is a Stalinist state. But little Kim is not fomenting a world revolution with a Comintern based in Pyongyang. He just wants his harems and his booze and his basketball courts and whatever else. He's just having himself a little party there while the whole country starves to death.
- 5.66** Even Castro's Cuba. While Castro was committed to global revolution, which is why he was always sending troops abroad and committed to hemispheric— Castro was all the time sending Cuban doctors, teachers, troops, whatever he could to Asia, anywhere around the world. But he didn't have the capability to spirit something like this. These guys, Lenin, Trotsky, and Stalin, are dead serious. Lenin says, "We're going to make this happen. We're going to do it." The Comintern will be the headquarters.
- 5.67** So that brings us to the subject of bringing communism to America. Drum roll, please. This is when it starts to come to America. That same week of March 1919, Lenin announces the creation of a Soviet Comintern. Every country in the world has to have a Communist Party. In America, our guys start to get it together, and they create an American Communist Party, and it's done in America in September 1919 in Chicago.
- 5.68** It's from the head of the American Communist Party at the time, Charles Ruthenberg, and he's reporting to the Comintern. "We've done it. We've done it. We've done it. We've created it. We've created it. We've made this happen. Long live the Soviet Socialist Republic. Long live the Comintern. Workers of the world, unite. We've created the American Communist Party." Ruthenberg today is—he didn't live a long life. He's

buried in the wall of the Kremlin, along with the heroes of communism, where he could be near his beloved Lenin and the country that he loved.

- 5.69** Where is Lenin buried today? Lenin is in a tomb—which is actually, in Russian, a shrine—there in Red Square. He's been preserved, encased in glass since 1924. Official Soviet mortuary people, while today, the Russian Soviet Union no longer exists, every now and then they have to take the body out and pump it up and put whatever they need to put in it to try to—because it turned yellow and the body started to mummify and it's waxed and they've got whatever it takes to try to make the body still look like Lenin at this point, after 100 years, after his death.
- 5.70** The American Communist Party is created, becomes known as Communist Party USA. It still exists to this day. The website is cpusa.org. At one point, at the height of its membership, it had about 100,000 members in total. Although we don't know for sure because they would never make the members publicly known. The range is probably the peak of membership, in the 1930s, about 50,000–100,000 members. Today, Communist Party USA, which claimed to have a membership surge under Trump, has maybe 4,000 or 5,000 members.
- 5.71** Most of the people that are doing socialism in America today are the Democratic Socialists of America, the DSA. That's the group of the Squad, Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, Ilhan Omar, Rashida Tlaib, Mamdani, the mayor of New York. The DSA has probably about 95,000 members. The last I saw from one of their convention speeches, it was 94,512, something like that, comrades. They call them comrades in the conventional literature. They claim to have—if you go to the website of the Democratic Socialists of America, it calls itself "The largest socialist organization in the United States," which it is. So, they've got way more members than Communist Party USA did.
- 5.72** But Communist Party USA, probably about 50,000–100,000 members, and they kept that membership secret. They kept it secret because people who were members of Communist Party USA did not want the US government to know that they were members.
- 5.73** And here's why. Here's a loyalty oath that you swore when you became a member of Communist Party USA. This is from the mid-1930s. You raised your right hand. You didn't put it on a Bible. That's the last thing you would do. "I pledge myself to rally the masses to defend the Soviet Union." This is an American Communist becoming a member, going from a small-c communist ideology to becoming a capital-C Communist. A lot of American small-c communists didn't take the step of becoming a member of Communist Party USA because they didn't want to pledge this oath. They thought, "That's a bridge too far. I don't want to swear a loyalty oath to Stalin's Soviet Union. I still consider myself an American first."
- 5.74** John Dewey, one of the founding fathers of American public education, he's honorary president for life of the National Education Association, said, "I am a communist spelled

with a lowercase c, not an uppercase C." Then those people, if they got called before the House Committee on Un-American Activities— and the House Committee would say, "Are you now or have you ever been a member of the Communist Party?" They could say no, because they weren't.

- 5.75** By the way, if they were, what did they usually invoke? The Fifth Amendment to the US Constitution, the right against self-incrimination. And the members of the House Committee on Un-American Activities, which, by the way, was run and was headed— most of its chairmen were Democrats, because in those days, you had an equal number of Democrat anti-communists, and Republican anti-communists. But they said that they found that when these people invoked the Fifth Amendment, they usually were members. If someone was not a member, they would typically say, "No, I'm not a member of the Communist Party." And they knew they had to deny it because they knew that when they got the summons to be called before the Committee, that there was very likely, undeniable, very strong evidence that they were members of the Communist Party.
- 5.76** Arthur Miller, the famous playwright who did *The Crucible*, married Marilyn Monroe. That's the weirdest couple of all time, by the way. Arthur Miller, Marilyn Monroe. I see Marilyn Monroe and Joe DiMaggio. That makes sense.
- 5.77** But Arthur Miller is called before, I think it was the Senate Internal Security Committee. They had his name, they had checks, they had aliases. I mean, he's writing under a pen name for *New Masses*, *Daily Worker*. And they had an actual Communist Party application card form from Arthur Miller. They said, "Is this not your address?" Like 18 Schermerhorn Lane, Brooklyn, New York. It's like, "Well, I must say that it's curious that it would have my address." But usually, they got to that point. They knew who you were.
- 5.78** So the Communist Party loyalty oath. When you joined, this is what you said. "I pledge myself to rally the masses to defend not America, but the Soviet Union." Who is the head of the Soviet Union right now? Joseph Stalin. This is the middle of the purge, the Great Terror, where tens of millions of people are killed in the Soviet Union, aside from the forced famine in the Ukraine— the military purge, the political purge.
- 5.79** They are swearing a loyalty oath, these American citizens, to the Soviet Union. "I pledge myself to remain at all times a vigilant and firm defender of the Leninist line of the party, the only line that ensures the triumph of Soviet power in the United States." They wanted the triumph of Soviet power in the United States.
- 5.80** They were committed to what William Z. Foster, Communist Party USA, had, and I'll read his long testimony to you in the next lecture, what he called a Soviet America. William Z. Foster, one of the founding board members of the ACLU, the American Civil Liberties Union, wrote a book called *Toward Soviet America*, 1932. A Soviet-American republic as part of the World Soviet Union.

- 5.81** The two founders of the ACLU were Roger Baldwin and Harry Ward. I'll talk about Harry Ward when I talk about the infiltration of the churches. He was known as the Red Dean among the religious left. But the founder, the president, was Roger Baldwin. Baldwin wrote a 1929 book called *Liberty Under the Soviets*. To Baldwin's credit, and I talk about this in my book *Dupes*, he later realized how bad Stalin was, how bad the Soviet Union was, and came to reject Soviet communism.
- 5.82** At one point, Baldwin, after having an ACLU board filled with communists and fellow travelers and sympathizers said, "I think our board members should take a loyalty oath to the US Constitution rather than the Soviet Constitution." A lot of them balked. They're like, "What? Are you fascist?" So "No, I think it's reasonable if we're going to be the American Civil Liberties Union, that you support the US Constitution and not the Soviet Constitution." But it took them a while to get there.
- 5.83** Lincoln Steffens, the journalist for the *New Republic*, said, "I am a patriot for Russia. The future is there. Russia will win out, and it will save the world."
- 5.84** Langston Hughes. Some of you read Langston Hughes. He's now required reading in our public schools. As a civil rights poet, Tim Kaine, the running mate of Hillary Clinton, when they lost the election in 2016, the next day, Hillary gave her concession speech. Tim Kaine went up there and quoted Langston Hughes. The American left swooned like, "Oh, yeah, he's wonderful. He's all about civil rights." Langston Hughes said, "Put one more S in the USA to make it Soviet. The USA, when we take control, will be the U.S.S.A."
- 5.85** Herb Romerstein, who I dedicate my book *Dupes* to, Herb was a former Communist and became a mentor to me on this subject, said, "You have to understand, people who were Communist Party members were loyal Soviet patriots. They were devoted first and foremost to the Soviet Union. That was their country. That's who they fought for."
- 5.86** All right, I'm going to read to you the testimony of William Z. Foster. I'll start that in the —I'll do that at the start of the next lecture. But a couple more points on some of these other people, just to give you an idea of who they were.
- 5.87** The early Communist Party leaders included—so these are the founders. Charles Ruthenberg was one of them. John Reed was another. There's a movie about him called "Reds," which lionizes him. But they had John Reed Clubs all over America that taught communism. Ben Gitlow, who was one of the early founders and actually ran for Vice President of the United States, repeatedly on the Communist Party USA ticket. Gitlow was a big deal. He later left the party in a very high-profile break. When I talk about the communist infiltration of churches, I'll talk about Ben Gitlow. His testimony to that was really remarkable.
- 5.88** Then would come William Z. Foster. And following Foster was a very influential—by the way, these leaders of Communist Party USA were called General Secretary. So that was their title. It wasn't president, it wasn't prime minister, it wasn't executive director. It

was General Secretary. So you're a General Secretary of the Communist Party, just like you were a General Secretary of the Soviet Union.

- 5.89** Altogether, there have been about a handful of leaders of Communist Party USA. These people stayed in power for a long time, very much akin to Soviet leaders in terms of their length of tenure of leadership.
- 5.90** The longest serving of all of them was Gus Hall, from 1959 to 2000. So he was there forever. And as you would expect from any Communist leader, these people, like in the Soviet Union, they were like it as well as General Secretary of the United States Communist Party, Gus Hall was terribly corrupt, stole money from party coffers. There's a great book on this called Operation Solo by John Barron. John Barron did terrific journalism. An American journalist in the 1970s, 80s, 90s, wrote a number of different books.
- 5.91** Operation Solo is about a fascinating figure named Morris Childs, who had become number two in the American Communist Party. Once Childs got in there, he realized how corrupt these people were, how abusive they were, how if you didn't toe the party line, they would treat you in the worst way. And if you did anything at all to break ranks with the party, you had to be under what they called party discipline. You followed the party. You did not question the Soviet Union. You did not question Moscow. You did not question the General Secretary. If you did, you were in big trouble. And he soon found that out.
- 5.92** Eventually, he pulled away from the party for a little bit, got sick, spent a few years away, and during that time, Morris Childs decided, "I've had enough. I'm no longer with them. I'm going to contact the FBI." So he contacted J. Edgar Hoover's FBI, and they said, "Sir, you could be a tremendous asset to us." So Morris Childs went back into the party. He became the number two guy in the American Communist Party, below Gus Hall, but he was actually working for us. He was an informant for us. He would go to Moscow, where they loved him like a son. They gave him the Order of Lenin and the Stalin, this and that, and feted him with all these great awards. Loved the guy.
- 5.93** Meanwhile, he's bringing back to the United States all kinds of incredible intel, including foreshadowing for the United States what would become the Sino-Soviet split after the death of Stalin under Mao. So he was giving us amazing information.
- 5.94** He also reported that he would bring back on a plane to America loads of cash from the Soviet Union for the American Communist Party. By the way, this was completely illegal for the American Communist Party to be taking money from Moscow. But Moscow was in control of the American Communist Party, was in control of picking the editor of the Daily Worker, everything. So they would give money to Gus, he would fly it back, and he would meet at a safe house in New Jersey with his FBI contacts, and they would count out every dime of the money. The annual subsidy that Moscow was providing to

Communist Party USA is printed in the index of John Barron's book, Operation Solo. It's fantastic information. It's great to see.

- 5.95** But that was—we knew all of this. We knew that it was going on, and several presidents, of course, knew about it. And a lot of them were probably tempted to say, "We need to tell the world what the Soviets are doing here." But they couldn't because they didn't want to break the cover of Morris Childs. At one point, it seemed like they were getting close on Childs, and so Childs pulled out and left.
- 5.96** But I bring all this back to Gus Hall. Morris Childs would bring this money back. They would count it. Our FBI would count it. So we knew how much Moscow was giving the Communist Party USA. And then Childs would bring it to Gus Hall, the head general secretary of the Communist Party. And what would he do with it? What any communist would do, the complaints about greed and capital and money. Take it, shove it in his pocket, shove it over here, shove it over there, and take it there, and enriched himself with it, which is what they did. So those are the party leaders in the American Communist Party.
- 5.97** We're out of time for this lecture. I will start the next lecture by reading to you the testimony from William Z. Foster to Congress in 1930. It is fascinating. It connects to Marx and Lenin in the Comintern. And you won't believe some—well, actually, you will believe it because you've been in this lecture series and probably won't be surprised. You'll be surprised by his candor and honesty at that point. All right, I'll stop there if you have any questions.
- 5.98** How does Hegel, his original philosophy, influence Marx, and if that influences this change from international communism to more modern national communism, such as in China?
- 5.99** Yeah, the whole Hegelian aspect is really quite complicated. Hegel had this view of this dialectical plane. In Hegel's case, it was called an ideational plane based on ideas. So all of history was going through this dialectical unfolding process. But in the case of Hegel, Hegel was a Christian. And Hegel saw all of this unfolding, the coming of Christ in a classic Christian worldview way. There are today what they call right-leaning Hegelians and left-leaning Hegelians. The left-leaning Hegelians became the people who took Marx's dialectic, which transformed Hegel's plane from an ideational dialectic to a class-based economic plane. So those are the people who were all about Marxism, communism, and that whole worldview.
- 5.100** Whereas the right-leaning Hegelians support tradition and order and religion. I would have to say that Hegel probably, if you dug up his grave today, you would find that he's rolled over in his grave. He would be appalled that a guy would borrow, in a sense, his philosophical framework and use it to apply it in a way that Marx did.

Lecture 6: American Marxism

At a glance — American Marxism.

- 6.1** Welcome back. I had mentioned in the last lecture the document from the Communist Party of America reporting to the Comintern in 1919. I'm going to hold it up, but I don't know that it does very well. You could see it's not a very good photocopy, but when you're dealing with microfiche that's over 100 years old, so even this looks about pretty much the same as how it looks in the Soviet Comintern archives at the Communist Party USA in the Library of Congress. It's just not a very good photocopy. But that's what happens when you're dealing with old documents.
- 6.2** But you could see at the top, or you can't see very well, but Communist Party of America, 1219 Blue Island Avenue, Chicago, Illinois. Then it says C. E. Ruthenberg, executive secretary. So he was Charles Ruthenberg. He's writing to the Comintern, "In the name of the Communist members of the United States, organized in the Communist Party of America, I extend greetings to the Communist Party of Russia." And then just three short little lines, salutations with exclamation marks. "Hail to the dictatorship of the proletariat! Long live the Russian Socialist Soviet Republic! Long live the Communist International! Fraternally yours, C.E. Ruthenberg, executive secretary."
- 6.3** And then he CC'd a number of people there who were early members of the Comintern, the American Communist Party. But that's how they did it. They were reporting excitedly to Moscow, "Hey, we've done it. We've established the American Communist Party. We're answering to the Comintern. Here we go."
- 6.4** So as I said at the end of last class, you had the following people, like Charles Ruthenberg, John Reed. You had a number of different general secretaries of the Communist Party. And I had mentioned William Z. Foster. So William Z. Foster was Secretary of the Party from 1929 to 1934.
- 6.5** These guys, communists, American communists, as I said in the last lecture, would frequently get called before Congress to testify. And they eventually learned, especially after this testimony, to just zip it up, not tell the truth about the system that they're committed to as loyal Soviet patriots, as Herbert Romerstein put it.
- 6.6** But on this day, Foster was surprisingly candid because they hadn't learned that lesson yet. So he's in an exchange, this is 1930, with Congressman Hamilton Fish. Hamilton Fish was a Republican congressman from New York and actually quite sophisticated, really on this issue.
- 6.7** In my last couple of lectures, I'm going to mention Bella Dodd, who was one of the most remarkable infiltrators among American Communist Party members in American history. She and her comrades later go after Hamilton Fish, calling him every name in the book: racist, anti-Semite. You guys think that language today is new? These guys

have been doing it. The far left has been doing this for over 100 years, calling people fascist and Nazi and whatever. They just sling these -isms out there, these invectives to whoever for whatever reason. Our job is to not take it seriously. This is their typical character assassination.

- 6.8** But Foster is testifying before Congress. So Hamilton Fish is asking him some questions as the head of the American Communist Party. All right. Fish begins. I wish I had this on an overhead for you to follow, but it would be too long to put on an overhead. It's in my book, *The Devil and Karl Marx*, pages 171 to 179. So people that are following this and have the book, you could follow along.
- 6.9** Fish says to Foster, Congressman Fish says to General Secretary Foster. "Now, if I understand you, the workers in this country [America] look upon the Soviet Union as their country, is that right?" As we saw in the loyalty oath that they swore, well, yeah, they do. Foster says, "Well, the more advanced workers do." Fish: "They look upon the Soviet Union as their country?" Foster: "Yes." Fish: "They look upon the Soviet flag as their flag?" Foster: "The workers of this country and the workers of every country have only one flag, and that is the red flag. That is the flag of the proletarian revolution." By the way, he's answering correctly, right? This is maybe not the way he wants to expose himself in his party, but this is the truth.
- 6.10** Fish: "Well, the workers of this country consider, then, the Soviet government to be their country." This is the workers of America. "Do they also consider the red flag to be their flag?" Foster: "I have answered quite clearly." Indeed, yes. Fish: "Do you owe allegiance to the American flag? Does the Communist Party owe allegiance to the American flag?" Foster: "The workers, the revolutionary workers, and all the capitalist countries are an oppressed class who are held in subjection by their respective capitalist governments. Their attitude toward these governments is the abolition of these governments and the establishment of Soviet governments." He's a very good Marxist.
- 6.11** Fish, who—I love this—just never lets them off the hook, just keeps probing calmly with questions. Fish: "Well, they do not claim any allegiance then to the American flag in this country?"
- 6.12** By the way, consider: these people are American citizens. And the American left to this day will say, "How dare they ask you, are you now or have you ever been a member of the Communist Party?" House Un-American Activities. What? You're calling these people un-American? Well, they're American citizens, but you'd have to call this pretty un-American. Like Herb said, they're committed to the red flag of the Soviet Union. Yeah, they're Americans. They're American citizens. We're not denying that, but they're clearly saying that their flag is the Soviet flag, which actually makes this all even worse.
- 6.13** "That is, you mean the support of capitalism in America" said Foster "no." Fish—it's a great question—I mean, if they had to choose between the red flag and the American

flag, I take it from you that you would choose the red flag. Is that correct? Foster: "I have stated my answer." Congressman Fish: "I don't want to force you to answer if it embarrasses you, Mr. Foster." Foster: "It does not embarrass me at all. I stated very clearly, the flag is the flag of the revolutionary class, and we are part of the revolutionary class." Fish: "I understood that." Foster: "And all capitalist flags are flags of the capitalist class, and we owe no allegiance to them." Fish: "Well, that answers the question." As indeed it does.

- 6.14** I also love reading older stuff because, as disturbing as this is, how much more diplomatic and mannerly people were back then. Today, they'd be screaming at each other, swearing, dropping F-bombs. This is two gentlemen, and Foster keeps giving him answers.
- 6.15** Congressman Fish: "Mr. Foster, would you mind stating to the committee the aims and principles of the Communist Party?" This is actually an excerpt of this. He gives a much longer explanation, explication. [Foster]: "The aims and principles of the Communist Party, briefly stated, are to organize the workers, to defend their interests under the capitalist system and to eventually abolish the capitalist system and to establish a workers and farmers government."
- 6.16** Fish: "Now, can you tell us more definitively if the principles of the Communist Party, as advocated in this country or anywhere else, are the same?" Foster: "Yes." Fish: "Does the Communist Party advocate the confiscation of all private property?" I love that question. You see, he's got a list here. Foster: "The Communist Party advocates the overthrow of the capitalist system"—by the way, implicit within this is that America is capitalist—"and the confiscation of the social necessities of life. That is, the basic industries and other industries for producing the means of livelihood for the people. By the property of individuals, personal belongings and so on, no; that is in the sense of their personal property."
- 6.17** All right, so at least we're getting a little bit of clarity of if you guys were in charge over here, how much of our property are you going to take? I'd really, really like to know. I could spend a lot of time on this. I should do a whole lecture just on this, but how private property was banned in different communist countries. Under Mao Zedong, it was really, really bad.
- 6.18** This is in—John King Fairbank writes about this, Jasper Becker's book, *Hungry Ghosts*. They took everybody from the cities, put them in the countryside. They put them in the collective kitchen. Private property was banned so much that private fires were abolished. The only fire that was allowed to emanate from the collective kitchen had to be the collective smoke from the collective fire. Even the fire was collectivized. You couldn't have private fires. And you took your woks: W-O-K, wok, used for Chinese food, and they were melted into communal woks used in the collective kitchen.

- 6.19** So they took this to the extreme. Pol Pot's Cambodia, really took it to the extreme. You look at the beginning of the movie, "The Killing Fields," where they're all being emptied out of the capital, Phnom Penh, out into the countryside.
- 6.20** By the way, I talked to somebody one day who was like, "That's not communism." What do you mean? They're abolishing the distinction between town and country. They're more equitably distributing the population. That's point nine in the 10-point plan. Read the book.
- 6.21** They banned personal hygiene products. They banned glasses. They went after the intellectual class—what was the song by the punk band, The Dead Kennedys? Was that? I'm old enough to remember this stuff from my previous life. But there's a thing about banning Right Guard, no more Right Guard—Holiday in Cambodia. That's the song. They banned Right Guard.
- 6.22** They banned deodorant. And a number of them did this—there's been a lot of people, like psychologically, trying to understand, why did you ban hygiene products? Some people think it was to really break down the individual at an altogether different level.
- 6.23** In Cuba, they banned—a lot of these personal hygiene products are banned because they just can't get them. They don't have the money for it. And advocates for Castro want to try to blame it on the US embargo, as if you can only buy toothbrushes from the United States. As if you can only get deodorant from America, you can't get it from China or Germany, anywhere else in the world.
- 6.24** In Cuba, boats are banned. Private boats are banned. One of the first things that they had to do after the revolution was ban private boats because people got the boats and got the hell out of there. They took off.
- 6.25** You want to see something creepy? Look at satellite photos of Cuba, and you'll see an island without boats. The dominant cuisine in Cuba is not fish, as it should be, but chicken, because people raise chickens. They banned fishing on the shore, as well as swimming, unless it's in beaches that are heavily monitored, because people jump in the water and start swimming 100 miles to Key West, and the vast majority of them drown. I'll talk about that in my next lecture, where I'm going to go through the actual communist death toll for all the different countries.
- 6.26** So Cuba really banned private property to an extreme scale. But hey, one thing that Marx isn't clear about in the book is, indeed, to what extent do we abolish private property? I guess he left it to his acolytes, those people that Lenin talked to in that speech to teach communism, to fill out those details.
- 6.27** So Congressman Fish naturally is asking Foster here, "So how much private property do you want to ban?" I think I'd be careful about it because, after all, this is America where he is. You're not going to get very far getting communist recruits if you stand up there and say, "We want to abolish your house. We want to take all your private property."

- 6.28** Fish continues to Secretary William Z. Foster. Congressman Fish: "Does your party advocate the abolition and destruction of religious beliefs?" We all know the answer to that. But how is he going to answer? In the future, they would answer, "I plead the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution." They're going to give an answer there. How do you think Foster would answer? Here's how he answers: "Our party considers religion to be the opium of the people, as Karl Marx has stated, and we carry on propaganda for the liquidation of these prejudices amongst the workers." Clear enough. I'd have to say that's spot on.
- 6.29** But Fish isn't done. He'll probe a little deeper on this question: "To be a member of the Communist Party, do you have to be an atheist?" [Foster] is probably thinking, "Well, yeah, natural." Foster says, "In order to be—there's no formal requirement to this effect. Many workers join the Communist Party who still have some religious scruples or religious ideas. But a worker who will join the Communist Party who understands the elementary principles of the Communist Party must necessarily be in the process of liquidating his religious beliefs. And if he still has any lingerings when he joins the party, he will soon get rid of them. But irreligion, that is, atheism, is not laid down as a formal requirement for membership in the Communist Party."
- 6.30** In other words, why the hell would you be religious and want to join the Communist Party? I mean, we call it the opium of the masses. Marx said, "Communism begins where atheism begins." Bukharin said, "We take on religion at the tip of the bayonet."
- 6.31** There might be people like an American magazine in the summer of 2019 that has cover stories, like "How a religious person should be a Communist," "The Catholic case for Communism," America magazine. There might be pastors saying, "Oh, you should be like the communists." But these guys realize, no, that doesn't make any sense at all. And why would you even be interested in communism if you were a religious person?
- 6.32** So if you join and you still have some religious scruples, you need to be in the process of liquidating those because we're going to be carrying on propaganda against religion in the party. So you really wouldn't have any value to us if you were a religious person.
- 6.33** Fish's immediate next question: "Have you been to Russia?" Foster: "Yes, eight or nine times." By the way, that's a lot. In that day, that's not easy to get there. Would he even have been flying yet? No, that would have been boat and train. That's a haul. That's quite a pilgrimage.
- 6.34** Fish: "You are familiar then with the workings of the Communist Party in Russia?" Foster: "Reasonably." Congressman Fish: "Well, can members of the Communist Party in Russia be married in the church and maintain religious beliefs of that nature and practice them?"
- 6.35** I should pause here and note that in communist Russia, you were supposed to be an atheist if you were a member of the Communist Party. And part of graduating from Moscow State University, you took courses in atheism.

- 6.36** I remember sitting at the Reagan Library, looking at the declassified memcons, memorandum of conversation, between Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev at the Geneva Summit. And they're having dinner together. And the Reagans, Ronald and Nancy Reagan, are sitting with the Gorbachevs, Ronald Reagan with Mikhail and Raisa Gorbachev. And Gorbachev—I'll talk a little bit about this tomorrow—Gorbachev was very interested in religion, and Reagan even thought a closet Christian. Raisa was a hardcore atheist. And so both men were talking about their wives, having a nice dinner conversation, bragging about their wives. "Nancy was an actress, and she did this." And Gorbachev said, "Raisa taught a course on atheism at Moscow State University." Which Reagan must have thought, "Well, that's just terrible." Very unimpressed with that.
- 6.37** So Congressman Fish asked: "Can members of the Communist Party in Russia be married in the church?" Which the answer was no. They banned religious weddings. They banned religious baptisms. Baptisms are religious. The war on religion was so pervasive. As Gorbachev said, "Our predecessors declared a wholesale war on religion that was completely unjustifiable, completely outrageous."
- 6.38** The Soviet state instead created secular ceremonies, a secular baptism—do I have that in this book? I have it in other books—where the mother holds up the child and pledges to commit the child to be a worthy builder of communism. So they actually banned baptisms.
- 6.39** Mikhail Gorbachev was secretly baptized by his Russian Orthodox grandmother. They gave him the name Mikhail, which is Michael, which is Saint Michael the Archangel—I gave the Michael the Archangel prayer earlier. Gorbachev told Pope John Paul II, he said, "My mother would take the cross, grandmother would take the cross from above the fireplace, and secretly blessed me with it."
- 6.40** But they banned, they closed churches, they blew up churches, they shut them down, the Soviets did. So they banned religious weddings, religious baptism, and religious funerals. They even banned priests from visiting hospitals in Russia. And priests were called upon—Russian Orthodox priests—to cease the publication of their magazines and newspapers. Horrible what they did.
- 6.41** Can you imagine your spouse is on his or her deathbed and wants to see a man of the cloth to talk about? No, they're banned. They weren't allowed in there. The banning of religious weddings, so you could not quite literally have a public ceremony where you and your spouse in holy matrimony made a vow before God—that was banned.
- 6.42** And I should add that divorce in Soviet Russia exploded. The Atlantic magazine did a piece around 1929 or 1930 called "The End of Marriage in Russia." The divorce rate was 50% to 60% within the first decade. They also, at the same time, went full scale, completely legalized, 24/7, government-paid for abortion during that period. So it was an all-out war on the family, marriage, everything. Hey, maybe they took that whole

"abolition of the family!" point seriously in the Manifesto. Sorry about the digression there.

- 6.43** Congressman Fish: "Mr. Foster, can members of the Communist Party in Russia be married in the church and maintain religious beliefs of that nature and practice them?" Foster: "My opinion is that a member of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union who would be married in a church would not be of any value to the Communist Party." Indeed.
- 6.44** Fish: "Could he maintain his membership in the party?" Foster: "He would not." Fish: "Would he be put out of the party?" Foster: "Eventually, if not for that specific act." Fish: "Would it not be the same in this country, America?" After all, you're a head of the American Communist Party. You want to do what they're doing. Foster: "As stated before, workers who would be so imbued with religious superstitions that they would be married in a church would be of no value to the Communist Party." Fish: "And the same thing would—what happened to them in this country that happens to them in Russia?" Foster: "Of course." Or at least that would be his hope.
- 6.45** Now, the problem in America for these guys right now is that America isn't Soviet Russia; we follow the American Constitution. You have the freedom to do these things. But if we could get that system over there, here, think of the horizon of possibilities.
- 6.46** Fish then asked William Z. Foster, again, head of the Communist Party USA in 1929 to 1934. Congressman Fish: "Does your party believe in the promotion of class hatred?" Well, the answer is obviously yes. They're the masters of class hatred. This is what they do.
- 6.47** M. Y. Latsis, who was a high-ranking official of the Cheka, said, "The first question that we ask each person is to what class does he belong? This determines the fate of the accused. We ask not what country you're from, not what ethnic background you're from, but to which class do you belong? This defines the fate of the accused."
- 6.48** It should be understood that this drives me crazy among people on the political left that condemn fascism and Nazism, but not communism. Nazism and communism were both based on hatred. Nazism was based on racial hatred, ethnic hatred. Communism was based on class hatred. So the Nazi would eliminate you and kill you based on your ethnicity and race. The communists would do so, certainly in the Soviet Union, based on your class. It's just a form of hatred and violence applied to different groups of people. For the Nazi: race, ethnicity. For the communists: class economics.
- 6.49** Fish: "Does your party believe in the promotion of class hatred?" Foster: "This is a peculiar question. What do you mean by class hatred?" Fish keeps his cool. Congressman Fish: "I mean, stirring up and exciting class antagonism and hatred of the working class against the other classes, so-called?" Foster: "Our party believes in developing the class consciousness of the workers." By the way, developing class consciousness means that you teach them to hate the bourgeoisie. And by the way, you

should hate the bourgeoisie because it's your oppressor. So yeah, you "love that hate," said Lenin.

- 6.50** [Foster]: "Our party believes to educate the workers to an understanding of their class interests and to organize them to defend that class interest, which inevitably brings them into conflict with the whole capitalist class in its whole system of ideology."
- 6.51** Now, remember the Lenin speech that I read in the last lecture? He talked about the only morality that we recognize is that which furthers class interests. All morality is acceptable that furthers class interests. We do not believe in God. We do not believe in an eternal morality. So, in other words, if you have to foment and work up class hatred in order to advance class interests, well, surely that's acceptable. Surely we believe in that. That would be good hate. Good hate.
- 6.52** Congressman Fish: "Do the communists in this country advocate world revolution?" Well, that's a no-brainer. You don't even need to wait for the response on this one. Foster: "Yes, the communists in this country realize that America is connected up with the whole world system, and the capitalist system displays the same characteristics everywhere. Everywhere it makes for the misery and exploitation of the workers, and it must be abolished, not only on an American scale, but on a worldwide scale."
- 6.53** Fish: "So that they do advocate world revolution. And do they advocate revolution in this country?" Foster: "I have stated that the communists advocate the abolition of the capitalist system in this country and every other country. That this must develop out of the sharpening of the class struggle and the struggle of the workers for bread and butter." All right. Got their answer.
- 6.54** Here's the quote from M. Y. Latsis, the head of the Cheka, that I was trying to state earlier from memory. I've got it verbatim right here. "We are exterminating the bourgeoisie as a class." He says to the Cheka, the predecessor of the KGB, "In your evidence against the individual, don't look for documents and pieces of evidence about what the defendant has done, whether in deed or in speaking or acting against the Soviet authority. The first question you should ask him is what class he comes from. What are his roots, his education, his training, his occupation? These questions determine the fate of the accused." What are we doing? We are exterminating the bourgeoisie as a class. In their case, they mean taking them, putting them up against the wall, and executing them flat out.
- 6.55** All right, a little bit more here from Congressman Hamilton Fish and General Secretary William Z. Foster. Fish: "Now, are the communists in this country opposed to our republican form of government?" That would be lowercase r republican because we are a republic. Foster: "The capitalist democracy, most assuredly. We stand for a workers and farmers government, a government of producers, not of exploiters."
- 6.56** Fish: "They are opposed to our republican form of government?" Foster: "Most assuredly so." Fish: "And they desire to overthrow it through revolutionary methods?"

Sounds like Fish read The Communist Manifesto. Foster: "On this point, I would like to read from the program of the Communist International." So he goes, and he reads the long statement from the Comintern in which, hey, why not? At that point, just go to the source and say here's what my bosses say in Moscow.

- 6.57** Foster: "The Communist International is the World Party of the Communist movement." Yeah, the Comintern. That's what we spent the last lecture on. Fish: "Is the Communist Party of the United States connected with it?"—with the Comintern—Foster: "It is." Fish: "In what way?" Foster: "It is the American section." Fish: "So you take your orders from the Third International, do you?" Foster: "The question, 'Do we take our orders from the Communist International?' is a question which reveals the utter distance of the capitalist conception of organization from the worker." He goes on to say the Communist International is a world party and on, and on, and on, and on.
- 6.58** Fish: "Then you do take the orders and carry them out, as decided in Moscow by the Third International of the Communist Party." Foster: "I stated it is not a question of taking orders." Fish: "Well, putting them into effect?" Foster: "It is a question of working out policies with the Comintern in the Comintern as party of this proletarian organization." By the way, they're not really taking orders because they want to do it. They're their comrades, and they're happy to do it.
- 6.59** Fish—you see what Fish is trying to get him to say, right? You guys are under the command of Moscow. They're pulling your strings—"Well, they have to carry out those orders, do they not? Foster: "Carry out the policies?" Fish: "Carry out the orders and policies as initiated by the Third International of the Communist Party over in Moscow." Foster: "We carry out the policies in the way I have stated."
- 6.60** By the way, in the background here, knowing that this is just killing them PR-wise, American communists, Bella Dodd, and others are like, "We're going to get that Congressman Fish. How dare he do this?" Yeah, Fish is exposing the truth. Foster is going to need a talking to after this. Next time you get there, you say, "I plead the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution. I'm not saying a thing." You told them way too much.
- 6.61** Fish: "You believe that by advocating the substitution of the Soviet system of government for the republican form of government, that you are operating under the law?" How's he going to answer this one? Comrade Foster: "I, of course, do not say we derived our theories from the Declaration of Independence, but the Declaration of Independence says when a government demonstrates that it no longer represents the interests of the masses"—I don't think Jefferson used the word "masses," but Jefferson did say—"it's not the right but the duty of these masses to dispose of that government and establish one that will represent their interests to abolish that government." It does indeed say in the Declaration of Independence, when a government becomes abusive of the republican form of government, it is the right of people to abolish that government.

- 6.62** Fish: "That is that you advocate is a change of our republican form of government and the substituting of it with the Soviet form of government." Foster's answer: "I have stated that a number of times." Straight from the horse's mouth. So there you go. William Z. Foster, American Communist, head of the American Communist Party.
- 6.63** All right, we've got about a half an hour here more to talk about American communism, and I could spend a lot of time on this. And in the next lecture after this, I'm going to talk about the infiltration of churches in America by the American Communist Party, which is really disturbing. So I'll do that, an exclusive lecture just on that. But continuing on with this point.
- 6.64** The Hollywood Ten, who were these guys? We're often told that, boy, one of the really abusive things that the House Committee on Un-American Activities did—these fascists in the American government—was that they harassed these poor, progressive Hollywood screenwriters and directors who were just out there advocating for a better world. They accused them of being communists. And then they blacklisted these people who were just practicing their civil liberties. These American communists were concealed. They had sworn a loyalty oath to the Soviet Union, and they didn't want anyone to know that they were actual Communist Party members.
- 6.65** What I said earlier, the Communist Party had anywhere from 50,000 to 100,000 members. We don't know how many because they kept the registration roll secret. Anybody watching this anywhere, if you can find for me in the attic of somebody's house a list of a party membership roll, I don't think one has ever been found. They put those things to the flames. They destroyed that evidence. They didn't want anybody to know.
- 6.66** Oftentimes, when we found out somebody was a party member, it wasn't until after their death. Paul Robeson, after whom there's a Paul Robeson Cultural Center named at Penn State University— Gus Hall came out and said, "Gosh, I'll tell you, old Paul was a great Communist. He used to bring his party check to me, and we would talk and everything and have a beer together." It's like, "Ah, okay." Like we always thought, Robeson was a Communist. Gus Hall told us.
- 6.67** But they were in Hollywood. These people were running front groups. They didn't want people to know that these were Communist groups. The list of front groups, I have what's called Volume 9—I don't know. Why can't I think of the name?—Appendix 9, which is this big 2,100-page three-volume report from the 1940s in Congress that listed all these different subversive groups, all the different communist front groups.
- 6.68** Probably the most common name in the back of them was Progressive. Progressive Citizens Alliance, Progressive This, Progressive That, the American League Against War and Fascism, which is really creative. It's like, who could be against an American League Against War and Fascism? The religious left tried to get Bishop Fulton Sheen's approval

of it. He said, "I'll tell you what, I'll join once you make it the American League Against War, Fascism, and Communism." How about that?

- 6.69** Something like 20% to 30% of the original signers of the American League Against War and Fascism rally in New York in June of 1940—I have this in my book, *Dupes*, the name started with R-E-V., "Rev." Because these communists would create this front group, and they would go to the religious community and say, "Blessed are the peacemakers. We don't want to have entrance into this war. Let the Europeans fight this war." Because at that point, World War II had been started by Hitler and Stalin together. Hitler-Stalin Pact. They started the war together. The American League Against War and Fascism at that point is calling for no US aid to Britain, no Lend-Lease aid, anything.
- 6.70** And then the moment that Hitler betrayed Stalin with Operation Barbarossa, on June 22, 1941, they invaded the Soviet Union. This is not an exaggeration. The American League Against War and Fascism, the American Peace Mobilization, APM, put their signs down. They became immediately pro-war overnight because now their country, the Soviet Union, had been attacked. Now they went from being anti-war to pro-war, full US aid for the UK, calling for US aid to the USSR. And the APM, the American Peace Mobilization, became the American People's Mobilization. Congress called it one of the most seditious, pernicious, insidious, communist front groups ever organized in the United States. These guys were such liars.
- 6.71** Patrisse Cullors, who I've mentioned a number of times, Black Lives Matter, her being a Communist, with the original BLM website even calling for the abolition of the nuclear family. She said, "Alicia and I are trained Marxists. We're super versed in ideological theories." That's a great example. You create a group with a name like Black Lives Matter. Who could be against that? Your neighbor puts that sign out in the front yard, and you go and say, "The lady that founded that group is a Communist. Could you take that sign down?" "What? You don't think that Black Lives Matter?" So these people are geniuses at coming up with the right slogans, sloganeering, and names.
- 6.72** A young actor named Ronald Reagan, who called himself a hemophiliac liberal and an FDR Democrat, said that he was so duped by these groups that he joined every group under the sun that had the word "progressive" in it.
- 6.73** He soon became an after-dinner speaker for these progressive groups. And then one day, he was talking to his pastor, the Reverend Cleveland Kleihauer. He gave a speech to his men's group—World War II is over, Hitler is dead. Reagan's lighting up fascism, Nazism. Reverend Kleihauer says, "You know, Ron, that was a good speech. But there's another -ism out there called communism, Stalinism. And it's out there just running all over Eastern Europe right now. I think you should add a line to your speech about condemning communism as well." Reagan said, "Well, that's a good idea. Good idea, pastor. I'll do that."

- 6.74 So Reagan's next speech, he did that. First of all, there's cheers, "Nazism". And then Reagan said, "There's another -ism out there. It's called communism. And if it becomes as abusive, I will condemn it, too." You could hear a pin drop. Reagan said that after this, he's soon being called a fascist scum, a Nazi, a racist, everything else. He talked about a moment where you could hear a pin drop at the end of one of these speeches.
- 6.75 Jimmy Roosevelt, FDR's son—who was an anticommunist—and an actor went up to him and said, "We noticed the reaction to your speech and how you got snarled at and booed and hissed and everything. "A few of us are meeting over at Olivia's house"—Olivia de Havilland, who was the actress who played Melanie in "Gone with the Wind." She was the saintly Melanie, the opposite of Scarlett O'Hara. "A few of us are meeting at Olivia's house. We think you should come over and talk to us."
- 6.76 They went over there, and Olivia was just like Reagan, an anticommunist liberal Democrat. And she said to Reagan, "I thought you were one of them," meaning one of the closet communists. And he said, "No, not at all." So for Reagan, he started to learn at this point. He learned these actors, these directors who are claiming all this stuff, this is, in fact, a secret underground group of communists.
- 6.77 The other group that they created—and this gets to my next slide on the Hollywood Ten—they created a communist front group called the Committee for the First Amendment. They got a bunch of headliner actors and actresses: Humphrey Bogart, Lauren Bacall, Judy Garland—Dorothy, "Somewhere Over the Rainbow"—Danny Kaye. It pains me to say this: Gene Kelly. I love Gene Kelly from my alma mater, the University of Pittsburgh. These communists, John Howard Lawson, Dalton Trumbo, and others said, "These people in Congress are accusing us of being communists. We are not. We are not communists. And they're calling us to Capitol Hill to testify. These fascists! These Nazis!"
- 6.78 So they go there, October 1947, and these actors and actresses go all across the country on a train, making train stops, talking about democracy in the US Constitution and how unfair the House Committee on Un-American Activities—how un-American the House Committee is. Go all the way across the country saying this.
- 6.79 And then they get called to testify before Congress. And guess what? These guys in Congress are no dopes. They've got Communist Party checks written out by these scriptwriters, these screenwriters. They've got articles written by them, petitions, a list of front groups, as long as my arm, on a piece of paper, typed up. They even have all of their Communist Party USA numbers. They present them publicly.
- 6.80 And these guys, John Howard Lawson and the others, what do they do? They respond with, "Fascist, Nazi." Starts screaming, "This is like Hitler's Germany, Reichstag, Nazi." They never stop and say, "Yeah, you're right. We're communists. We're secretly committed to the Soviet government. We swore loyalty to the Soviet Union." But here they are on the screen.

- 6.81** As you can see, that's John Howard Lawson, the Hollywood Ten. They were all members of the Communist Party. Was that declassified like the end of the Cold War? No, they had them in 1947. That's why they were so mad, so angry. They were exposed. Every single one of them. Now, you can argue whether or not they should be blacklisted, whether or not they should be banned from writing in Hollywood.
- 6.82** Ronald Reagan testified in October 1947 as a friendly witness. So did Gary Cooper, Robert Montgomery, and a few others. Reagan's view was, "I believe that we as a country can survive this. If you can be whatever you want to be in this country. But on the other hand, if they're secretly committed to Stalin's Soviet Union, that might be an altogether other issue. We might have to think about that a little bit differently. They swore loyalty oaths to the Soviet Union." So there they are: the Committee for the First Amendment.
- 6.83** When Humphrey Bogart and these other people, who were liberals and not pro-communists, found out about this, Bogart flipped. I've got a long chapter on Bogart in my book, *Dupes*. He said, "You, F-word, right? You, F-word, you sold me out. You lied to me. You lied to me." And you never hear today among the American left, criticism of these communists who lied to all the progressives and almost ruined the careers of the progressives because they were such liars about it.
- 6.84** On the Hollywood Ten, here's two prominent members: Dalton Trumbo and John Howard Lawson. Now, before I read those quotes, Vladimir Lenin was really into films. And he said, "Of all the arts, for us, the most important is cinema." They realized the power of film for propaganda. Reagan said, "Yeah, they want to turn Hollywood, they want to infiltrate Hollywood and turn it into a giant billion-dollar grist mill to foment their communist propaganda." Of course, they want Hollywood. They could do more with Hollywood than they can with other institutions in America.
- 6.85** Grigory Zinoviev, remember him, the head of the Soviet Comintern, who said, "Global Civil War is the watchword of the day?" He said this, "Motion pictures can and must become a mighty weapon of communist propaganda for the enlightening of the widest working masses." After Lenin's death, Stalin, in 1928, held his first party conference on cinema. "Yeah, we can really do some good work with films. Really do some good work."
- 6.86** The American comrades in cinema know this. One of the Hollywood Ten, writer Dalton Trumbo, you see the quote on your screen, wrote in 1946, "Every screenwriter worth his salt wages the battle in his own way, a literary guerrilla warfare. To not employ the medium of film would be tantamount to abandoning the struggle altogether."
- 6.87** So, comrade, you must—you have a responsibility, a duty, especially remember Lenin's speech of the Communist Youth League, right? You should spend every single minute and purpose of your day and life advancing communism. These are true believers, so

much so that they've joined the Communist Party under Stalin. So they're certainly going to use their craft, their medium, to advance communism.

- 6.88** John Howard Lawson was the worst of them. No one liked Lawson, and he liked nobody. Trumbo was actually liked and a fun guy. And by the way, I should point out here, to be fair, he wrote some really good scripts— I mean, these guys did, what's the movie about the bombing of Japan? "Thirty Seconds Over Tokyo." The other one in the green room here, there's a framed picture of Audrey Hepburn from "Breakfast at Tiffany's." I love Audrey Hepburn. He wrote "Roman Holiday," which is Audrey Hepburn as a young princess in Rome on a holiday with Gregory Peck. So these guys wrote some scripts that didn't have communist propaganda, in their defense.
- 6.89** But Lawson—who was just an angry man, feared inside and outside the party—was known as Hollywood's commissar. In his book, which is called *Film in the Battle of Ideas*, which was published by Masses and Mainstream. Right there, that's a tip-off as to where Lawson is coming from. So he candidly told his comrades, he instructed them. "As a writer"— this is very shrewd and Machiavellian, isn't it?—"do not try to write an entire Communist picture." If you do that, you're going to get exposed. But "try to get five minutes of Communist doctrine, five minutes of the party line"—that would be the Soviet Stalinist line—"in every script that you write. It is your duty to further the class struggle by your performance."
- 6.90** I should add the one thing that drove a number of people out of the American Communist Party: Jewish American Communists were really upset when Stalin signed the pact with Hitler, launching World War II. Really honked off. A lot of them at that point left the Communist Party because they could no longer support the Soviet Union. They became lowercase-c communists, or they followed Trotsky and the Socialist Workers Party. These dudes were still in the Communist Party even long after the Hitler-Stalin Pact. This is the late 1940s. They apparently couldn't care less. Although several of these scriptwriters were Jewish, I believe. I don't try to follow who's Jewish and who's not, but I think several of them were.
- 6.91** We've got about 10 minutes. There's so much more here that I could hit upon, and I'm anticipating some of your questions dealing with some of these people, too.
- 6.92** The American Communist Party did what communists do: infiltrate. They infiltrated as many parts of society as they could. Film, obviously, education. Gramsci is credited with the phrase "the long march through the institutions." Somebody else said it. But Gramsci talked about the conveyor belts of culture: education, film.
- 6.93** And of course, they infiltrated the US government as well. The list of people in the FDR administration, they pounded the Roosevelt administration because it was the 1930s. A Democratic administration that was very left-leaning, had the New Deal, had the AAA. The government was doing incredibly powerful things with agriculture. So this became

just a hotbed for American communists to try to infiltrate the American government. And they didn't tell people who they were. They kept this secret.

- 6.94** Some of the major names—some of them were outright Party members. Others were communists who didn't want to join the Party because then they could be exposed, but did the work of the Soviet Union. Some of them actually worked for the Soviet Union. Some of the names—I should have them up on the screen, but I don't. Some of the names: Harry Dexter White was one. People watching this can look them up. Pressman, Lee Pressman. Lauchlin Currie was a big one. Harold Glasser. Alger Hiss. We all know Alger Hiss. That led to the Hiss Chambers trial. I could talk a long time about that.
- 6.95** Harry Hopkins was so close to FDR and FDR's wife, the first lady, Eleanor, that he actually had a room at the White House, a bedroom at the White House.
- 6.96** The Venona papers, which are decrypted communications between the Soviet Union and the American Communist Party during World War II in the 1940s, they were eventually decrypted and interpreted, published, and released by Congress in the 1980s and 1990s. Herb Romerstein, who I've mentioned several times, did a book on the Venona papers, the Venona Project. And they told us 40, 50 years later, a lot of names of a lot of people that we now know were spies.
- 6.97** A mysterious person in the Venona papers is Agent 19. Some believe that Agent 19 was Harry Hopkins, who actually went to Moscow and met with Stalin. Alger Hiss went with FDR to Yalta, among other places. So these guys became major agents of influence.
- 6.98** Now, I should say with Harry Hopkins as Agent 19, some of my friends in the anticommunist movement, historian scholars who are really good, like my friend Ron Radosh, he believes that Hopkins was not Agent 19. Romerstein, on the other hand, got angry at me. He said—he talked in a scratchy voice—"In the book, you suggest that Hopkins isn't Agent 19, or there's doubt about it. There's no doubt about it. There's no question." Ron Radosh the other time was like, "Herb's full of it. He's not an agent." So there's debate among these things.
- 6.99** But at the very least, if Hopkins wasn't an agent of influence or a spy, he was a dupe. Oftentimes, that could be even worse. The guy that comes back to the president says, "Look, Mr. President, you know I'm no Communist. I think those people are barbarians. But I think we can trust Stalin, and"—to quote FDR—"that he will work with you to build a world of peace and democracy." "Well, thank you, Harry, for your counsel, my friend. We shall do that."
- 6.100** According to Mark Kramer, who was Director of—still is, I believe—of Harvard's Cold War History Project; Mark's really good, very fair, fair-minded scholar: "The Venona papers revealed that more than 350 Americans, including numerous high-level US government officials and key scientists working on the Manhattan Project, were spying for Soviet intelligence agencies in the late 1930s and the 1940s." So over 350 Americans, including numerous high-level US government officials and key scientists

working on the Manhattan Project, were spying for Soviet intelligence agencies in the 1930s, 1940s.

- 6.101** That's pretty remarkable. And a lot of them were in the US government. When Joe McCarthy said that he had a list of however many people made fun of it, McCarthy was way under that number. He wasn't even close to that number.
- 6.102** I have a document, a declassified FBI document, March 2, 1948. It's an FBI document trying to calculate how many Communist Party members there were in the United States. It said that approximately 30,000 Communist Party members live in the New York City area alone. Almost 50% of all Communist Party members in the United States are located in the New York area. So New York was the hotbed. The Party was started in Chicago. It was also a lot of members on the West Coast. But New York, New York, New York: 30,000 members in New York City alone during that period.
- 6.103** I got about three minutes here on this. Speaking of the Manhattan Project, there were the Rosenbergs. There they are, Ethel and Julius Rosenberg. They were both what? Executed for atomic espionage. Some people say today that they think, to the extent that execution is morally justified, but that Julius legally deserved it or had it coming legally. But they think that Ethel should not have been executed. I don't—people can dig into that. Julius's code name for the Soviets was "Liberal." They called him "Liberal." Executed in 1953.
- 6.104** In fact, the best work on the Manhattan Project, read some of the aforementioned Ron Radosh—Ron Radosh is R-A-D-O-S-H—including Ron's final interview with Mort Sobell, S-O-B-E-L-L. Mort Sobell talks about the guilt of Julius Rosenberg. So they took information from the Manhattan Project.
- 6.105** Who else, of course, was suspected at the Manhattan Project? J. Robert Oppenheimer. And Oppenheimer, I don't think we ever found out that he was a Party member. But he had a brother who was, and was surrounded by people, written checks to the Party. He was, at the very least, at one point, a small-c communist. But I don't think there's ever been any proof that he pilfered information from the Manhattan Project and gave it to the Soviets.
- 6.106** By the way, they were trying to build the bomb, people like Oppenheimer, because they were planning to use it against Hitler and the Nazis. So they could be communists dedicated to the Soviet Union and do great work researching the bomb for the United States. But Hitler committed suicide and Germany surrendered at the start of May 1945. And the bomb was not tested at Alamogordo, in New Mexico, until mid-July 1945. So it ends up being used on Japan rather than on Germany.
- 6.107** One more here, and then we'll end with this. Lee Harvey Oswald, the man who assassinated John F. Kennedy, was a dedicated communist. He was a Marine, member of the US military, sharpshooter, loved the Soviet Union. His fellow Marines actually called him "Osvaldovitch," made fun of him, met a R woman that he fell in love with

and married, reached out to the Soviets, we now know, and even in Mexico City, reached out to the Cubans to see if he could get their support because he wanted to assassinate the President of the United States.

- 6.108** He was a loner type from the South, fatherless, looking for a cause, who went up north with his mother to New York City, completely apolitical, and then one day he's walking down the street—this is in the Warren Commission report—comes across a leftist Communist Party USA member who's handing out leaflets about the racist American government, anti-Semitic government, unjustly executing the Rosenbergs and gives him a mouthful of communist propaganda. He goes straight to the New York Public Library, starts researching Marx, and becomes this ideological communist.
- 6.109** Eventually decides that he really wants to execute John F. Kennedy because of what Kennedy did with the Bay of Pigs and Cuban Missile Crisis, because Oswald's top favorite communist was Fidel Castro. That's why he shot JFK. I'll take a few questions.
- 6.110** Question about this. You actually just mentioned New York, but I was thinking of Chicago as the hotbed. In modern politics, I know Obama got a start in Chicago.
- 6.111** Yeah, right.
- 6.112** Do you feel like that subversive communism spreading really got its base in Chicago and then started to spread from there?
- 6.113** Yeah. Chicago was a hotbed. Chicago was a base of operations. I had additional slides here that I was going to hit today, but I ran out of time on it. Maybe I might do it in the next time we meet. Bill Ayers, Bernardine Dohrn, all that whole Chicago group that became part of the Weather Underground, they were Students for a Democratic Society, Tom Hayden, who came up out of Michigan. But Chicago was, yeah, just a political ideological zoo. It goes way back.
- 6.114** There's a reason why the explosion that happened at the Democratic Convention in 1968 was in Chicago. That was far radical leftist, communist leftist going after Democrats on that case. They weren't protesting the Republican Convention. So, yeah, it would be—you'd put Chicago in the top three. I'd have to say Chicago and New York were the top two. It begins in Chicago, but very quickly, New York becomes the headquarters of everything, including the Daily Worker, including Communist Party USA. And then way too many end up in Los Angeles. In fact, Los Angeles, the publication out there on the West Coast is People's World. So they were very active out there, too.
- 6.115** I should note, since I mentioned JFK, Sirhan Sirhan, the assassin of Robert F. Kennedy, was operating out of Los Angeles and was a communist. People don't realize that. But if you look at Sirhan Sirhan's very chilling published diary called RFK Must Die, and he writes over and over again, "RFK Must Die, RFK Must Die, RFK Must Die, Must Die, Honored Before June 6, 1968,"—June fifth, 1968—which was the anniversary of the Six-

Day War in Israel. And he also writes in there, "Long-lived communism, long-lived communism, long-lived communism," over and over again. So he was motivated by it as well.

- 6.116** What are the most important details to consider in the context of the Red Scare?
- 6.117** Well, I would say that one thing the American left has done with this is that every investigation of communist infiltrators in the United States, they've described it as a Red Scare.
- 6.118** But the first was the Alexander Mitchell Palmer raids. Alexander Mitchell Palmer, known as the Fighting Quaker, was a progressive Democrat who worked for Woodrow Wilson. So even before Joe McCarthy, almost everybody who's made any concerted attempt, organized attempt, to expose communist infiltration in the United States—J. Edgar Hoover's FBI, House Committee on Un-American Activities, Joe McCarthy, Alexander Mitchell Palmer, who worked for Woodrow Wilson—the left will describe it as this overheated, paranoid, red under every bed investigation, a merciless, antidemocratic, search for communists that don't really exist.
- 6.119** Arthur Miller, who was a Communist, compared it to the Crucible, to the witch trials. And I quote in Dupes, Elia Kazan's wife, who, I think, said something like, "Well, the difference between the two is that witches in Salem didn't really exist, but communists in Hollywood do, and they're all over the place."
- 6.120** So the communists would deny it. And then the left— a curious psychological element with this, Richard Pipes and others have talked about it. With the American left, what you find is a curious, not so much pro-communism. Here I'm talking about liberals and progressives, but anti-anticommunism. They don't like anticommunists. They hate anticommunists.
- 6.121** I've given presentations like this in liberal academic settings, and they're staring at me like I'm crazy, like the ghost of Joe McCarthy has flown into the room and leapt inside of my body. And I want to say, well, is anything that I'm saying false? They killed 100 million people. It's like, yeah, this is distasteful. Something about anti-communism just really bothers them. It's like a psychological thing. Maybe spiritual, too. I think a lot of this is spiritual.
- 6.122** Were there any other countries the communists were similarly prioritizing to infiltrate, like America?
- 6.123** Oh, yeah. Certainly, all through Europe and in the UK. Major atomic breaches there. Certainly, all throughout Western Europe.
- 6.124** When I talk about the infiltration of churches in the next lecture, one of the reasons they go after American churches is because they so quickly capture the churches in Eastern Europe. But that was easier for them to do there because they had captured

those governments. Actually, infiltrating American churches would be harder for them to do.

6.125 But yeah, in the Manhattan Project, we got the bomb. I think we tested at Alamogordo, July 16 or 17, 1945. The Soviets tested four years later, and that was a big shock. No one expected the Soviets to get the bomb that quick, and they got it because they had help from people who stole atomic secrets. So this infiltration had real direct results on the arms race. You name it. Sure.

Lecture 7: Church Infiltration

At a glance — Church infiltration.

- 7.1** Okay, everybody, welcome back. So lecture seven in this series on Marx and Marxism. We're now into American communism. In the last lecture we talked about everything from FDR to the Rosenbergs, even mentioned Lee Harvey Oswald.
- 7.2** As a transition into this next topic, I thought I would mention, too—I didn't quite get to him because we ran out of time. But I would have talked a little bit about Frank Marshall Davis. Frank Marshall Davis was a mentor to Barack Obama. In fact, he's referred to repeatedly in Obama's memoir, *Dreams from My Father*, simply as Frank. Obama doesn't give his full name. But it would later be admitted by the Obama campaign that Frank is indeed Frank Marshall Davis.
- 7.3** I did a whole book on Davis. It's called *The Communist*, and that's the lead title. And the reason I ended up doing the book was because I had the help of an amazing assistant, a student at NYU, at New York University, who helped identify for me this giant cache of documents from Davis, including all of the articles that he wrote for the *Honolulu Record*, which was the Communist Party newspaper in Honolulu.
- 7.4** He eventually went from Chicago to Honolulu and started agitating while he was there. I also got a hold of Frank Marshall Davis's FBI file. So his declassified FBI file, which a friend of mine filed a FOIA request for, Freedom of Information Act request. It's about 600 pages, that file. You can find it online. So it's now posted online.
- 7.5** And you'll see in there, among other things, you'll see his Communist Party USA number, which I have memorized, 47544. We even put it in the front of the book, 47544, just so people would know this guy actually pledged himself to the party, was a party member, was quite literally a card-carrying Communist.
- 7.6** Frank Marshall Davis is one of those guys that joined the party during World War II, after the Hitler-Stalin Pact. So at a time when a lot of people, as I said, especially American Jews who were communists, bolted the party because they were disgusted by the Hitler-Stalin Pact. But that was no drawback to Frank Marshall Davis. He went right ahead with it.
- 7.7** He was called before the Senate Internal Security Subcommittee in December 1956. When he got there and was asked the question, "Are you now or have you ever been a member of a Communist Party?" He just bang, bang, bang, bang, pleaded the Fifth Amendment every time. They said, "Well, we have here, Mr. Davis, that you did this. What's your response to that?" "Fifth Amendment." "Okay, well, we also have here that you did this. Your response?" "Fifth Amendment." "Well, we also have, Mr. Davis—your response?" Same response, fifth. "Okay, Mr. Davis, I see this isn't going to go very far."

- 7.8** The irony of all of this, too, is that people like Frank were pledged. They swore that loyalty oath to the Soviet Union and basically the Soviet Constitution. Here they are, they're wrapping themselves in the American Constitution in order for their protection. It's the height of irony.
- 7.9** You also see in the case of Frank Marshall Davis, that we saw with many members of the American Communist Party that they were placed on the Security Index, which was an FBI index roster of names of people who, because they were pledged to the Soviet Union and Communist Party members, there was a fear that if war broke out between the United States and the USSR, they would serve the enemy. If they were on the Security Index, they could be arrested or taken into custody in that case because they were considered internal subversive threats from within.
- 7.10** This guy, Frank Marshall Davis, who ends up later in the 1960s being this father-like figure to young Barack Obama, was on the Security Index. And the way that Obama got in touch with him—this says a lot about Barack Obama's upbringing.
- 7.11** Obama was raised by a single mom. His biological father was from Africa, Kenya. They met at the University of Hawaii. They met in a Russian studies course, a Russian language course at the University of Hawaii. They met there, and the father was absent; he was gone. So, Obama was raised by that single mom and the mother's parents. The grandfather was named Stanley Dunham. His mother's name, by the way, too, was Stanley. The father, weirdly, gave the daughter his name; Stanley Ann Dunham was Obama's birth mother's name.
- 7.12** Stanley clearly must have been pretty hard left himself because everybody who was aware of Frank Marshall Davis in that area knew who he was, what an agitator he was. But he was trying to find a mentor, a father figure for his grandson in the late '60s. And of all people, he introduces him to Frank Marshall Davis. In *Dreams from My Father*, Obama quotes these sessions and nuggets of wisdom that he got from Frank.
- 7.13** Knowing all of that, I thought, I've got to write a book about this guy. So my book is about Frank Marshall Davis and also about his influence on Barack Obama. That came out, I think it was 2010, 2012. It's published by Mercury Ink, which is the Glenn Beck imprint for Simon & Schuster.
- 7.14** In a transition to this topic here today, Frank Marshall Davis, who was anti-religion, just like, of course, all of these communists were. When the party went underground in Honolulu, the underground code name for the party was the Church. They called it the Church. So here again, Ronald Reagan—"communism, that religion of theirs." The party to them was like the church, their infallible authority, their source of guidance.
- 7.15** That's a transition to what we're talking about today. We're going to talk about the infiltration of churches by the American Communist Party. It's a shocking thing.

- 7.16** Now, background: they were in the Soviet Union. They didn't have to infiltrate churches. They just took them over. They flat-out took over. They seized churches. They shut them down. They turned them into warehouses, worker shops, shops for workers.
- 7.17** They turned them into museums of atheism. The late great Malcolm Muggeridge talks about himself being an agnostic, if not atheist, and going to one of these atheist museums in Moscow that a church had been converted into, where they ridiculed and made fun of religion. It was so awful to him that one of the things that began Muggeridge on this long journey of faith, eventually. Muggeridge was the guy who discovered Mother Teresa when he was at the BBC and did the documentary series, *Something Beautiful for God*. Muggeridge ends up becoming this great convert to the faith.
- 7.18** But the Soviets would take over these churches. At one point, 1920, 1921, 1922, they took Russian Orthodox—that's the main church in Russia, the Russian Orthodox Church—Russian Orthodox bishops, patriarchs, priests, and they put them on trial. It was called the Moscow Church Trials. They also had the Petrograd Church Trials as well, where they went in and interrogated these people. The main reason that they put them on trial was because the priests and the bishops were saying, "You cannot come in and take these church relics and valuables," which the Soviets started doing.
- 7.19** At one point, they were just blowing up the churches. And they thought, "Well, wait a second. We're broke. Our communist system, obviously, doesn't produce any money. There's a lot of valuables in these churches." So the state started taking, confiscating these relics and valuables.
- 7.20** The church responded by issuing a statement saying, "You can't do this. This belongs to the church, it belongs to the people, it belongs to the faith." And of course, the Soviets turned it into, "You're just greedy. You don't care about the faith of these people. You just care about your jewels," which is typical of these guys. Oh, you're not greedy? You're not trying to take them? So they turn this into a big propaganda thing. They put these different priests on trial. They put these bishops on trial. They go to jail. Some of them are even executed.
- 7.21** Lenin was ruthless in shutting down churches. Stalin was ruthless. Stalin did have somewhat of a change of heart once World War II broke out, and after he was invaded by Hitler and the Nazis, after the Soviet Union was invaded by Hitler and the Nazis, when Hitler betrayed Stalin and the Hitler-Stalin Pact.
- 7.22** At that point, Stalin realized maybe he should bring faith back a little bit because they were losing. How many people died in World War II? 50, 60 million? And the numbers that were from the Soviet Union, 20, 30 million? Just like World War I, they lost way more people than everybody else. The United States and the UK lost 300,000, 400,000 people. The Russians, the Soviets lost 40 times that amount, 20, 30 million altogether.

- 7.23 So Stalin, at that period, realized maybe he shouldn't crack down on religion so hard because the babushkas, the mothers of these young boys, needed something to cling to. They needed to get through the war. Stalin, at that point, laid off on religion a little bit.
- 7.24 Then, when he died in March 1953, and Khrushchev eventually comes in in 1953, Khrushchev did a re-crackdown on religion. This went on in the Soviet Union until Mikhail Gorbachev called off the war on religion in the late 1980s. As Gorbachev said, "My predecessors declared a wholesale war on religion. It was completely unjustified. It was very vicious. It was very ruthless." And that eventually leads to a renaissance of religion in Russia after that point, especially under Boris Yeltsin.
- 7.25 They even rebuilt the great church in Moscow that Stalin had dynamited in the 1930s. But over there, the way they handled religion was they just squashed it with the iron fist. They shut it down. They shut down churches. They arrested people. Religion was the opiate of the masses. They just declared a war on religion when they went into Eastern Europe after World War II, when they took Eastern Europe, when the Iron Curtain went down in Eastern Europe after World War II, same thing, communists in Czechoslovakia, East Germany, Romania, wherever they could.
- 7.26 The one place—I'll talk about this in lecture eight—where they failed to crack down on the church was Poland. But they tried. They certainly tried. But in those countries, totalitarian regimes, the way to deal with the churches was to shut them down, lock people up. Alexander Solzhenitsyn in his classic book, *The Gulag Archipelago*, says that nuns were put in special sections of the gulag with prostitutes, where they were declared whores to Christ. The Soviets would use that belittling language.
- 7.27 In America, however, this is an altogether different thing. The American communists don't like religion either. As we heard from William Z. Foster's testimony, "I don't know why an American party member would want to be a member of a religion. I suppose we could have some people join the party who have some religious scruples, but they would need to be in the process of liquidating those beliefs. They really wouldn't have any value to us if they were married in a church."
- 7.28 In the case of America, at first they start out, if you read their literature from Communist Party USA, from the *Daily Worker*, from *New Masses*, the publication *New Masses*. Man, they are ridiculing religion. They're showing pastors and priests to be a religious equivalent of the fat-cat capitalist. So they have a lot of derogatory, insulting language propaganda against them.
- 7.29 Then they realize after a while that this isn't going very well. This isn't bringing us any recruits in America. So maybe instead, what we need to do—we, communists in America, we're not in charge here like we are in the Soviet Union. In America, we have freedom of religion. 90-plus percent of the country at that point was Christian. Probably 98% of people believed in God at that point.

- 7.30** We need a different approach in America in dealing with this. So, among other things, they decide to infiltrate churches. They're going to have party members who claim to be religious, who will go into the seminaries of the mainline denominations, and also into the Catholic Church as well.
- 7.31** So, I will talk about that here now. Infiltrating the churches, they really hit hard the mainline denominations, especially the Episcopal Church, the United Methodist Church. There's a group called the Methodist Federation for Social Action, which really served as a front group for communists who were infiltrating the Methodist Church. They infiltrated what became my former denomination: the Presbyterian Church USA. So the mainline Presbyterian Church, they hit hard.
- 7.32** Earl Browder, who was the General Secretary of the Communist Party USA, following William Z. Foster—remember, William Z. Foster was head in 1929 to 1934. He's the guy that Hamilton Fish was talking to. Browder has an altogether different approach. Browder is really slick. Browder even befriends FDR, and FDR likes Browder. And Browder comes up with this new policy, especially toward the Catholic Church, called the Outstretched Hand. Instead, the approach is not that religion is for superstitious idiots, opium of the people, spiritual booze.
- 7.33** Instead, the approach is that you religious people should like us, communists. "From each according to his ability, to each according to his needs." Acts 4:32, 4:35, they shared everything in common. We love workers, too. So they use a totally different approach, and at the same time, they are surreptitiously infiltrating churches.
- 7.34** Earl Browder, who was General Secretary of Communist Party USA, spoke to Union Theological Seminary in New York. Now, Union Theological Seminary is to this day a very left-wing religious left seminary. He spoke there on February 15, 1935, and he said—and this is quite a statement. Think about this. He tells this group of seminarians, "You may be interested in knowing that we have preachers, preachers active in churches who are members of the Communist Party." Well, that's astonishing. You have preachers, preachers who are active in churches who are actual members of Communist Party USA?
- 7.35** Foster would have never thought that that could have been possible. Presumably, if that's the case, these are wolves in sheep's clothing. These are people that are going in and actually infiltrating, clearly.
- 7.36** Ben Gitlow—I had mentioned Ben Gitlow in the last lecture. Gitlow is G-I-T-L-O-W. He was one of the leading American communists.
- 7.37** I should note here, too, that a lot of this is in my book, *The Devil and Karl Marx*. An interesting reaction from people who read this book, they said, "Wow, the stuff on Marx and the devil, they were all really new, shocking. The things about how the Soviets treated religious people, the Romanian prison of Pitesti and the torture that went on there, and the unbelievable way that they laid priests on the ground and on

crosses and had prisoners come by and urinate on them and try to force these priests to consecrate excrement and give it to people, dubbing Mary the Great Whore—unbelievable stuff. Shocking, shocking."

7.38 "But, Professor Kengor, the section that really shocked me the most was on infiltrating the churches. I never knew any of this." They would point out, "After reading your book, I know that we knew because the people that you quote"—I'm going to quote them now—"Ben Gitlow, Manning Johnson, Herb Philbrick, Bella Dodd, they're testifying before Congress about this." This made the newspapers. It wasn't closed session. Some of the testimony, especially with Bella Dodd, was closed session.

7.39 But these things were said out in the open, under oath, before Senate committees, before House committees. And Ben Gitlow, who had been VP, Communist Party USA, ran for vice president of the United States on the Communist Party ticket. He left the party in the late 1920s.

7.40 And he would say this to Congress in sworn testimony under oath, July 7, 1953: "The Russian communists were the first to exploit ministers of the United States, and through them, the church organizations for the purpose of spreading propaganda in favor of communist Russia and for the building up of a pro-Soviet sentiment among church people in America and among Americans, generally."

7.41 So first, they'll try to say things like, the Soviet Union is not your enemy. Just like you Christians, they want to help the poor. They want to help the working man. When they talk about private property, they want to share the private property, like the Apostles did in the first century.

7.42 However, then it gets rather dark where they start to actually infiltrate churches and not tell people what they're doing. Here is the case of Manning Johnson. He is one of my favorite figures from the Cold War. Black American. He left the party in large part because Manning really never left his faith. He was brought up Baptist, continued to go to church while he was a communist, and realized that they didn't want him doing that. And eventually, his conscience—he becomes very conflicted, and he leaves the party.

7.43 Here's what he told Congress: "The plan [of the American Communist Party] was to make the seminaries the neck of a funnel through which thousands of potential clergymen would issue forth. The communists have an advantage in religious organizations due to the fact that their forces within religious groups are well-organized and they work unceasingly toward a premeditated program."

7.44 This is the thing about the comrades; remember Lenin's speech to the Communist Youth League. They spend every moment of their day thinking of this stuff. They get up in the morning and think about: How do we advance the cause? How do we advance our faith? Or to borrow from Frank Marshall Davis: How do we advance the church? How do we do this?

- 7.45 "I know from my own experience," said Manning Johnson—this is fascinating. Think about this: "If we had an organization with 10,000 members and there were only 60 or 70 communists, we could control the organization. We could control it. So with a small minority of ministers who work in an organized manner, they can always win over and subvert and dupe the majority who are disorganized." He said that you needed only about 1% of the membership to be your guys.
- 7.46 I've seen this—I won't name names, it'll just get me in trouble—with different mainstream organizations in the United States. And I've seen it with different churches, different denominations, where you'll get a very committed cadre of a few dozen people, maybe a couple of hundred. And if they're working together around the clock and really hell-bent, focused on what they want to do, they eventually tire out everybody else. The others eventually say, "You know what? I've had enough of this. I don't like this. I don't like what they're doing. I'm leaving."
- 7.47 And they go join another organization. They go start another church. In fact, I think a lot of the rise in nondenominational evangelical Protestantism is because of this push to the left of the mainline denominations, some of it by communists, others just a general push to the left. A lot of people just said, "Well, forget that. I'm not going to be in that denomination anymore. I'll go down here to this church, which is independent and has this great preacher who's given great sermons, and the place is on fire for the Lord. I don't need them anymore. Let that denomination go."
- 7.48 I've also seen people within the denominations who hang in there and continue to fight and try to stay on the board or the council or the national convention or whatever. And eventually, they get worn out, too. "I'm done fighting. I'll just start a different Presbyterian group or church."
- 7.49 In fact, Presbyterian Church USA, which I was a member of, as I said, eventually split into two and is now two different Presbyterian denominations. PC USA continues to become the great shrinking denomination. The numbers on the mainline used to be really, really high, but they're getting lower and lower and lower.
- 7.50 But Manning Johnson's point—with just 60 or 70 committed members, comrades—he saw again and again how they could subvert, influence, take over an organization with 10,000 members. It says a lot about the power of effective organizing, which the radical left is really good at doing.
- 7.51 More here from Manning Johnson's Senate testimony. He said, "In the early 1930s, the Communists instructed"—think about this. "In the early 1930s, the Communists instructed thousands of their members to rejoin their ancestral religious groups"—this guy was a party member, right?—"and to operate in cells designed to take control of churches for Communist purposes."
- 7.52 So they find out, "So you were religious in your time. I know you now think it's the opium of the people. Which denomination were you a member of? You know the

prayers, you know the actions, you know when they meet, how they do the services. Go back in and rejoin. See what you can do. Don't tell them you're a Communist. See what you could do."

- 7.53** "This method was not only propounded but was executed with enormous success among large elements of American church life. Communists operated a double-pronged infiltration, both through elements of Communist-controlled clergy and Communist-controlled laymen; they managed to pervert and weaken entire stratas of religious life in the United States." Pretty insidious, isn't it? That you could even go in there and lie about what you believe.
- 7.54** But then again, by the way, is that moral? Is that ethical? Remember what Lenin said? "There's such a thing as communist ethics and communist morality. Whatever advances the interests of the class of our cause is moral, is ethical." Manning Johnson, again, speaking to the Senate under oath. Communists created cells and "small forces" in seminaries. The word cells was a popular phrase. There was the Hal Ware, W-A-R-E, Ware, cell that was in AAA under FDR. They would create these little cells, groups, units that were like units of infiltration.
- 7.55** Communists created cells and "small forces" in seminaries. These in turn were quickly augmented by new recruits, promoted up, and "siphoned into the divinity institutions" and "educational institutions." An actual "plan" to reorient seminaries to generate potentially "thousands" of pro-communist clergymen commenced. Johnson said, rather cynically, "Through Reds in religion, we have a true living example of the old saying, 'The devil doth quote the Scripture.'" So they'd be in there quoting the Scripture, but in fact, they don't believe any of it.
- 7.56** They created thousands of front groups. The American League Against War and Fascism, I mentioned in the last class, last lecture. The American Peace Mobilization, I mentioned. The Progressive Citizens Alliance—that's one that Reagan was familiar with. Most of these prominent in the titles were words like "progressive" and "democratic." But in fact, they weren't genuine progressives at all. They were Marxists.
- 7.57** Another person who testified to this, Herb Philbrick, was really well known, a household name in the 1950s. He did a book called I Led Three Lives, which eventually became a TV series that was widely watched. And in his case, unlike Manning Johnson, Ben Gitlow, and some of the others who had been Communist Party members and were involved in infiltrating churches, Philbrick had never been a Communist, but actually went and served the FBI and went underground and pretended to be one and observed what was going on in the churches in his area in Massachusetts.
- 7.58** Here's what he said. "The Communist Party had"—and again, this is to the Senate, April 7, 1951—"the Communist Party had in its pro-group section between seven to eight individuals. These were hardened, disciplined, steeled party members posing as ministers of the gospel. [All had been] communists prior to their becoming ministers. I

had many contacts in the religious field. I was widely known as a church youth leader among the Christian movement in the New England area."

- 7.59 And get this quote—boy, is this cynical and devious, isn't it? The advice, instructions that were given to Philbrick when he was handed his Communist Party membership card. And when he was handed this card, remember, he's not an actual Communist. He's underground, so they don't know that he's a non-communist. They think he's a comrade.
- 7.60 They told him, "If you are questioned or if you are charged to be a member of the Communist Party, you will swear on a stack of Bibles that high"—that's what Philbrick said—"that you are not and never have been a member of this organization." In other words, lie. But then again, lying is moral if it, according to Lenin, advances class interests. That's communist ethics. That's communist morality. Sure, we have moral rules based on whatever advances the proletariat.
- 7.61 You could watch online some old episodes of "I Led Three Lives." If you go on YouTube and check it out, it's kind of fun to watch. What a different world it was back then.
- 7.62 Another major person who turned on the party, Louis Budenz. Budenz, B-U-D-E-N-Z. Louis Budenz. He had been editor of the Daily Worker. So he was brought into the faith by Bishop Fulton Sheen, who I'll talk about a lot next when I focus on Bella Dodd, who also brought Bella Dodd into the faith. In fact, Sheen converted Budenz to the faith while Budenz's name was still in the masthead of the Daily Worker. I think that's great, and it's really funny.
- 7.63 So Budenz told Congress on November 22, 1946, "The Communists everywhere planned to wage war on the Catholic Church as the base for obliterating all religion." And in this, they would seek the help of a master organizer, and that is Bella Dodd.
- 7.64 So I've talked about Manning Johnson, who had been a Baptist. I think Philbrick, as well, was a Baptist. Ben Gitlow. Gitlow was Jewish. So now we'll look at the case of how they went after the Catholic Church. And the story here that I want to focus on for the last half hour of this presentation is Bella Dodd.
- 7.65 I wrote a book on Bella Dodd, and it was called The Devil and Bella Dodd. So it was the follow-up to The Devil and Karl Marx. The way that came about was that we started getting information on Bella Dodd that we never had before. In fact, through the help of a friend, I filed a FOIA request to get Bella Dodd's FBI file released. That's one of the biggest FBI files I've ever seen, and that was classified for one of the longest periods of time that I've ever seen. I think in part because of the sheer nature of some of her revelations and what she was telling to Congress, often in closed session, not just at open session, but closed session as well.
- 7.66 I did The Devil and Karl Marx through TAN Books, a wonderful publishing house, and they wanted to do another book like that. I said, "Well, I don't know how many 'devil

and' books I could do." I said, "However, I've got a pretty good one for you," because Bella Dodd talked about how her being into the party was like a seductive, satanic attraction. She believed that the devil himself was behind the Communist conspiracy.

7.67 And unlike Karl Marx, she described her break from communism as trying to break from the clutches of the devil. So in her case, it's like a story of redemption. Her case has a happy ending, unlike Karl Marx. So I did a book called *The Devil and Bella Dodd*. All right.

7.68 So Bella Dodd, she was born with this beautiful name, Maria Assunta Isabella Visono, in Picerno, Italy, in 1904. So this sweet little Italian Catholic girl in Picerno, Italy. I mean, what could go wrong with a name like Maria Assunta Isabella Visono? Maria—a name for the Blessed Mother. Assunta for the Assumption. Isabella means beautiful. And then Visono.

7.69 She's born there in Italy, 1904. Her family comes to America, really, at the exact same time my family came to America from Italy, on my Italian side. My dad's Polish, but on my mom's side, my mom's 100% Italian. They came at almost the same time, not from the same area. My folks, my people, were from Calabria, Italy. But she eventually— it's harder for her to get there, and she stays with these two beautiful people that helped raise her until she could get to America, Tadeo and Mammarella.

7.70 In 1909, she goes to New York City. Remember, that's the hotbed of communism. She goes into public schools. She goes to Evander Childs High School in the Bronx and is immediately introduced to socialism, and has young students around her who are socialists. She goes to college at Hunter College, which is on the Upper East Side of New York, on the East Side of Central Park. It's there that she's radicalized by a professor, an English professor named Sarah Parks.

7.71 By the way, English is one of the most radical majors that you could take in college. I get students all the time who are like, "I love to read. I like *Pride and Prejudice* and Brontë and Dickens and all. I'd like to go study this in graduate school." Then they go there, and they find out they go to a school like Duke, and they're studying Shakesqueer. You can look it up, by the way—Shakesqueer. Look it up. You'll see it. You're like, "Holy cow, he's right. Duke has a program on Shakesqueer. There's a whole book on it." Yeah, but it's one of those majors—English, education—that has just been radicalized. It shouldn't be ideologized at all, but it is. Even more so than economics and political science.

7.72 So, she's radicalized by a teacher at Hunter College named Sarah Parks. She also, following up with Hunter College, went really full communist when she attended the Marxist hotbed of Columbia University. Columbia, right? Again and again and again. Columbia, Columbia, Columbia.

7.73 That's where Whittaker Chambers entered in the late 1910s as this apolitical, Republican-leaning kid from Long Island comes out a raving Marxist who ends up

spying for the Soviets. Thomas Merton, immigrant, born 1915, comes over from France, goes to Columbia, ends up joining the Communist Youth League at Columbia. So this place is just—Columbia has just been infamous for radicalizing people like this.

- 7.74** She eventually—her quote, this is quite the quote: "Step by step," said Bella Dodd, "I retreated from God and went forth to meet the world, the flesh, and the Devil." She would write this later in her book *School of Darkness*.
- 7.75** She went into education. She was an educator, majored in education, became an educator. That became her thing for the party. And through Sarah Parks at Hunter, through the socialism she learned at Evander Childs School in the Bronx, through what she learned at Columbia, she's being drawn further and further in the 1920s, 1930s into the Communist orbit.
- 7.76** She testified that she started working very closely with the Communist Party" from the time that I first became interested in 1932 until the time that I became the legislative representative of the Communist Party in New York City." That's a big job. She became really one of the highest-ranking members of the Communist Party for a woman in the history of the United States Communist Party. A few others that I would put in that category, but she was very, very high ranking.
- 7.77** By 1935, she was so trusted by the party that she was invited to secret meetings, caucus meetings. And then in 1943—this is a big step—she agreed to join the party as an open member. That's when you really showed your cards, right? "I'm so committed, I'm not even going to hide it. Here's my card. I am a party member. I'm a party leader. I'm a party organizer."
- 7.78** She told Congress that from 1932 on, "I was under discipline from the Communist Party." And when you're under party discipline, you do not break ranks. "Well, comrade, I'm uneasy about this pact that the dear leader, Stalin, has signed with that monster, Hitler. I thought we hated his guts." "You're not allowed to express that view, comrade. We've sworn a loyalty oath to the Soviet Union and to the Comintern. Retract that statement now." "I'm sorry, sir. I've been feeling ill lately and sick. I'm sorry." These were not places for debate. 1944 to '48, Bella was a member of the National Committee of the American Communist Party. So very high ranking, very high ranking.
- 7.79** Being this one-time sweet Italian girl from a huge family with a bunch of siblings, they're all about family, family, family. *Alla famiglia* is the Italian phrase: for the family, to the family, all for the family. She wanted kids. She wanted to get married. And she married a fellow whose last name was Dodd. So that's how she ended up with the last name Dodd. But the party told her not to have children.
- 7.80** Her quote: "The bourgeois family as a social unit was to be made obsolete." What did the book say? *Communist Manifesto*: "Abolition of the family!" They have some people say, "I don't know if they really meant abolishing the family." Well, that's how these guys interpreted it. They were in the party.

- 7.81 "I often talked of adopting children, but the comrade dissuaded me." As far as biological children, you were expected to have an abortion if you got pregnant. And Whittaker Chambers and his wife, when they first got married, and she was pregnant, he's thinking right away, "Abortion, that's what you do."
- 7.82 The guy that Whittaker Chambers exposed, Alger Hiss and his wife, Priscilla. Priscilla helped him in all of his spying. Alger Hiss would leave the State Department, his office of the State Department, with a thin folder at the end of the day in his briefcase. He would get home at night, and Priscilla would retype it. And then the next day, he would bring those documents back and refile them. Then those documents would go to a courier, to the party, and eventually to the Soviet Union.
- 7.83 But Hiss and his wife, Priscilla, had no children. And we now know from modern biographies of Chambers, including the wonderful book by The New York Times writer—New York Review of Books—Sam Tanenhaus and Whittaker Chambers, that Priscilla did get pregnant and had an abortion, and it went so bad that she was probably infertile, and they were never able to have children again after that. And that experience wrecked her, really, really destroyed her. But that's what you were expected to do. After all, you're giving your life not to your family or to your spouse. You're giving it to the party.
- 7.84 In later testimony to the US Senate, Dodd said, "Communism is an all-embracing philosophy which embraces everything you do"—of course, that's what Lenin said it was—"which determines the kind of marriage you have, your relations with your children,"—if you have any—"your relationship to your community, your relationship with your profession." All-encompassing.
- 7.85 Her guy that she reported to was Alexander Trachtenberg of the Soviet GPU. This was a bad dude. This guy is like right out of central casting. "So tell me, Dr. Dodd, are you not following the party?" "I'm not feeling well, comrade. I apologize." "We shall see." Almost like a Bond character, right? Like a Bond villain.
- 7.86 And she said this. Alexander Trachtenberg of the Soviet GPU told her, "When we take the United States,"—and Bella Dodd said this several times in speeches, in testimony, in her book: "When we"—meaning the Soviets, the communists—"take the United States, we will not take it under the label of communism; we will not take it under the label of socialism. These labels are unpleasant to the American people, and they've been speared too much. We will take the United States under labels we have made lovable. We will take it under liberalism, under progressivism, under democracy. But take it, we will." They use that word democracy. And Bella Dodd told the Senate, "They always use the word democracy. Democracy, democracy, democracy." But when communists use the word, she said they meant economic democracy.
- 7.87 I didn't cover this with my Lenin talk. I almost did, but I knew I would mention in the Bella Dodd presentation, Lenin said, "Of course, we support democracy." You might

think, "Really? How is that?" He said, "For us, democracy means equality." So, economic equality.

- 7.88** Beware of people. Mao said the same thing; Engels said the same thing. So beware of that when you hear people on the far left saying—and they say this all the time about Donald Trump, right? "Trump is destroying democracy." It's like, "Well, I know that you don't like the guy, but how's he destroying democracy?" We think of democracy like one man, one woman, one vote, elections, freedom of speech, press, religion, First Amendment, freedom of assembly. Are you saying that he's going to go to the National Archives and tear up one of the remaining copies of the Declaration and then— I don't know. What does that mean?
- 7.89** But in their view, they apply a word like democracy in a really broad way. And a lot of the modern American left uses it the same way that the communist left used it. It's almost synonymous with equality.
- 7.90** What equality? It depends on what they want to do. With the communists, classical Marxists, it was economic equality. With today's left, it might be gender equality. It might be marriage equality. That's the phrase that they use. They're really good at sloganeering. When they really want to push something and win a campaign, they put the word equality after it. But yeah, "they always use that word," she said, "democracy."
- 7.91** So, Bella Dodd became the party's chief organizer for the education front. That was her charisma, if you will. That was her focus. She was good at that. She came out of education.
- 7.92** This is extraordinary. Think about this. This shows how good she was at organizing. It also tells you a lot about New York City. She became the New York State Teachers Union, which was one of the first teachers unions. By the way, what was one of the first teachers colleges? Columbia. Columbia University, Columbia Teachers College. That's where John Dewey was. That was one of the first teachers colleges. It had about 10,000 members. She testified to Congress that she helped place over 1,500 communists in the New York State Teachers Union out of 10,000.
- 7.93** When you consider that, what did Manning Johnson say? If he had an organization of 10,000 members, he just needed 60 or 70 communists and they could take it over. Imagine what you could do with 1,500.
- 7.94** I've read some of the conventions with these people, the transcripts. They were thugs. They would take over a floor if somebody even tried to object about their union dues, going to whatever and saying, "I'm just a teacher and I believe in our teachers' rights, but I don't know, why are we issuing statements on Venezuela? Why are we doing that?" Because the comrades in charge are hijacking the organization and turning it into a political front. That's what they're doing with it.

- 7.95** Plus, it's all about education, education, education. In the 1936 May Day parade in New York City, she had 500 communist teachers marching. Extraordinary, isn't it? I quote here again on my slide, the 1948 report from the FBI that's been declassified that says, "Of the roughly 60,000 Communist Party members that they knew of, over half of them lived in New York City alone in the five boroughs of New York City." That's fertile ground. That's where she's organizing.
- 7.96** So she proves herself to the party—Bella Dodd does—as this master organizer. "Bella, you're great." "Comrade Dodd, you are fabulous." So they go to her, "What is your ancestral religion?" "I was raised Catholic, Roman Catholic." "Okay. I think we could use your help in infiltrating the Catholic Church."
- 7.97** Bella Dodd said—and this was the main focus of our biography. I said "our"—I co-authored *The Devil and Bella Dodd* with Dr. Mary Nicholas. And Mary Nicholas has more on Bella Dodd than anybody I know. Kevin Symonds, S-Y-M-O-N-D-S, also has so much great information he's been collecting on Bella Dodd.
- 7.98** But the quote that's attributed to her that's quite sensational and dramatic—she said, "In the 1930s"—this is one of the quotes attributed to her: "In the 1930s, we put eleven hundred men into the priesthood in order to destroy the Church from within. Right now, they are in the highest places in the Church."
- 7.99** There's a number of variations on that quote, and our book is a deep dive into trying to separate these claims, these reported quotes. Generally, she said that she tried to place over a thousand communist men into Catholic seminaries. Over a thousand. Now, that might seem like an incredible number to try to do. But in the book we went through, at that time, there were 60,000 priests, roughly, between guys in seminary, guys out of seminary, between about the 1930s and Vatican II. You're looking at 30,000, 60,000 priests, something like that. If you have somebody who put 1,500 Communist teachers in a 10,000-teacher union, she'd probably think placing 1,000 in Catholic seminaries out of tens of thousands of priests is a cinch. I could do that. Sure. Why not?
- 7.100** She told us that Alice von Hildebrand, Alice von Hildebrand and Dietrich von Hildebrand—Dietrich von Hildebrand, very famous for his resistance to Nazism in Germany, Nazi Germany, married Alice, who was much younger than him. Alice just died a few years ago. She lived a really long time, I think close to 100.
- 7.101** They said they knew Bella Dodd. She did not want to say this publicly about the infiltration of the churches, especially because Bishop Fulton Sheen, who ends up being the figure that brings her back into the church and pulls her out of the clutches of the devil, as she put it, told her, "I don't want you publicly talking about this." This is just too scandalous. It's too scandalous. But she clearly told Sheen about it as we walk through very carefully in the book. And she told Alice and Dietrich about it.
- 7.102** Alice said this. In fact, my colleague, Mary Nicholas, interviewed Alice von Hildebrand. Bella Dodd said to Fulton Sheen, "I want to enter the most severe penitential order that

exists to pay for my sins"—for her sin of this infiltration and what she tried to do. Sheen told her, "No. Instead, I command you to give lectures on communism because these people are blind." They're totally blind to the dangers of communism. That was her order to her instead. She decided, "I need to get out. I need to get out of the party."

- 7.103** But hey, it's like the Hotel California. You could try to check out, but you can never leave. You don't leave the party voluntarily. We excommunicate you from the party. And when we do, we smear you. We destroy you. That's what the comrades believe.
- 7.104** So she left the party. The party issues a press release denouncing her, smearing her. Bella's phone rang. The reporter said, "Hello, Dr. Dodd. This is the Associated Press. We have received a statement from the Communist Party announcing your expulsion. It says here that you are anti-Negro, anti-Puerto Rican, anti-Semitic, anti-labor, and the defender of a landlord. Have you any statement to make?"
- 7.105** The same thing they do today: racist, anti-Semite, hater, bigot, fascist, Nazi. The character assassination had begun, and she explained how it worked. This is good stuff to know because Bella Dodd herself did this for the party. She was one of the people who led the smear campaign against Hamilton Fish, that congressman who humiliated the party by getting all those answers from William Z. Foster. So they had a food chain of smears.
- 7.106** Bella Dodd said, "The Communist Party knew how to fight very effectively against anyone who touched the communist movement. If anyone tried to attack the movement, the party immediately went among the liberals, among its allies, and on various bases got the support and help of these people to smear and to isolate the person. What we would do, of course," she said, "is, first of all, get the attack published in the Communist press, the Daily Worker, Masses & Mainstream, New Masses, and whatever publication the party had."
- 7.107** "The next step, the trade union leaders would understand that this is the official attitude and then use their power within the trade-union movement." All right. Next. "Then we had certain contacts in the newspaper world. We had Communist Party members on the staff of various newspapers. We would contact them and see to it that they would use the publicity to smear the person."
- 7.108** Then the radio. "We had contacts in the radio world. We would use them to see that they were smeared." Next came friendly, fellow traveler, left-wing intellectual professors and ministers. "We had contact with the intellectual world, various committees, professors who we called upon or ministers who we called upon."
- 7.109** She said of one politician she helped destroy, and I think this one was Hamilton Fish, "We built him up into a pro-fascist, anti-Negro, anti-Semitic, anti this and that. Everything which the man has done is blown up so as to create of him a monster and a horror."

- 7.110** Now it was her turn. It was her turn to be attacked and smeared. And she got to put her head down and said, "Well, I guess I deserve it." She became super depressed over all of this. At one point, she feared for her life having left the party. She talked about—we talked about in the book— Julie Points, who was from Nebraska originally, who was a disappeared party member and was killed. Whittaker Chambers worried for his life.
- 7.111** At one point, she said she met with her congressman in DC in his office and said, "Bella, you seem really down, really depressed." She said, "I don't know where to turn. I don't know what to do. I've got the FBI following me. I've got the KGB following me." And he said to her, "I think I should get you to talk to somebody. How about a priest?" And she said, "Yes, yes." She still had the lingerings of faith. And he said to his secretary, "Get Father Fulton Sheen from Catholic University of America on the phone. And see if he'll meet with her."
- 7.112** So she goes over, and she meets with Sheen at his apartment in Washington, DC. And she was really touched. She said he greeted her at the door with a big pectoral cross, everything. And he didn't say to her, "You old Bolshevik, you old bag, look at what you did. Get out of here." Which is what the Bolsheviks would have said. You're anti this, you're anti that. He said, "Doctor, I'm so glad you came. You look unhappy." For the first time, she said, "I knew peace, which I hadn't known for years."
- 7.113** He takes her and walks her over to the tabernacle in this room in front of a statue of the Blessed Mother, and she kneels down to pray, and he puts his hand on her, and she's sobbing, and he says, "There, there, it's okay. It's okay." And when she came up, she was just awash in tears. And he treated her with faith, hope, and charity, with kindness, with decency, and that for her began her pull "out of the clutches of the devil," as she put it. Sheen commands her, says, "Here's what I want you to do? I want you to go tell the world about the dangers of communism." So she made good on that.
- 7.114** In congressional hearings, she was such a tour de force. She had a code name in the Senate. They called her the Falcon. The Falcon. Her 1,300-page FBI file that I talked about that we got declassified by a FOIA request, was not released until 2021, and even then, it's just a portion of it. She became a female Whittaker Chambers, writing, speaking, doing memoirs, speaking nationwide, utterly fearless, warning the world about communism. All of this eventually takes a toll on her.
- 7.115** She did not live long, only into her mid-sixties. April 1969, she went into a coma during a gallbladder surgery at St. Vincent's Hospital in New York, and it became clear that she was slipping away. Just when the staff and everybody was hoping that a priest could come to give her last rites, Fulton Sheen shows up, walks in the door, and she opened her eyes for the first time in hours, if not days. He gives her the anointing of the sick, and she passed. She died. Quite a story. Very touching.
- 7.116** But her advice—and I'll finish with this, this is my last slide on Bella Dodd, infiltration of the Church. When she was asked who was the head of the communist conspiracy, she

said, "I would have to say, and have to identify, that person as Lucifer." Wow. Wow. So not Stalin, not the Comintern—Lucifer.

- 7.117** She said that they were the very worst deceivers and infiltrators because they reject God and morality, and any behavior is deemed acceptable or moral if it's on behalf of the party. She knew this. She read all their literature. She knew all about them. She said the churches were especially vulnerable. They're too easily deceived. They're easy prey. They're too naive. They just don't think that people would lie like that to them. The public is easy prey to slick slogans packaged in benign language like democracy, progress, social justice, even economic freedom. And she said, above all, they focus on education, education, education.
- 7.118** Vladimir Lenin said— isn't this a chilling quote? — "Give me four years to teach the children and the seed that I have sown will never be uprooted." It's the time it takes to get a college degree in America. She told the US Senate, "There is no doubt in my mind that the Communists will use the schools and every other educational medium to do what they want to do."
- 7.119** And finally, I say she's a perfect example of Pope John Paul II's exhortation. I'll mention him in the next lecture. "Do not be afraid." Be a courageous witness against these evils and on behalf of truth.

Lecture 8: The Collapse of Communism

At a glance — The collapse of communism, the finale.

- 8.1** Okay, our eighth and final lecture in this series. As I said from the very beginning, we've been working up through this chronologically. We started with the birth of Karl Marx, May 5, 1818, went up through his life. Then we get to The Communist Manifesto, 1848, Bolshevik Revolution, 1917. Then, in the last couple of lectures, we talked about American Marxism, went to the '20s, '30s, '40s, and '50s.
- 8.2** Now, I think appropriately for the final lecture, we talk about the collapse of communism. Now, unfortunately, as I've said, communism still exists in other forms, but at least what we fought against, what the United States fought against in the Cold War, there's some closure to that. There was a major victory, a major defeat of Soviet communism that came at the end of the 1980s. So I will talk about that.
- 8.3** And I will talk about my main book on the subject, which is called A Pope and a President, about Ronald Reagan and John Paul II and their extraordinary story of how they worked together to defeat Soviet communism. I also talked about this in books of mine, like God and Ronald Reagan.
- 8.4** And the main one where I talked about it, the case of just Reagan, was The Crusader: Ronald Reagan and the Fall of Communism. That's the book that the Reagan movie with Dennis Quaid, 2024, was based on.
- 8.5** But before getting to that good news and how Reagan and John Paul II worked together, I'll give some bad news here. A tabulation of just how many people these—you know what's; I'll try not to curse, make this family-friendly—just how many people these guys killed. It's an extraordinary number.
- 8.6** The Black Book of Communism, which was published by Harvard University Press in 1999, is probably the most respected authoritative account to try to pin an actual number on the death toll, the butcher's bill, if you will. And what's so good about the Black Book of Communism is that it's written by largely really leftists, some of them former communists, some of them still very sympathetic to the ideology. But they agreed that they needed to come to terms with just how bloody this ideology was and really talk to the world, tell the world, report to the world, how many people died.
- 8.7** The book, which is edited by Stéphane Courtois, who's a French author, writes that "Communism"—as an ideology—"committed a multitude of crimes, not only against individuals, but against world civilization and national cultures."
- 8.8** It's remarkable, too. A number of people point this out in that book and elsewhere, that communist ideology in these countries, where it was implemented, killed people at a level and scale unlike anything that those countries and cultures had ever seen before, ever in their entire history. You don't see in the history of Cambodia anything

like what happened under the Khmer Rouge in just three or four years. You don't see in Cuba the suffering under Castro that you had. Batista was a dictator, but you didn't see numbers of death like that. You didn't see in the history of Russia, even with all the bad stuff that's happened in the long history of Russia, cases of a few tsars where 20 or 30 million people were killed in the name of the monarchy or the ideology or the political system.

- 8.9 Courtois notes, "Communist regimes turned mass crime into a full-blown system of government." Martin Malia also writes in the Black Book of Communism, and he talks about how it was as if the communist governments in the process of nationalizing everything—transportation, communication, farms and factories—even nationalized crime.
- 8.10 They took over crime. It's like, "We'll take that, too, please. That used to be part of the private sector. But if we're going to take everything, we're going to take everything. We'll take crime, too." These were like criminal enterprises because of what they did, how they operated. In 1999, the Black Book endeavored to come up with a death total altogether. How many people killed by communist governments? And they came up with a figure approaching about 100 million altogether, about 100 million dead. And that would be in the 20th century, from the Bolshevik Revolution in 1917, and to that point, to the early to mid-1990s, 100 million dead.
- 8.11 Now, I'll break these numbers down. Here's the numbers from the Black Book. The USSR—you can see in my overhead, too. Who do we have laying there? None other than Vladimir Lenin himself in his tomb. The Black Book of Communism credits the Soviet Union, USSR, with, I will say, "only" 20 million deaths.
- 8.12 Now, we know that that number is low. That number is conservative. I think most people ought to argue with that. Books done by sources as diverse as Lee Edwards, Robert Conquest, Alexander Solzhenitsyn, R. J. Rummel, and his work and his database is Death by Government. They all come up with far higher numbers than that.
- 8.13 There was a book that came out in the early 2000s by Yale University Press called A Century of Violence in Soviet Russia, and it was done by Alexander Yakovlev. Yakovlev was Gorbachev's chief reformer. So he would be—in fact, they called him a liberal, because he was all about rejecting the old system. Faithwise, it's an interesting story. But in terms of—he was given the job in the early 1990s of trying to count the skulls, if you will, trying to figure out just how many people were killed under the system.
- 8.14 It's interesting that in pretty much all of these communist countries, including Cambodia, there are post-communist projects done by local researchers and academicians and so forth, trying to find out how many people were killed in their countries. Because the communists didn't always keep exact numbers. The Nazis in World War II could be pretty exact. They could tell you with frightening precision how

many people they gassed at Auschwitz. But the communists didn't always broadcast these numbers.

8.15 But the Alexander Yakovlev book, *A Century of Violence in Soviet Russia*, Yale University Press, he said in their quote, "Stalin alone annihilated over 60 million people." So that's quite a statement. So 20 million is probably a conservative figure.

8.16 Now, the *Black Book of Communism* says that the country that had the most deaths was China: 65 million. They had more people to kill, I suppose, almost a billion, at the time that Mao Zedong was doing what he was doing. And that happened. The bulk of those died from 1957 to 1960 in the Great Leap Forward, including the massive famine during that period that probably killed a minimum of 30 million people. And then the Great Proletarian Cultural Revolution from 1966 to 1969. So altogether, you're looking at about a 12-year period of at least 65 million deaths. Now, the latest numbers—and this is all under one man: Mao Zedong. In fact, I'll show you Mao's picture right there. So that's all under Mao alone.

8.17 Add to that, I think you could—the latest numbers on China, including a book, *Mao: The Unknown Story*, by Jon Halliday and his wife—I can't think of her name. They think that Mao may have killed, may have been responsible for the deaths of over 70 million, over 70 million.

8.18 So right there, if you're looking at closer to 60 million with the Soviet Union, closer to 70 million with China, that's 130 million people right there. That'd be on the upper end of projections. This doesn't even include, I should note, other factors.

8.19 Look at China after the death of Mao. It wasn't Mao who did—it was Deng Xiaoping, who was a reformer who in many ways repudiated Mao, but he implemented the one-child policy in China, where Chinese women were told that you were allowed to have one pregnancy brought to term, and that was it. After that, you were expected to abort, terminate the pregnancy in the womb. Or if you did have the child, you were fined very, very, very heavily in a punitive way.

8.20 One of the reasons why there have been so many adoptions in the West of Chinese girls is because Chinese women would have the baby anyway, maybe a second pregnancy, and they would take the baby and leave it at quite literally the doorstep of an orphanage.

8.21 My wife and I have adopted two children, and we looked at one point into adopting Chinese children. When you look into this, you'll be really struck. It's like, wow, all the Chinese children that are up for adoption at this agency, they're all girls. They're all girls. Because it tends to be girls. How's this for feminists? Take this for pro-abortion feminists. It's been girls that were the most punished in China, because a lot of Chinese couples figure that if they're allowed to have one child, it's going to be a male, somebody who could be an heir, somebody who could, I guess, supposedly maybe work more on the farm or whatever. So if a female is identified via ultrasound, in the

womb, they may choose to abort the female. Or if they do give birth to her, they'll drop her off at an orphanage so that they could get their boy.

8.22 It's really a sick, sad thing, and it's led to a horrible, quite unnatural situation in China, where they have a deficit, male-female deficit, of tens of millions less girls than they do men. They've got a whole generation of marriageable men struggling to find marriageable women because they vanished, because they were never produced. And China, which in doing this, followed the population-control advice of many people in the West: Paul Ehrlich, his book, *The Population Bomb* in 1968. They've come to realize now what a big mistake this was. They now realize that they've had a birth dearth, and this has caused real problems. In the last few years, they've changed the one-child policy.

8.23 I mention all of this because that figure, however many of those girls' lives were terminated because of a communist policy on population control, that's not even included in the 65 million, 70 million figure. Who knows what that could be?

8.24 I should add, with Russia, that also doesn't include— the Russia figures, of course, don't include abortion either. You wouldn't include abortion in these numbers. But communist countries always had the highest abortion rates. And in Russia, it got so bad. The abortion rate got so bad. This is unbelievable. In the 1970s, in the Soviet Union, they were averaging seven to eight million abortions per year, according to official Soviet statistics. In America, post-Roe v. Wade, I think the highest we ever got was a little under two million a year. They were doing seven to eight million a year. A year. So giant numbers.

8.25 Also not included in the Russia numbers are the number of World War II deaths. As Nikita Khrushchev said in 1956 in his Crimes of Stalin speech, you could blame a lot of the Soviet World War II deaths on Stalin's purges of the military. Stalin purged his military, killed seven out of eight admirals, tens of thousands of corps commanders. He did this between 1936 and 1938. So when World War II came after the Hitler-Stalin Pact and Hitler betrays Stalin and they invade Russia, Operation Barbarossa, you have a lack of men who know how to run a war because Stalin purged them.

8.26 I saw an old special on maybe the History Channel 20 or 30 years ago called "Military Blunders," where they talk about mistakes made in combat, such as Desert One. And this military blunder was just on Stalin annihilating his officer corps because it made possible the annihilation of Russia and the Soviet Union by Hitler when that time came.

8.27 So you could probably include some World War II deaths there. And you could even go—I don't know. Got to be careful with data, right? But it was Hitler and Stalin together who launched World War II. So how many World War II deaths would you like to peg on Stalin.

8.28 Some of these Jewish-American communists that I talked about, who bolted from the party, outraged over the Hitler-Stalin Pact, would include those numbers. They would

say, "Yeah, yeah. Stalin is equally responsible for what happened in Poland in September 1939." The Hitler-Stalin Pact was signed on August 23rd–24th, 1939. And Hitler wasn't there, but it was signed in Moscow. It's also known as the Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact. Molotov was Stalin's Foreign Minister. Ribbentrop was Hitler's Foreign Minister. Molotov, Ribbentrop, and Stalin all met together in Moscow and signed that pact. And they agreed that, among other things, they would mutually invade Poland. And that happened exactly seven days later, September 1, 1939, when the Nazis invaded Poland from the West. And then two and a half weeks later, September 17th, 1939, the Soviets invaded Poland from the East. And with that, World War II was on. That's when the Brits declared war, that's when France declared war, that's when World War II started.

- 8.29 Other numbers here, "The Communist Butcher's Bill," as I call it. Vietnam: one million deaths. North Korea: two million deaths. That figure, to my recollection—and where do I write about this? I break these numbers down somewhere in one of my books.
- 8.30 They published the Black Book of Communism too early in the case of North Korea. Because North Korea, between 1995 and 1998—look up the article by Barbara Crossette in The New York Times around 1998 on this. Between 1995 and 1998, 2-3 million North Koreans starved to death under the second Kim. Two to three million starve to death in four years out of a total population of only 20 million people. That's 10 to 15% of the population starving to death in four years, in the period of the second Clinton term. That's how dysfunctional communism is. Those people died.
- 8.31 That was dubbed, including in the article I referenced in The New York Times, a dystopian totalitarian famine, not a famine caused by temperature, or winds, or drought, or flood. And it only happened in North Korea. It didn't happen in South Korea—look at a satellite photo of the Korean Peninsula at night, and it's crazy. The north is a sea of darkness, with the exception of maybe one dot of Pyongyang, and then the south is like a wash in light and electricity. It's an incredible thing. But 2-3 million people starve to death there in the late 1990s.
- 8.32 It ain't easy to starve to death. That takes some work. People were eating bark from trees. People were eating grass. Small animals were gone because people were eating whatever they could. Pets were gone because people would eat dogs or cats or anything they could eat. It was a shocking, horrific duplicate of what had happened in China from 1957 to 1960. Communism comes. A lot of these people, like I said, they learn this craft in Asia—in Paris. France never becomes communist. But these people go there, and they learn it, and then they bring it back to Asia and destroy their beautiful countries with it.
- 8.33 Speaking of which, Cambodia. Cambodia: two million deaths. Cambodia might be the worst of all of these in terms of sheer percentage of population. The numbers on Cambodia is probably—the range is about 1.7 to three million dead. Here, they use the figure two million, but it could be as high as three million. Out of a total population of

five to seven million people, and this is like four years, 1975 to the end of 1978. Two to three million dead, possibly, out of five to seven million in the population.

- 8.34** That would be the greatest percentage of death in a population under communist ideology or any ideology. Eastern Europe: about one million deaths. Latin America: about 150,000 deaths. Now, that would include Castro's Cuba.
- 8.35** I could do a whole lecture on Castro's Cuba, and really, I probably should. But with Castro's Cuba, the numbers here, the Black Book uses a figure that's common to most assessments of Castro. From 1959 to about 1989, 1990s, looking at 15,000 to 18,000 people killed in Castro's Cuba. That would be purges by rifle by Fidel's chief executioner, Che Guevara, at the La Cabana Prison, where Che described himself as bloodthirsty. So 15 to 17 thousand people killed in Cuba.
- 8.36** Beyond that, and I mentioned this a few lectures back, the Black Book of Communism says this as well, these are US Coast Guard numbers, UN numbers, and others. Between 1959 and the 1990s, approximately 100,000 people tried to escape Cuba by swimming to Florida. Imagine that. Any swimmers in here? I have kids who swim, but it's not easy to swim like 90 miles. I don't care how good you are. They would take whatever they could get their hands on that would float.
- 8.37** Remember Elian Gonzalez, 1999, 2000, washing up, escaping with his mother and some others, and he's the only one that made it. And the Clinton administration had a big explosion internally over this, and they sent him back to Cuba because Castro called a press conference with his father and demanded the child back. Al Gore, by the way, the vice president was against it, sending him back. He knew that this could cost him Florida in the election. And by the way, it did. The Florida recount went to Bush, who won in the 2000 election.
- 8.38** But of the 100,000 that have attempted to swim, Black Book and others note that at least 40,000 died from drowning. Shark-infested waters. I've got a son who's literally fishing in Florida right now and sent me a text picture last night of a shark that they got. This is—these are dangerous waters down there.
- 8.39** And the Cuban government, the Black Book of Communism talks about this, would fly overhead in helicopters and drop sandbags on these people, Marielitos, whoever, who were trying to swim out of there. Sandbag sounds almost comical, right? If you read that the Cuban government was flying overhead, gunning at them, it'd be so outrageous that maybe the UN would demand the removal of Castro at that point, right? But instead, they quietly fly over. There's a lot of sand in Cuba. It's cheap. Fill up a bag with it, drop it from 4,000 feet, hit somebody who's been swimming 20 or 25 miles who's exhausted.
- 8.40** Africa: 1.7 million deaths. Africa would include there—the worst case was Mengistu Haile Mariam in Ethiopia, which was a massive famine, terrible. I go to Washington, DC a lot because I said as an editor at The American Spectator, our offices are in

Alexandria, Virginia. A lot of my cab drivers are from Ethiopia. There's a huge Ethiopian community in Washington, DC. Every time I go there, I start up a conversation. If they're from Ethiopia, I ask them about Mengistu Haile Mariam. I would say at least half of my cab drivers, or at least back a few years ago, escaped during that time. He annihilated that beautiful, historic, very religious, ancient country.

- 8.41** Afghanistan: 1.5 million deaths. And that happened under the Communist regime that took over in 1978, and then with the Soviet invasion in 1979, and the Soviets were there until 1989, a 10-year period. The blowup of Afghanistan that eventually led to the Mujahideen, the so-called freedom fighters, holy warriors, which even brought in Osama bin Laden. Osama bin Laden went to Afghanistan in the 1980s, among these other Mujahideen, to fight the communists, to fight the Soviets. In all, said Professor Martin Malia, "It is the most colossal case of political carnage in history." Indeed.
- 8.42** Ronald Reagan gave a radio broadcast in the 1970s where he described communism as a disease. It's hard to find contagions that killed that many people. The influenza epidemic of 1918 to 1919 killed—what—maybe 20, 30 million. There's higher numbers on that in more recent research, but that's nowhere close to this. Reagan said it's not just like a disease, it's a form of insanity.
- 8.43** Look at these numbers. I already said a lot of this, but altogether, if the communist death toll might even be closer to 140 million, this would be a rate of multiple thousands of people dead per day over the course of the period from 1917 to the end of the Cold War and the end of the 1990s.
- 8.44** By comparison, Hitler's genocide was about 10 million, about six million Jews, and then another several million what he calls misfits, undesirables, gypsies, Poles, Slavs. You'd have to take all the dead in World War I and World War II, combine them and double them to get close to the number of people the Communist governments have killed.
- 8.45** The dance of death. Remember Marx's words? "Ever more boldly"—his player, the violinist—"ever more boldly, I play the Dance of Death." That's what that was, a dance of death.
- 8.46** This deadly ideology was confronted by two men who both called it evil, described it as evil. And that would be Ronald Reagan and Pope John Paul II. Now, because I did a 600-page book on this, it's going to be pretty hard to sum it up in 30 minutes. But I'll see what I can do. I have about 30 slides as well. I'll skip around quite a bit.
- 8.47** John Paul II was born Karol Wojtyła in Poland in 1920. Ronald Reagan was born in Tampico, Illinois, on February 6, 1911. So they were about a decade apart. Here's the game changer. And I could talk at great length about Reagan and where Reagan was at this time and everything. But we'll start with October 16, 1978.
- 8.48** In the middle of this war on religion that the communists had been orchestrating, that the Soviets had been orchestrating, spreading it everywhere around the world, behind

the Iron Curtain. All the countries—to quote Churchill in the Iron Curtain speech—Budapest, Bucharest, Berlin, Sofia, all the countries behind the Iron Curtain.

- 8.49** The one area where the communists' war on religion had utterly failed was in Poland. Poland remained overwhelmingly religious, overwhelmingly Roman Catholic. And the communists tried again, again, and again, but failed to stop it in Poland.
- 8.50** So the College of Cardinals gets together to hold another conclave. The previous pope had been chosen earlier and lived for only 33 days, was pope for only 33 days. So the conclave gets together again. On October 16, 1978, the College of Cardinals, under the fresco of Michelangelo's Last Judgment in the Sistine Chapel, made an incredible decision. They chose the first non-Italian pope in 455 years. The pope was always Italian, right? It's just the way that it was. Now he's Polish, if you can believe that. But 455 years, they picked the first ever Slavic pope. Lo and behold, they pluck him out of Poland, of all things. Karol Wojtyła, Archbishop of Krakow, was chosen the 264th heir to the chair of St. Peter. Picks the name John Paul II.
- 8.51** The reaction to this, the Soviets were just completely stunned. They couldn't believe it. The head of the KGB, Yuri Andropov, telephones the KGB chief in Warsaw and says, "How could you possibly allow the election of a citizen of a socialist country as pope?" The KGB resident in Warsaw says, "I don't have anything to do with that. You can maybe send your protest to the College of Cardinals in the Vatican. Nothing I can do about that."
- 8.52** Karol Wojtyła thought pretty much the same. He thought, in fact, he turned to his close aide and said, the Italian equivalent of what the— "You can't have a Polish pope. Pope is supposed to be Italian. A Polish pope. This is impossible. What are they doing? What are they doing?"
- 8.53** In his first homily, six days later, October 22, 1978, he exhorts the faithful and really the three-word signature phrase of his papacy: "Be not afraid open the doors to Christ. Open them wide. Open the borders of state economic and political systems, the vast domains of culture!"
- 8.54** But Moscow, on the other hand, is very, very afraid and furious. John Paul II announced—he was asked by his aides, "Where do you want to go for your first foreign trip?" And he said, "Poland." They were like, "Oh, Holy Father. We're already rocking the boat here. I mean, I don't know. You really want to do that?" And he said, "Poland. I'm going to Poland. I'm going to Poland. Period." Brezhnev, of course, hears about this; the whole world hears about this, so he telephones Edward Gierek and tells him to veto the trip. We now have this transcript of this conversation.
- 8.55** Gierek said, "How can I not receive a Polish pope? My countrymen are Catholics. They're Polish." Then Brezhnev actually told—only a Communist dictator would say something that's stupid— "Tell the pope, he is a wise man, that he could announce publicly that he cannot come because he has taken ill." Meanwhile, he's thinking, taken

ill? He's in his mid-fifties. He's like a picture of health, and this is several months away. What are you talking about? Gierek tells him that he really can't do that. That wouldn't be very effective. And Brezhnev barks at him about his predecessor, "Gomułka was a better communist than you," slams down the phone. So John Paul II goes to Poland, June 2 through 11, 1979.

- 8.56** Newt and Callista Gingrich—Callista Gingrich was an ambassador to the Vatican under Donald Trump—did a fabulous documentary on this called "Nine Days That Changed the World." He arrives there, and he goes to there's huge crowds, an outdoor mass of 2-3 million people.
- 8.57** Lech Wałęsa, the Polish Solidarity movement leader, said, "He comes to Poland, and the 20 who followed me were suddenly now 10 million. It was a greater multiplication than the loaves and the fishes." Great, great line.
- 8.58** So on June 2nd, he gives his opening homily at Victory Square in Poland. Isn't that beautiful? Victory Square. So he's not holding back here. He and Reagan shared courage in common. And he said exactly what his handlers didn't want him to say. "Just stick to religion, okay? No politics." Meanwhile, he's like, "I'm not going to get too political, but we're going to talk about morality and things that matter."
- 8.59** He says this, tells the people, "Christ cannot be kept out of the history of man in any part of the globe. The exclusion of Christ from the history of man is an act against man." Here he's talking about the communists. "Without Christ, it is impossible to understand the history of Poland," which is true, from the Black Madonna and on and on and on. And then he says this emphatically, and this is a shot heard around the world: "There can be no just Europe without the independence of Poland marked on its map." He calls for the independence of Poland: "There can be no just Europe without the independence of Poland marked on its map." That's quite a shot at Moscow.
- 8.60** The New York Times does a snooty, stupid editorial. So smug, three days later: "As much as the visit of John Paul II to Poland might reinvigorate and re-inspire the Roman Catholic Church in Poland, it doesn't threaten the political order of the nation or Eastern Europe." Yeah, right. Tell that to the Soviets. Tell that to them. Sure.
- 8.61** Reagan, on the other hand, is watching this on TV, and I talked to Richard V. Allen, Reagan's first National Security Advisor, and they're sitting together in Reagan's living room. They were talking about foreign policy. They were having sandwiches. Then Reagan said, "Dick, let's go turn on the evening news," which, those of you old enough to remember, would have been like 6:00 on CBS, ABC, NBC. They turned it on, and they're watching footage of the Pope landing in Poland and these millions of people there.
- 8.62** And Allen said that Reagan was overcome with emotion, and tears welled up in his eyes. And he said, "Dick, look, look, look at this. Look at this. We've got to find a way to get elected. We've got to reach out to this pope and the Vatican and make them an

ally." Because Reagan, at that point, is thinking, "It's 1979. I lost in 1976 when I challenged Gerald Ford for the Republican primary. But I'm running again in 1980. I've got this plan,"—as he told Dick Allen—"we win, they lose."

8.63 Reagan goes to the Berlin Wall in November 1978. He and Nancy, Dick Allen and Dick's wife, Peter Hannaford, Peter Hannaford's wife, and he looks at the wall and says, "We've got to find a way to knock this thing down. We've got to win the Cold War." But how do you do that? Well, the election of a Polish pope really, really, really helps.

8.64 Reagan considered it providential, called it part of the DP, the divine plan. Reagan gave a radio address on this. In the radio address, he was writing these daily, nationally syndicated radio address, which he would handwrite himself. These were about 300 to 400 words each. He said, Stalin once contemptuously asked, "How many divisions does the pope have?"

8.65 Reagan said we've just found out. "Wherever we went in Poland, there were unbelievable numbers, crowds of a half million, million, five million." Reagan said, "Poles lived first the Nazis and then the Soviets. The voices behind those tanks and guns told them, 'There is no God.'" That's what Lenin said, "We do not believe in God." Then Reagan asked, "Will the Kremlin ever be the same again? Will any of us, for that matter?" And Reagan was indeed never the same again.

8.66 Here is his second National Security Advisor, William P. Clark, Bill Clark. I was Clark's biographer. He became like another grandfather to me. We talked every day for years. We were very, very close. Clark, more than any other figure, helped Reagan win the Cold War on the American side. Bill Clark, Bill Casey, the CIA director, and Ronald Reagan, that was really the three.

8.67 And Clark said, "Reagan knew that Poland would be the linchpin in the dissolution of the Soviet Empire." He felt that the Communist Bloc, B-L-O-C, picture it like a block of wood, B-L-O-C-K. In the middle, you've got Poland. If you could just take a wedge and start pounding it in the middle, you could crack that entire block from top to finish. Reagan felt that Poland had been betrayed by the West, including FDR at Yalta. Promised free and fair elections in 1945. Never happened. But Poland was the key. Poland was the linchpin. And now, especially so with the Polish pope.

8.68 In response to all of this, Reagan says, "Bill, Dick Allen, we need to reach out to this new Polish pope in the Vatican and make them an ally. And I need to get elected. I need to win the presidency," which is not always easy to do. All the new pope had to do was survive.

8.69 To that end, we now know John Koehler found these documents and published them. On November 13, 1979, there was a meeting of the nine comrades of the Soviet Central Committee on a dreary, drizzly, cold day in Moscow, where they get together a few months after the pope's appearance in Poland, and they meet to try to decide what to do about this menace, this Polish pope. This is a real problem. What do we do?

- 8.70** They issue this statement, which they certainly don't publish publicly, "Use all possibilities available to the Soviet Union to prevent the new course of policies initiated by the Polish pope, if necessary, with additional measures beyond disinformation and discreditation."
- 8.71** Because they do disinformation all the time, the Soviets. It was called dezinformatsiya. They had a Soviet Department of Disinformation. They had a Soviet Department of Agitprop. But now they're talking—by the way, a country that's killed tens of millions of people, when they say, "Use all possibilities available to prevent this new pope from pursuing—" That's a scary prospect.
- 8.72** As Kohler noted, "In laymen's terms, this was an order for assassination foreshadowed by the need to 'get physically close' with the pope." Kohler said that at the end of the text was a note from the Italian secret service: "SISDE says document found, Moscow points to plan for the physical elimination of JP II." Yeah. I mean, they wouldn't do that, would they, the Soviets? Kill a pope? They would really do that?
- 8.73** Keeping this in chronology. All Ronald Reagan had to do was get elected. You guys could see from the slide. Pretty good job there, right? So my overhead shows a vast sea of red. Reagan defeated the incumbent Jimmy Carter by winning 44 out of 50 states, won the Electoral College, 489 to 49, won the popular vote by 10 percentage points. He was sworn in on January 20, 1981.
- 8.74** He's got his hand there on his mother's Bible, Nell Reagan, who I dedicate my book God and Ronald Reagan to. It's open to 2 Chronicles 7:14, which is the passage, "If my people turn from their wicked ways, I will heal them. I will heal their land." And Reagan's mother, Nell, had written next to that passage a wonderful verse for the healing of a nation.
- 8.75** So now John Paul II is in, and Reagan is in. The Soviets are apoplectic. This is their worst nightmare. A Polish pope in Rome, this anti-communist president in Washington. They immediately fear a Reagan-pope alliance.
- 8.76** So the Soviet press denounced the pope as a "malicious, lowly, perfidious, backward toady of the American militarists"—typical language, Marx, Lenin—"who's seeking to undermine communism with his overseas accomplices and with his new boss in the White House." Reagan, his new boss. Reagan is his boss in the White House.
- 8.77** I say here, if only these two men could be gone, that's the thinking. Preferably dead. To quote Uncle Joe Stalin—as FDR called him, Uncle Joe—"Death solves all problems. No man, no problem." Well, they almost get their wish, Reagan first.
- 8.78** March 30, 1981. He's coming out of the Washington Hilton in DC, and waiting for him there is a young man named John Hinckley, who's just trying to get the attention of the actress Jodie Foster. No grandiose scheme, not part of any conspiracy. And he takes his shots at Reagan. He uses .22 Devastator bullets that explode on impact.

- 8.79** Reagan believes that his life was spared by God. He very easily could have bled to death. People here are old enough to remember, right? It's initially reported that Reagan wasn't even hit, and then that he was okay.
- 8.80** Well, Nancy Reagan gets to the hospital and pretty much collapses when she finds out that, no, he's hit and he's bleeding to death, and he needs emergency surgery. What does he say to the surgical team before he goes out? "I hope you're all Republicans." Finds a way to joke about it. But he survived, and he told people close to him that he believed that his life was spared by God, spared by God for a special purpose, which he believed had something to do with taking down what he will call an evil empire.
- 8.81** Merely six weeks later, on May 13, 1981, John Paul II is riding through St. Peter's Square in the white Fiat popemobile. He is getting ready for one of his general audiences. Waiting for him is a 23-year-old Muslim Turk named Mehmet Ali Agca. He's concealing in his jacket a 9-millimeter semi-automatic Browning handgun. He's been waiting there all day long. And then about five o'clock, a little bit after five o'clock, about 5:13, 5:15, he pulls it out and starts firing at the pope.
- 8.82** The pope immediately collapses into the arms of his aides, Father Zhevich, Angelo Gugli. And Zhevich asks the Pope, "Are you hit?" He says, "Yes." He said, "Where?" "In the stomach."
- 8.83** They immediately rush the pope to Gemelli Hospital, one of Rome's best hospitals. Traffic is almost impassable if any of you have ever been to Rome in rush hour. The Gemelli doctor, providentially, happens to be nearby, jumps into the ambulance. And like Reagan, he's quickly losing blood, a lot of blood.
- 8.84** Like Reagan, he is greeted at his hospital by the hospital's very best. The top surgeon, Francesco Crucitti, happened to be present. When Reagan was shot and was sent to George Washington University Hospital, there just happened to be a meeting of all the surgical heads of all the different departments who were there that day.
- 8.85** Crucitti comes in, goes straight to the ninth floor, mobbed by nurses, scrubs. He looks grimly at his patient, whose blood pressure plummets to 70. John Paul II, who right before he went out, said to the nurse, "How could they do it? How could they do it?" It's interesting that he said "they" because there was only one shooter.
- 8.86** He has five and a half hours of emergency surgery, requires six pints of blood transfusion. Reagan needed eight. The bullet missed his main abdominal artery by centimeters. In Reagan's case, the bullet missed his heart by a mere centimeters. If that bullet is a little bit over, a few centimeters over for both men, they both die in the car on the way to the hospital.
- 8.87** Well, they believe that both made it, both survived. Reagan's diary entry that day, May 13, 1981, he wrote, "Word brought to us of the shooting of the pope. I called Cardinal

Cooke and Cardinal Krol, sent a message to Vatican and prayed." And this after John Paul II had been praying for Reagan, after Reagan got shot on March 30, 1981.

- 8.88** Dick Allen, that guy, who Reagan said to him, "We win; they lose. We've got to find a way to knock this thing down. We've got to reach out to this pope and make him an ally." He said, "Reagan asked me every day about the Pontiff's recovery. His affection for the Pope was greatly magnified."
- 8.89** He sends a letter from Congressman Rodino to be delivered directly to John Paul II, where he tells the pope, "Happily, few leaders in the world today have the dubious distinction of knowing with some precision the event that you have just experienced." So it's funny because Moscow was worried about a bond between these two. Well, now there's really a bond between these two. I mean, there couldn't be a more remarkable bond, both shot six weeks apart.
- 8.90** They had wanted to meet since Reagan was elected in November 1980, certainly since he was inaugurated in January 1981. This was stopped by the shooting of the pope—the shooting of Reagan first, and then the shooting of the pope. They finally get together on June 7, 1982, at the Vatican.
- 8.91** Reagan looked at John Paul II and said, "Look how the evil forces were put in our way and how providence intervened." And he told him, there's a cover of the Time magazine story on this, "The Holy Alliance," done by Woodward and Bernstein—Carl Bernstein—in 1992. So imagine this, the president of the United States, not Polish, not Catholic, says to the Polish Catholic pope, he says, "Hope remains. It remains in Poland. We working together can keep it alive."
- 8.92** They talked about using the forces of the Solidarity Movement, the Vatican, and the United States to work together to keep Solidarity alive, to create the wedge in the Soviet Empire that could take down peacefully the whole Soviet Bloc and win the Cold War. And they both said to one another that they believe that their lives have been spared for the purpose of working together to defeat atheistic Soviet communism. Pretty remarkable. They committed their aides to that task.
- 8.93** One cardinal, quoted by Bernstein in the Time magazine cover piece, said, "Nobody believed the collapse of communism would happen this fast or in this timetable." But in their first meeting, the Holy Father and President committed themselves and the institutions of the church and America to such a goal. From that day, the focus was to bring it about."
- 8.94** They would meet five times. At the Vatican, June 1982. Fairbanks, Alaska, because both are flying over that area, coming back to or from trips to Asia, May 1984. Miami, Florida, September 1987. The cover of my book that has Reagan talking and the pope listening pensively to him, that's Miami, September 1987. The Vatican, again, June 1987. And they met at Castel Gandolfo in Italy, September of 1990.

- 8.95** What compelled me to write this book was that I had not only my interest in Reagan and John Paul II, but I had found out from the closest aide to Bill Casey, the CIA director—in the book, I don't say his name because he was not allowed publicly to disclose this information. He said, "If you share my name, which you wouldn't do to me because we're friends, but I'd have to call you a liar because I can't end up in Leavenworth." But I said that I would share his name after he died.
- 8.96** He died pretty unexpectedly. Herb Meyer was my source for this. Herb Meyer told me they, at the CIA, did a super-secret investigation. He said it's the tightest report that he's ever seen done in all of his years of intelligence. The report was done by two young women working for the agency. He said they did fantastic work. They looked into the issue of who made the call to shoot the pope. They came to the conclusion that it was indeed the Russians. To quote her, "The Russians did it. The Russians ordered the hit on the pope."
- 8.97** It wasn't the KGB that ran it. It was the GRU, the Soviet GRU, military intelligence. That's the group that knows where all the bodies are buried. The KGB head, Yuri Andropov, is the one that said, "How could you allow a Polish pope to be chosen?" He knew about it. He gave the go-ahead on the hit, but it was organized by the Soviet GRU. So they organized the attempted assassination of the pope.
- 8.98** I found out that John Paul II was briefed on this report. John Paul II's answer was, "I know. I figured as much. Of course, they did it." He connected it to the Feast Day of Our Lady of Fatima, May 13, 1981, May 13, 1917, Third Secret of Fatima, all kinds of stuff that I go into at great length in the book.
- 8.99** But he was Thomas Melady, who was George H. W. Bush's ambassador to the Vatican. He told John Paul II, "We know that they did it. We had an investigation on it. We did a report on it. Do you want us to disclose this information?" And Melady said that John Paul II said, "In his very calm voice, he told me that he did not want the US to make an issue of the 1981 plot to assassinate him." What was done was done.
- 8.100** Gorbachev was now in. He was working with Gorbachev. The Cold War was ending. And by the way, had they come out and said this, the Soviet disinformation apparatus would have denied it, would have called him names. It wasn't going to make any difference. He had his eyes fixed on higher things, higher priorities.
- 8.101** I'll finish with this. The collapse of communism comes, and it came in 1989. And the real sign of that is not so much the fall of the Berlin Wall, which came in November 1989. But elections in Poland on June 4, 1989, which, ironically, was the start that time of Tiananmen Square as well in China, an event that overshadowed elections in Poland.
- 8.102** But Poland had been promised free and fair elections back at Yalta in February 1945. They finally come in 1989. Now, they only, because the communists were still in charge, they only allowed 100 seats to be contested. This is typical of communists. If they're going to allow any elections at all, even in a moment like this, it's not going to be very

many. Of the 100 seats, the communists won how many? Zero. Which is why communists don't hold elections.

- 8.103** Mikhail Gorbachev said, "When the elections were held in Poland, I knew it was all over. I knew the Cold War was effectively over." It was just a few months after that, November 9, 1989, that the Berlin Wall fell and the Cold War was over. The historian John Lukacs said, "The 20th century ended in 1989." And it effectively did.
- 8.104** But I'll put a little coda on it just to close out this course topic. Where it really ends, and some of you old enough like me to have lived through it, I was a senior in college at the time, pre-med major at the University of Pittsburgh, as I said in my first talk, where it really ended—because we thought 1989, we said, "Well, this is great, but Eastern Europe is free, even Romania." But the USSR still exists. There's still these hard-line party apparatchiks.
- 8.105** Boris Yeltsin held an election, and he won. He's now president of Russia or the Russian Federation or whatever it's called. The USSR is still, well, it's breaking apart. Countries are declaring independence, Ukraine, Latvia, Lithuania, all of these other countries are declaring independence. But Mikhail Gorbachev is still president of what's called the USSR, the Soviet Union. So as long as he has that, it still exists.
- 8.106** Well, on December 18, 1991, the Kremlin put down the red flag that had been flying there since the Bolshevik days and replaced it with the flag of the Russian Federation. And then seven days later—and I love this, especially given the focus of our course talking about religion—on Christmas Day, 1991, December 25, 1991, Mikhail Gorbachev, who called off the war on religion, calls President George H. W. Bush, who had succeeded Ronald Reagan, and said, "I want to wish you a Merry Christmas, and I want to let you know that I am resigning as head of the Soviet Union." And so on that date, the evil empire, the USSR, ceased to exist. That was the end of it—on the date that celebrates the birth of Christ, that the communists had tried to stop, of all things.
- 8.107** So if you're walking through the graveyard of history, it says, "Communists, Bolshevik, Russia, born October 25, 26, whatever, 1917, died Christmas Day, December 25, 1991. Evil Empire, do not rest in peace. Do not rest in peace." All right, very good. I'll stop there and I'll take any questions that you have.
- 8.108** Thank you. Any other papal encyclicals that maybe stood out to you in your research? I did actually read *Qui Pluribus*.
- 8.109** *Qui Pluribus*, yeah.
- 8.110** I read it last night, and I was really amazed by what was in there. That was 170 years ago, right?
- 8.111** Amazing, is it? Two years before the Manifesto was even published.
- 8.112** Crazy.

- 8.113** Crazy, yeah. I would say the other ones that stand out, *Divini Redemptoris*, that's the one from 1937. What really struck me, I read that one before any other. So *Divini Redemptoris* on atheistic communism. That one, I remember the first time I read it, people were still just apoplectic that Reagan had used words like evil to describe the Soviet Empire. And by the way, why wouldn't you? Even Soviet citizens, when the Cold War ended, were like, "Why did you mock him for this?" Of course, it was evil.
- 8.114** But I read *Divini Redemptoris*. It makes Reagan's evil empire talk look like, I don't know, a kid's nursery rhyme or something. It just excoriates Soviet communism, calls it a satanic scourge orchestrated by the sons of darkness. So it really, that encyclical seems to describe communism as quite literally out of the pit of hell.
- 8.115** And it says in a phrase that Reagan used, not from *Divini Redemptoris*, because I don't know if Reagan would have known of the encyclical, but Reagan said the same thing. It said that the ideology that we're confronting, this is—I want to call Reagan—not a battle of just rockets and money, but of ideas, of morality. This is an ideology, first and foremost, of the moral and spiritual order. So the church, in that encyclical, saw communism as a dark supernatural force beyond some proposed economic system.
- 8.116** Has communism become more resilient due to modern technology making authoritarian control easier, or has modern technology and communication made it more fragile? What's the balance?
- 8.117** Well, I think it has made it more fragile, especially, look at a country like North Korea, trying to not let its people know what's going on in the outside world. North Korea is one of the only places where they haven't been able to do that. I talked to somebody from Cuba a few years ago who told me, they said, "Oh, yeah, because of cell phones now, and they do everything that they can to block our Wi-Fi or whatever, but they'll put it on for an hour. And when they do, everybody goes into this park in Havana, and they get information, and they start finding out the truth about what's going on in the outside world."
- 8.118** China has really found this, especially being a modern technological superpower, that they just can't hold back this technology. So the more that the technology becomes available, you can't nationalize or centralize the means of communication, like Marx advocated for in *The Communist Manifesto*, or that the Soviets did. So it makes it more difficult.
- 8.119** And I would tell people, too, watching this: the way to respond to these evil ideas like communism is to go online and produce your own videos, produce your own—teach, to borrow from Bella Dodd: "educate, educate, educate." Just as they've been out there teaching this stuff in their universities and everything, you at least now have platforms and podcasts, and through sources like the Jordan Peterson Academy, we have a way to respond now based on technology and the internet that we didn't have 20 or 30

years ago. Back then, it was all controlled by a few different sources. Seize that technology and go out there and make a difference yourself.

- 8.120** Do you think the intense presence of Marxism in Hollywood has an effect or potentially caused the current Satanism present in Hollywood?
- 8.121** Yeah, it's a good question. In those days, so the Hollywood Ten and the screenwriters, they had some influence, no question about it. And they gave it a hell of a shot to do what they were doing, to borrow from John Howard Lawson, Dalton Trumbo. "Do not try to make a Communist picture, but get the party line or party message in every script that you write."
- 8.122** But they were still overwhelmed by other filmmakers with greater messages. "Frank Capra," "It's a Wonderful Life," "Mr. Smith Goes to Washington," "Meet John Doe." The studio heads, frankly, people like Ronald Reagan and the studio heads who took them on, who really took them on and stopped them. So Hollywood today is not really pushing communism, but they're pushing other toxic ideas and behaviors and other things that are likewise struggling. But there's certainly not a group, an underground party today in Hollywood that was doing anything like what was happening in the 1930s and 1940s.
- 8.123** Did Lenin have to make any significant changes or amendments to Marxism?
- 8.124** Who?
- 8.125** Lenin.
- 8.126** Lenin.
- 8.127** Yeah. Did he have to make any significant amendments or changes to Marxism to adopt it? Because otherwise it seems like adopting true Marxism is completely impossible.
- 8.128** What Lenin really did was put practicality to it because he said, "Now that I have to implement this, what's it going to look like?" And so Lenin ends up creating the one-party police state. He created the gulag, which they first called concentration camps because they were concentrating people in these camps. The Gulag Archipelago.
- 8.129** He created what became the Committee on State Security, the Cheka, the NKVD, what became the KGB, the GRU. He banned freedom of speech, press, assembly, religion. One scholar said, "At one point in the academy, Marxists would try to blame everything on Stalin." No, Stalin just picked up what Lenin created.
- 8.130** But Lenin, I think, in a way, took Marxism to its natural conclusion, which is that if you're really going to do all the things that they called to do, you're going to need guns and gulags. To have the forcible overthrow of everything that exists, including religion, traditional ideas, you're going to need guns, you're going to need gulags. And that's what he did. And that led to the first of these repressive states that in total killed over 100 million people in the 20th century.

